



HSBC resumes share buybacks as quarterly profits soar to \$10.1bn

Arjun Neil Alim in Hong Kong and Ortenca Aliaj in London

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Wealth management and insurance business in Hong Kong boosts Europe's biggest lender

HSBC's pre-tax profits jumped 60 per cent to \$10.1bn in the second quarter as the bank raised its target for cost savings and announced a new share buyback.

Revenues at Europe's largest lender came in at \$19.1bn in the three months to June 30, against a company-compiled analyst consensus of \$18.6bn — up 16 per cent on the same period last year.

Profits were boosted by its wealth management and insurance business, including in its “second-home market” of Hong Kong, where it said it onboarded 640,000 new clients across HSBC and its subsidiary Hang Seng this year.

Pre-tax profits in the second quarter last year was damped by impairment losses relating to the bank's stake in a Chinese lender, as well as restructuring costs of \$500mn.

“HSBC is becoming the stronger bank we set out to build,” said chief executive Georges Elhedery. “We’re executing our strategic priorities with pace, precision and discipline.”

Shares dipped 0.4 per cent in morning trading in London, bringing the increase this year to a third and valuing the company at £273bn.

HSBC retained its targets of a return on tangible equity of 17 per cent or higher for the next three years, and updated its banking net interest income outlook for 2026 from “around” to “at least” \$46bn.

Profits were up across HSBC's four businesses, with Hong Kong and international wealth and premier banking both delivering double-digit growth.

Wealth revenues rose 22 per cent in the second quarter from a year earlier to \$2.8bn, while wholesale transaction banking revenues were up 7 per cent at \$3bn.

The share buyback worth up to \$1bn is the first since the bank last year announced a deal to take Hang Seng Bank private. It also planned to pay a second interim dividend of \$0.10 per share.

The bank raised its target for savings from its restructuring from \$1.5bn to \$2bn annualised by the end of this year, and recognised an additional \$200mn of costs in the quarter relating to Elhedery's plans to simplify operations.

HSBC also warned its costs may increase if it allowed “additional performance-related pay” on the back of strong business performance. Analysts at Citi responded by warning that higher costs were not factored into existing consensus estimates.

Expected credit losses for the quarter stood at \$1.1bn, in line with the previous year and analyst expectations, with an additional \$400mn set aside for risky loans related to the Hong Kong commercial real estate sector.

Provisions for wholesale banking were \$1.6bn, which HSBC attributed to “fraud-related, secondary, securitisation exposure with a financial sponsor in the UK”. In May the FT reported that HSBC had exposure to collapsed mortgage lender Market Financial Solutions through Apollo’s asset-backed lending unit Atlas SP.

The higher provisions also reflected an uptick for “mid-market clients across the globe”, said Pam Kaur, HSBC’s chief financial officer.

HSBC has continued its drive to simplify operations and reduced the number of managing director positions by 15 per cent between October 2024 and June 2026.

It announced the sale of its \$25.3bn Australian mortgage and personal loan book to a Blackstone-backed group last month and sold its Singapore insurance business to Allianz for \$2.1bn — which the bank said would net it a pre-tax gain of \$1.8bn.

Last month the FT also reported that HSBC had begun to market risky loans made by Hang Seng Bank to investors, in an early sign of how it intends to overhaul the Hong Kong lender after taking full control at the start of this year.

On Andy Burnham taking over as prime minister and the potential for higher taxes on banks, Elhedery said: “We’re very, very encouraged by the government’s ambition to support and enable growth in the UK. UK growth requires strong banks.”

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Top Stories

Firmer rates, loan growth and wealth gains seen lifting Singapore banks' Q2 results

Tan Nai Lun

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Singapore's banks are expected to report resilient second-quarter earnings this week, buoyed by higher interest rates, robust loan growth and strong **wealth management** income.

For Jonathan Koh, director of research at UOB Kay Hian, the banks will likely post strong double-digit growth in **wealth management** fees for Q2, accentuated by a low base in the same period last year.

Investors will be watching for signs that pressure on net interest margins (NIMs) has yet to fully ease and whether earnings momentum can be sustained in the second half of 2026, said analysts.

DBS kicks off the reporting season on Aug 6, followed by OCBC and UOB on Aug 7.

Industry watchers expect to see a slowdown in margin compression after Singapore interest rates rose for the second consecutive month in June, while lending growth remained strong.

At the same time, buoyant equity markets and volatile trading conditions should support non-interest income through **wealth management** and treasury activities, they added.

NIMs, loan growth in focus

Singapore's three-month Singapore Overnight Rate Average (Sora) was up one basis point on month to 1.07 per cent in June.

This was after six quarters during which flushed Singapore dollar liquidity and persistent belief in US dollar weakness kept front-end Singdollar rates low, said DBS Group Research analyst Lim Rui Wen.

This could slow the quarter-on-quarter decline in NIMs, although she cautions that the trend is "not yet over".

For Glenn Thum, research manager at Phillip Securities Research, the "single most important line" to watch is how NIMs fare against what the banks have guided.

Specifically, he noted that UOB had previously guided its 2026 NIM to be 1.75 to 1.80 per cent, but already reported a 1.82 per cent NIM in the first quarter.

"Any beat there resets the whole sector narrative," he said.

Loan growth in the local banking system was also strong in the second quarter.

In May, Singapore's banking system loans grew 8.7 per cent on year, which could lead to the banks raising their loan growth guidance, Thum said.

Thilan Wickramasinghe, head of Singapore research and regional financials at Maybank Investment Banking Group, added: "We will be watching how this has translated into market share for each bank and looking for indicators on the sustainability of this momentum."

Still, analysts cautioned against being overly optimistic.

Thum warned that a US rate hike will likely come because of reignited concerns of oil-driven inflation, which will result in slower loan growth and higher credit cost.

Citi analyst Tan Yong Hong also said markets may have been “euphoric” in pricing in NIM upside from the recent Sora rebound, noting that Singapore continues to have excess liquidity while spot Sora has since gone down.

Tan expects the banks will guide for asset yield pressure, given that they have limited room to reprice their cost of funds lower.

He sees greater downside risks for UOB and OCBC than DBS, which has given consistent guidance. He has a “buy” call on DBS.

He downgraded his call on OCBC to “neutral” on Jul 30, noting that its growth prospects are largely priced in.

Earlier in July, he also put a 30-day downside catalyst watch on UOB, as he expects the market had been “overly optimistic” on a turnaround of UOB’s non-interest income and asset quality.

Non-interest income “heavy lifting”

Analysts also expect non-interest income to provide a meaningful boost to earnings in the second quarter.

Maybank’s Wickramasinghe expects non-interest income to “do some heavy lifting” while DBS’ Lim said that the low cost of funding and ongoing volatility likely supported markets trading revenue.

Strong equity markets are also likely to support growth in wealth assets under management (AUM) alongside net new money inflows, Lim added.

Thum noted that the opportunity with wealth income is that it carries “little credit risk and spills over into treasury and bancassurance”.

But the risk is that fee income is a leveraged bet on markets, so a risk-asset drawdown would hit it hard, he said.

Wickramasinghe flagged that investors should pay attention to how much client wealth has been deployed into investments rather than remaining in cash, as that would provide a better gauge of underlying client sentiment, rather than just safe-haven demand.

For Jonathan Koh, director of research at UOB Kay Hian, the banks will likely post strong double-digit growth in **wealth management** fees for Q2, accentuated by a low base in the same period last year.

However, the banks may “tone down their expectations” on growth in **wealth management** for the rest of 2026, due to the recent pullback in technology stocks and the “on-and-off” nature of the Middle East conflict.

Even so, Koh has an “overweight” call on the banking sector, noting that the banks “deserve to trade at a premium for their structural resilience”.

He added that the sustainability of the banks’ dividend payouts is supported by their resilient earnings, strong capital adequacy and discipline in capital management.

Lim also noted that Singapore banks continue to benefit from robust dividend yields and strong investor sentiment, though she remains watchful on asset quality.

In particular, UOB will likely continue to be weighed by its higher quarter-on-quarter operating expenses, as well as its exposure to commercial real estate loans, Lim said.

DBS has a “buy” call on OCBC and “hold” on UOB.

Phillip’s Thum added that one-off gains from asset sales could possibly flatter UOB’s headline earnings.

Thum previously upgraded his call on the sector to “accumulate” from “neutral”, citing stronger-than-expected loan growth, bottoming rates and attractive dividends yields.

At market close on Monday (Aug 3), DBS gained 0.6 per cent or S\$0.43 at S\$74.45, OCBC fell 0.9 per cent or S\$0.26 to S\$28.87, and UOB lost 0.8 per cent or S\$0.36 at S\$43.04.

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Business

S'pore banks using AI agents to vet private banking clients, speed up onboarding

Chor Khieng Yuit

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SINGAPORE – Prospective private banking customers can now expect their account applications to be processed faster, as Singapore banks put agentic artificial intelligence to work behind the scenes.

Beyond customer-facing chatbots, banks are now deploying the technology for back-office tasks such as compliance and know-your-customer due diligence – automating and speeding up customer onboarding without compromising on regulatory requirements.

OCBC announced on July 29 that with its new HELIOS agentic AI platform, private banking accounts can be opened in 15 business days, compared with more than 30 previously, while maintaining stringent risk management and compliance standards.

The 15-day figure is a median across all clients, meaning half of OCBC's new private banking accounts are opened within that time or less. The remaining, more complex applications take longer.

Loretta Yuen, head of group legal and compliance at OCBC, said that depending on the client's risk profile, straightforward cases can even potentially be onboarded within a day.

This timeline reduction aligns with industry efforts to speed up customer acquisition.

The Monetary Authority of Singapore is working with the Private Banking Industry Group to reduce private banking account opening times to within one month by the end of 2026, down from the current industry median of around six weeks or even longer for complex cases.

HELIOS, or Holistic wEalth Lifecycle Insights & Ongoing Surveillances, is a digital co-worker for OCBC's relationship managers (RMs).

The multilingual "assistant" uses advanced data-gathering to research and run background checks on prospective customers in multiple languages, including Chinese.

It highlights potential information gaps so RMs can obtain the missing data when they meet the customer.

As a result, the back-and-forth between the customer, RM and compliance unit is significantly reduced.

Yuen said banks need to identify potential concerns early on and assess financial crime risks more holistically.

"By combining agentic AI with the expertise of our compliance professionals, HELIOS enables us to screen prospective customers more thoroughly and earlier in the customer journey," she said.

Koh Sinyee, director of compliance consultancy firm Integrity Consulting, described HELIOS as an "inventive step" of using AI to scour the internet for information to pre-qualify prospective clients.

By doing so, OCBC narrows its focus to prospects the bank is confident it wants to do business with and can successfully onboard.

Over the past five months, more than 100 relationship managers (RMs) at Bank of Singapore (BOS), OCBC's private banking arm – representing 25 per cent of its RMs – have begun using the platform across Singapore, Hong Kong and Dubai.

BOS chief executive Jason Moo said around 50 clients have since been onboarded via the platform.

All of BOS' RMs will have access to HELIOS by the end of the third quarter of 2026.

Following the **private banking** roll-out, OCBC plans to extend the agentic AI platform to its Premier Private Client segment by year-end. This tier serves affluent clients whose net worth sits between the mass-affluent Premier Banking tier and the high-net-worth tier served by Bank of Singapore.

Jan Ondrus, professor of information systems at ESSEC Business School, said **private banks** globally are competing for the same wealthy clients in Asia.

He added that other financial institutions are exploring agentic AI for onboarding as well, so the technology might not be a point of market differentiation for long.

Echoing this trend, a DBS spokesperson said the bank has also turned to AI, cutting overall onboarding time by half in the first five months of 2026.

The shortened timeline means DBS has been able to onboard 20 per cent more new high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth customers over the same period.

The spokesperson added that the bank can complete the onboarding process and open accounts within a week for some new client profiles.

Similarly, Alex Sim, chief operating officer at UOB **Private Bank**, said UOB can open accounts within seven calendar days for clients with straightforward profiles.

He noted that as at end-June, UOB's "median turnaround time was well within industry guidelines" of around six weeks.

Amid the optimism over AI, Ondrus cautioned that the technology can confuse individuals with similar names or draw incorrect conclusions from fragmented data.

He added that while agentic AI is excellent at finding what is in the public domain, the wealthiest clients are often the least visible online.

The real test, therefore, is whether the system treats an absence of information as a red flag that demands greater human scrutiny, or gives a false sense of security that all is well, said Ondrus.

Indeed, the human-in-the-loop is a vital piece of the puzzle. UOB's Sim noted that "human accountability remains central to the bank's approach".

OCBC's Yuen said there is always a human involved throughout the bank's due diligence process, with ultimate accountability for all reviews, judgments and decisions resting firmly on the RMs and internal review teams.

What Ondrus found "genuinely novel" is that OCBC has turned compliance into a source of business leads.

He said: "The due diligence work becomes a source of new clients, so compliance shifts from being a (traditional) cost centre to a (direct) value generator."

HELIOS is able to do that because it has relationship-mapping capabilities that can lay out a potential client's relationships and connections. This enables the compliance team to identify high-quality leads and surface them to RMs.

Yuen said: "This is a paradigm shift for compliance, where we are not just enabling business, but also originating opportunities."

BOS' Moo said: "It is very rare for compliance partners to provide good-quality leads that bankers can prospect with confidence."

HELIOS, thus, becomes a "compelling differentiator" in growing the business, he added.

OCBC also plans to extend HELIOS to support the ongoing monitoring of customer activity by the first half of 2027.

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COMPANIES & MARKETS

OCBC to cut wealth onboarding to 15 business days with agentic AI; simple cases in 1 day

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OCBC is looking to cut onboarding time across all its wealth clients to 15 business days using agentic artificial intelligence.

Depending on the client profile, straightforward cases could also potentially be onboarded within a day, the bank announced on Wednesday (Jul 29).

Loretta Yuen, OCBC's head of group legal and compliance, said: "This is a paradigm shift for compliance, where we are not just enabling business, but originating opportunities."

This follows announcements by the Monetary Authority of Singapore to reduce account opening timelines in the **private banking** industry to within a month by the end of 2026.

OCBC noted that it has been working to cut onboarding time, with its current average more than 30 days, compared with the current industry median of around six weeks.

Among the other local banks, DBS can complete the onboarding process and open accounts within a week, depending on the new client's profile, a spokesperson said.

The spokesperson noted that AI implementation at the bank has led to 20 per cent more new high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth clients in the first five months of this year. Overall onboarding turnaround time also fell by half.

Meanwhile, UOB can open simple cases in seven calendar days, having reduced the median account opening turnaround time for **private banking** clients over the past six months, said its chief operating officer Alex Sim.

He said the bank's median turnaround time was "well within industry guidelines" as at end-June.

OCBC's platform, called Helios, comprises five separate agents. It will move the due-diligence process to before the relationship manager meets a prospective customer.

It will provide relationship managers with individuals' key data, information and credit-risk profiles upfront, while highlighting information gaps.

This enables relationship managers to quickly obtain the missing data from customers, and reduces the back-and-forth between the customer, relationship manager and the bank's compliant unit.

The time freed up for the compliance unit will also allow for a pivot to advisory research or perform more AI-related analyses.

The current industry practice is for know-your-customer screenings and risk assessments to be conducted only after the relationship manager submits source of wealth information.

Jason Moo, chief executive at OCBC's **private banking** arm Bank of Singapore (BOS), said: "The beauty of the system was it was built by (the bank's) compliance (unit).

"It wasn't built by the tech person or from the business side, (the compliance team) can build their standards already into the system," he added.

BOS has tested the platform on a quarter of its relationship managers over the past five months.

The platform is set to be rolled out across BOS by the third quarter of 2026. OCBC also plans to extend Helios to its premier private clients by the end of 2026.

Four of the five agents are already in play.

The first agent conducts prospect research, which supports pre-onboarding due diligence. The second is in charge of onboarding recommendation, which highlights remaining profile gaps.

The next one is a leads generator, which identifies associates of current prospects and helps relationship managers identify higher-quality leads.

The fourth is an independent agent that checks the other agents for accuracy.

OCBC noted that most information will be verified and checked by this agent, and whatever remains will be checked by a human.

The fifth agent that looks at ongoing monitoring of existing clients is set to be ready by the first half of 2027.

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Investment Banking

Standard Chartered investment bank profit dented by Middle East war; The bank has increased credit impairments in its corporate and investment bank, which weighed on profit despite an increase in dealmaking fees

By Paul Clarke

368 words

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Bill Winters, chief executive of Standard Chartered, saw revenue rise but costs increase PHOTO: Anthony Kwan/Bloomberg/Getty Images

The war in the Middle East weighed on profit in Standard Chartered's corporate and investment bank despite an uptick in dealmaking revenue during the second quarter.

The UK lender put aside \$150m in credit impairments in the unit during the first six months of 2026, which weighed on profit in the unit. Pre-tax profit of \$1.5bn within its corporate and investment banking division for the second quarter was down 7% on the prior year.

Despite this, Standard Chartered beat analyst expectations for its global banking business, with revenue of \$651m up by 19% compared with the second quarter of 2025.

The UK lender has been [hiring dealmakers for its M&A](#) team as it looks to gain a bigger share of the market. Standard Chartered has typically focused on Asia and the Middle East, but has made some big name hires within its UK team.

Capital markets and advisory revenue of \$105m was up by 46% compared with a year earlier. Wall Street investment banks have enjoyed sharp gains in dealmaking fees this year, fuelled by mega-deals in the US and some big IPOs after years of slow listings activity.

Standard Chartered also brought in \$1.1bn in global markets revenue, which was down by 5% compared with a year earlier.

This contrasts with both US players and the European banks that have reported second quarter numbers so far. Equity trading revenue from volatile markets has bolstered overall profit this year, with some Wall Street lenders unveiling record numbers.

Overall pretax profit for Standard Chartered of \$2.3bn for the three months to the end of June exceeded analyst expectations.

Rajesh Singhi, who leads Standard Chartered's M&A business, told Financial News in June that it was "doubling down" on the business following a series of senior hires this year.

Write to Paul Clarke at paul.clarke@dowjones.com

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OCBC harnesses agentic AI for faster onboarding of wealthy customers

Distributed by Contify.com

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Key Highlights:

- * Onboarding timeline meets MAS's one-month target by end-2026.
- * HELIOS extends to OCBC Premier Private Client segment by year-end.
- * AI-driven platform enhances risk assessment and opportunity origination.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, July 29 -- OCBC Bank issued the following news release:

- Using agentic AI, **private banking** accounts can be opened in 15 business days, lower than the industry median duration of about six weeks.
- A majority of customer due diligence is completed even before the relationship manager (RM) engages a prospective customer. High-quality leads will also be generated.
- The shortened onboarding timeline is achieved while maintaining stringent risk management and compliance standards.

OCBC is harnessing agentic AI to transform its customer due diligence process as part of its **wealth management** ambitions under its Next Frontier strategy. With the use of its agentic AI platform HELIOS (Holistic wEalth Lifecycle Insights & Ongoing Surveillance), the bank is accelerating the onboarding of wealthy customers while maintaining stringent risk management and compliance standards.

HELIOS' extensive intelligence-gathering and sophisticated relationship-network mapping capabilities enhances the accuracy and completeness of customer information needed for onboarding. By front-loading and automating this collection, verification, and assessment of key data, a significant portion of the Know-Your-Customer (KYC) due diligence process is completed before the relationship manager (RM) engages with a prospective customer. This streamlines and speeds up onboarding without compromising regulatory requirements.

In a first for a bank in Southeast Asia, high-quality leads will also be identified and surfaced to RMs by the Compliance function. This serves as an additional lead generation channel for RMs.

RMs in Bank of Singapore, OCBC's **private banking** arm, have begun leveraging HELIOS across Singapore, Hong Kong and Dubai, with the roll-out to be completed by the 3rd quarter of 2026. Account opening can now be completed in 15 business days – half the time needed compared to the current industry median of about six weeks – barring delays in the submission of customer documents.

The roll-out is timely as the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS) recently announced that it is working with the **Private Banking** Industry Group to reduce the account opening timeline to within one month by end-2026.

HELIOS will be extended to the OCBC Premier Private Client customer segment in the consumer banking business by the end of the year.

A paradigm shift for compliance

Moving the due diligence process before the start of the customer journey transforms current industry practice where Know Your Customer (KYC) screening and risk assessments are typically conducted only after an RM submits a prospective customer's Source of Wealth information.

In contrast, HELIOS provides RMs with individuals' key data and information, and credit risk profile upfront. Information gaps will also be highlighted, enabling RMs to quickly obtain the missing information and data from the customer. This significantly reduces the back-and-forth between the customer, RM and the Bank's Compliance unit.

RMs and the internal review teams maintain ultimate accountability on review, judgment and decision making.

Beyond onboarding, HELIOS will be extended to support the ongoing monitoring of customer activity. This will enable the bank to proactively identify changes in customers' risk profiles, strengthen risk surveillance, and support more timely risk management and compliance reviews.

Ms Loretta Yuen, OCBC's Head of Group Legal and Compliance, said, "We need to identify potential concerns earlier and assess financial crime risks more holistically. By combining agentic AI with the expertise of our compliance professionals, HELIOS enables us to screen prospective customers more thoroughly and earlier in the customer journey, while uncovering connections that may not be obvious. This is a paradigm shift for compliance where we are not just enabling business, but originating opportunities. It is about using agentic AI to enhance the speed and diligence of intelligence gathering to ensure our risk assessment is full and complete. While we are targeting a median turnaround of 15 business days across all clients, straightforward cases – depending on the client profile – could potentially be onboarded within a day."

Mr Jason Moo, CEO of Bank of Singapore, said, "HELIOS is a powerful example of how we can leverage agentic AI to combine risk intelligence with business growth. In the industry, it is very rare for compliance partners to provide good quality leads that bankers can prospect with confidence. This will be a compelling differentiator in not only growing the business, but also attracting bankers to join us."

Mr Justin Ho, a Bank of Singapore Market Head who is already using HELIOS said, "Even before we have onboarded the customer, HELIOS is able to provide an in-depth report on a prospective customer's Source of Wealth. This ensures that the compliance and front office teams are on the same page, significantly reducing the need for us to go back-and-forth with customers to clarify documentation details. What I appreciate about this platform is that it also provides an additional avenue for high-quality leads."

AI, Digital and Data-driven growth

The rollout of HELIOS is a result of OCBC's investment in AI, digital and data (ADD), which is at the core of its corporate strategy – the OCBC Next Frontier. In terms of technology spend, OCBC expects to spend more than one billion dollars every year for the next three years.

In July 2026, OCBC deployed the first AI-native bank mobile app in the region incorporating two avatars to offer hyper-personalised **wealth management** services on a real-time basis, 24/7. Over time, OCBC WoW will leverage its AI-native environment to extend its range of products and services to meet customers' increasingly sophisticated needs and build deeper and stickier relationships.

Earlier this year, OCBC's consumer banking unit rolled out a Gen AI-powered skills training programme for its wealth advisor force in Singapore. The six-month programme coaches wealth advisors on a full range of competencies including investment advisory, customer management, product mastery and wealth planning. By incorporating Gen AI, the programme helps minimise bias and emotional influence often associated with traditional, supervisor-led coaching, enabling more objective and consistent development outcomes.

Within the first three months of training, wealth advisors demonstrated a high level of customer engagement, securing double the number of weekly customer appointments compared to peers who had not yet completed the programme. There was also a 50 per cent uplift in revenue compared with the previous three months.

Last year, Bank of Singapore, rolled out an agentic AI-powered source of wealth (SOW) tool. Embedded directly into KYC workflows, the AI 'agent' independently initiates and coordinates tasks such as extracting, structuring and synthesising information across customer records and supporting documents, identifying data gaps and prompting targeted follow-ups when needed for assessment completion.

This tool helped RMs reduce average preparation time for SOW reports from 10 days to just one hour, accelerating customer onboarding and periodic reviews. The RMs can then channel the gain in productivity into deepening customer relationships and delivering superior experiences.

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, New Offerings, Technology, Artificial Intelligence]

Source: OCBC Bank

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Business

Sun Life targets Asia's booming wealth transfer market

Enoch Yiu

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29 July 2026

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Canadian insurer Sun Life has launched a new platform targeting Asia's fastest-growing wealth management markets, as high-net-worth individuals in the region increasingly seek to use insurance products to protect their wealth and pass it on to the next generation.

Sun Life Private Wealth was launched yesterday with about 400 staff spread across Hong Kong, Singapore, Bermuda, Dubai, Canada, Ireland and the United States. It will serve high-net-worth customers with at least US\$1 million of investible assets and ultra-high-net-worth individuals with at least US\$30 million, according to the company.

Rival insurers including Manulife, HSBC Life and AXA have been exploring similar services recently.

Clement Lam, CEO of Sun Life Hong Kong, said Sun Life had provided insurance products to high-net-worth customers for decades across different markets, but the new platform would connect Sun Life teams across the seven markets to work together and serve these customers, who often had business and family members around the world.

"High-net-worth clients have become very global in nature, as they may live in Dubai, invest in Hong Kong, have business in mainland China, while their children are studying in the US or the UK," Sujoy Ghosh, CEO of Sun Life Private Wealth, said yesterday. "We need to have an integrated platform to provide a solution for them globally."

Ghosh said the platform would offer personal services to meet the needs of wealthy customers at different life stages, as some entrepreneurs would focus on growing their businesses, while others would need solutions to pass on wealth to the next generation.

Insurance policies, which allow the company to pay beneficiaries named by the policyholders, were an effective tool for ensuring smooth wealth distribution and avoiding disputes among family members, according to several industry players.

Platforms for global high-net-worth individuals' wealth saw their assets increase by 8.7 per cent to US\$98.3 trillion last year, with Asia-Pacific recording the highest regional growth at 10.5 per cent, according to Capgemini's World Wealth Report 2026.

AXA introduced AXA Global Private in June, a platform targeting high-net-worth clients who have HK\$10 million to HK\$50 million worth of insurance policies or investment products with the insurer.

Hong Kong is currently the world's largest offshore wealth management centre.

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Standard Chartered appoints Kavita Kulkarni as Chief Technology & Operations Officer for India and South Asia

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Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Kavita brings 25+ years of banking, **wealth management**, and tech leadership experience.
- * She will drive tech & ops strategy, support strategic priorities in the region.
- * Previously served as MD & CIO for Private Banking & **Wealth Management** at Barclays.

Original Press Release:

India, July 27 -- Standard Chartered PLC issued the following news release:

Standard Chartered today announced that Kavita Kulkarni has joined the Bank as the Chief Technology & Operations Officer (CTOO) for India and South Asia.

At Standard Chartered, Kavita will be a member of the India Country Management Team and will be based in Mumbai. She will drive the execution of the Technology & Operations Strategy while supporting strategic priorities in the India and South Asia.

Kavita brings with her over 25 years of leadership experience in banking, **wealth management**, and technology, having held senior positions at various multinational financial institutions in India, UK and the USA.

Prior to joining Standard Chartered, Kavita served as Managing Director and Chief Information Officer for Private Banking and **Wealth Management** at Barclays Bank. In this role, she led global technology and operations teams, championing the adoption of artificial intelligence across delivery cycles.

She holds a Bachelor of Engineering (Computer Science) degree from Karnataka University (India), and an MBA (Finance) from New York University, Stern School of Business (USA).

Speaking about the appointment, PD Singh, CEO, India and South Asia, Standard Chartered said, "We are delighted to welcome Kavita to Standard Chartered. As we continue to invest in innovation and strengthen our capabilities, Kavita's deep expertise combined with her extensive global leadership experience will help us deliver simpler, faster and more resilient banking experiences for our clients, while supporting our long-term growth ambitions in the region."

Standard Chartered

Standard Chartered Bank has been operating in India with a continuous presence of over 165 years making it one of the oldest foreign banks in the country offering a full range of services across business segments including Corporate and Investment Banking and Wealth and Retail Banking. The Bank has an extensive branch network covering major cities. For more information, visit <https://www.sc.bank.in/>

Globally, we are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 54 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

[Category: Investment Banking, Management Changes, Technology, Innovation]

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Source: Standard Chartered PLC

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Companies

UOB targets five times growth in Hong Kong private bank AUM by 2030

Renald Yeo

546 words

25 July 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A13

English

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UOB is targeting a five times increase in the assets under management (AUM) and revenue of its Hong Kong private banking business by 2030, while trebling its client adviser headcount to about 60.

UOB sees the expansion as part of a broader strategy to position Hong Kong as a bridge between the Chinese mainland and Asean, rather than as a standalone market.

The Singapore lender currently has 20 private banking client advisers in the city. It plans to invest further in talent, advisory capabilities and technology as it seeks to capture growing cross-border wealth flows between China and Asean.

UOB does not typically disclose AUM or wealth revenue figures for individual markets.

At the group level, UOB Private Bank's AUM has grown at a compound annual rate of more than 12 per cent since 2022. The Hong Kong business has expanded at a broadly similar pace, the bank said on Thursday (Jul 23).

UOB sees the expansion as part of a broader strategy to position Hong Kong as a bridge between the Chinese mainland and Asean, rather than as a standalone market.

The bank expects the city to play a growing role in connecting trade, investment and wealth flows across the region.

It cited estimates that Asia's private wealth pool could reach US\$99 trillion by 2029, while wealth flows from China, including Hong Kong, into Asean could approach US\$100 billion by then, expanding by about 9 per cent a year.

UOB added that more than 70 per cent of its clients are business owners, driving demand for services ranging from investments and financing to succession planning and cross-border wealth structuring.

George Tung, who took over as CEO of UOB Hong Kong on Jul 1, said companies were moving beyond the traditional "China+1" model of diversifying their supply chains towards what the bank calls a "Growth+1" strategy.

"As clients expand across Asean, their priorities are evolving beyond manufacturing and supply chain diversification to encompass treasury optimisation, financing, risk management, wealth creation and succession planning," he said.

"This is creating a powerful growth corridor connecting (the) Chinese mainland, Hong Kong and Asean, where trade, investment and wealth flows are increasingly intertwined."

Since establishing its foreign direct investment advisory unit in 2011, UOB has supported about 5,000 companies expanding into Asean.

It has helped 2,400 Chinese enterprises venture overseas – more than 90 per cent of which chose South-east Asia – and facilitated over HK\$190 billion (US\$24.2 billion) of direct investment into the region since 2020.

UOB's expansion comes as Singapore banks step up their wealth ambitions in Hong Kong.

OCBC said in May that it planned to hire 30 to 50 wealth management relationship managers in the city in 2026, lifting its headcount by at least 30 per cent.

Wealth management income at OCBC Hong Kong rose 1.5 times year on year in the first quarter, driven by a larger customer base and higher investment and insurance income.

The franchise is targeting double-digit revenue growth in 2026, and aims to become one of Hong Kong's 10 largest banks by 2030.

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Document STBT000020260725em7p0000j

HSBC sells Singapore insurance arm to Allianz in £1.6bn deal

Maisie Grice

504 words

24 July 2026

14:35

City AM Online

CITONL

English

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FTSE 100 HSBC has agreed to sell its health and life insurance business to German insurance giant Allianz for \$2.1bn (£1.6bn) as it refocuses its strategy on Singapore's wealth management. The banking giant agreed to sell its Singapore business to Allianz in a transaction that is expected to be completed in the first half of [...]

FTSE 100 HSBC has agreed to sell its health and life insurance business to German insurance giant Allianz for \$2.1bn (£1.6bn) as it refocuses its strategy on Singapore's wealth management.

The banking giant agreed to sell its Singapore business to Allianz in a transaction that is expected to be completed in the first half of 2027, subject to regulatory approval.

HSBC and the German insurance group will enter a 15-year partnership upon the deal's completion, which will see the London-listed bank continue to sell insurance to its retail banking and wealth clients in Singapore, but it will be owned and underwritten by Allianz.

The deal is expected to generate a pre-tax gain of £1.4bn for HSBC, while the bank will also receive an additional £150.1m upfront payment.

The sale follows HSBC's strategic review, which determined this deal would be the "best outcome" as part of the bank's ongoing "simplification" of its group business.

HSBC focus on trimming its business

Chief executive Georges Elhedery, who took charge of the bank in 2024, has moved swiftly to overhaul its operations upon launching a major restructuring plan in October 2024.

The bank had aimed to achieve £1.1bn in annual cost reductions by the end of 2026, but accomplished this ahead of schedule in June.

Elhedery has said a large amount of savings have come from slashing its headcount, resulting in a 15 per cent reduction in managing director positions.

The banking group's UK and Hong Kong businesses were turned into standalone units.

He also redrew the bank's operations between the east and west regions at a time when falling interest rates were choking profit.

The deal with Allianz also comes after Elhedery rejected claims he plans to spin off the bank's Asia business at a summit at the end of last year, arguing a banking presence in the region was "something our customers need".

The firm said the shedding of its insurance business would allow it to focus on "areas where it has a clear competitive advantage", while reaffirming its commitment to Singapore, calling it "crucial" to future growth.

Second chance for Allianz

The deal grants Allianz a second chance to tap into the Singapore market after it was forced to withdraw from a high-profile \$2.2bn (£1.7bn) bid to buy Income Insurance in 2024 after the Singapore parliament raised concerns over the deal and amended the Insurance Act to prevent it from going forward.

Allianz expects this deal with HSBC to generate a double-digit return in the medium term.

Document CITONL0020260724em7o000jh

DBS Hong Kong survey finds affluent investors reset return expectations, broaden portfolios and embrace AI for long-term growth

Distributed by Contify.com

1,037 words

22 July 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Long-term wealth growth becomes top priority for 66% of investors.
- * Portfolio diversification increases, with stocks (41%), alternatives (18%), and ETFs gaining.
- * Hong Kong remains attractive for Chinese Mainland investors, with 63% holding accounts there.

Original Press Release:

Hong Kong, July 22 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

- Investors recalibrate expected returns to 8% and diversify across asset classes and global markets, while AI becomes a mainstream research tool alongside professional advice

DBS Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("DBS Hong Kong") today released the "DBS Treasures Affluent Investor Survey 2026", revealing affluent investors are recalibrating return expectations while continuing to pursue long-term wealth growth through broader portfolio diversification, international market exposure and growing use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in investment research and decision-making.

Affluent investors in Hong Kong and Chinese Mainland remain cautious about market prospects, but optimistic about long-term wealth creation opportunities despite an uncertain economic environment. Expected annual returns among Hong Kong investors eased to 7.9% from 8.4% in 2025, while expectations among Chinese Mainland fell to 8.1% from 10.1%. At the same time, long-term wealth growth has become a more important objective for investors, with 66% of them naming it as their most important wealth goal, up from 57% a year ago.

As they navigate an evolving market environment, affluent investors in Hong Kong and Chinese Mainland are increasingly broadening their portfolios. Stocks remained the largest portfolio holding in 2026, rising 1.8 percentage points year-on-year to 41%, while alternative investments recorded the strongest growth, increasing 10.3 percentage points to become the second-largest asset class at 18% of portfolios. Allocations to exchange-traded funds (ETFs) also increased, while exposure to investment and mutual funds declined, reflecting investors' growing preference for a broader mix of asset classes.

The growing emphasis on portfolio diversification is reflected in the broader range of investment products held by affluent investors. On average, investors hold 4.5 product types, with Chinese Mainland investors recording a notable increase from 3.9 to 4.5 product types. Investment preferences also vary across markets, with Chinese Mainland showing a stronger preference for insurance products, while Hong Kong investors continue to favour stocks. Across both markets, stocks, insurance, gold, foreign currency and investment funds remain the five most widely held investment products.

Amy Kwan, Head of Business Planning, Customer Segment and Ecosystem, Consumer Banking Group & **Wealth Management**, DBS Hong Kong said, "The survey shows that affluent investors remain invested and opportunity seeking despite ongoing market volatility. While they continue to pursue wealth growth, they are increasingly balancing this with greater diversification and risk management. We are also seeing AI become an important tool to support investment research and decision-making, while investors continue to value professional advice from relationship manager for more complex wealth planning needs."

While both Hong Kong and Chinese Mainland investors increased allocations to alternative assets, their investment preferences diverged. Hong Kong showed a stronger shift towards stocks, while Chinese Mainland investors were more inclined to increase ETF holdings. Looking ahead, Chinese Mainland investors are most likely to expand exposure to gold and virtual assets, whereas Hong Kong investors continue to favour, stocks and commodities.

AI and technological innovation, yield-generating assets, and healthcare emerged as attractive investment themes among affluent investors. Investors are increasingly turning to AI tools to better understand investment products, monitor market developments and compare risks and potential returns. Despite this growing adoption, investors value the human touch and professional advice from relationship managers, particularly for major investment decisions, retirement and long-term **wealth management**, and cross-border wealth needs.

The survey also highlights Hong Kong's continued competitiveness as an international **wealth management** centre. 63% of affluent Chinese Mainland already hold an account in Hong Kong. Hong Kong's diverse investment product offerings, strong financial system, quality **wealth management** advice and cross-border banking connectivity remain key attractions for investors, underlining the growing importance of international connectivity. Nearly three in four investors have exposure to overseas markets, with Hong Kong serving as the leading offshore investment destination for Chinese Mainland investors.

The DBS Treasures Affluent Investor Survey 2026, conducted between June and July 2026, surveyed 1,617 affluent individuals across Hong Kong and Chinese Mainland, with a minimum of HKD/RMB 1 million in assets in their respective markets.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best AI Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the winner of multiple digital assets awards. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025.

DBS provides a full range of services in consumer, wealth, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by uplifting lives and livelihoods of those in need. It provides essential needs to the underprivileged, and fosters inclusion by equipping the underserved with financial and digital literacy skills. It also nurtures innovative social enterprises that create positive impact.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Professional Services]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

Document ATINBK0020260722em7m000jr

Business

SC Bank Korea opens second Priority Private Center in Dogok

362 words

22 July 2026

The Korea Herald

KORHER

English

(c) 2026 The Korea Herald

Standard Chartered Bank Korea said Wednesday it has opened its second Priority Private Center in Dogok-dong, southern Seoul, as part of efforts to strengthen its **wealth management** business for high-net-worth clients.

The Dogok Priority Private Center, which serves clients with deposits of at least 1 billion won, follows the opening of the lender's first such center in Apgujeong in November last year. The bank said the center is based on Standard Chartered's global private banking model and is designed to expand its presence in affluent areas.

The new center has six relationship managers, each with more than 10 years of **wealth management** experience on average, supported by investment and foreign exchange specialists.

They will offer tailored portfolio consulting based on Standard Chartered's Global House View, as well as inheritance and succession planning and global lifestyle services.

The center also includes six private consultation rooms, a lounge for private seminars and safe deposit box facilities. It will provide food and beverage services through a professional barista and display works by various artists.

"I am pleased to open our second Priority Private Center in Dogok, an area with a high concentration of affluent individuals in Korea," said Joseph Cho, head of wealth and retail banking at SC Bank Korea. "We will provide differentiated wealth experiences as a trusted partner for our affluent clients based on our leading global investment strategy."

SC Bank Korea also plans to open **wealth management** centers in Jongno in October and Yeouido in November.

[From left: Im Mi-suk, manager of the Dogok Priority Private Center; Lay Choo Ong, Standard Chartered's global head of segments, sales and client propositions; Raymond Ang, global head of private bank and affluent clients and head of wealth and retail banking for Greater China and North Asia; Lee Kwang-hee, CEO of SC Bank Korea; Cho Hyung-ki, head of wealth and retail banking at SC Bank Korea; and Cho Sung-min, head of Priority Private sales at SC Bank Korea, cut a cake at the center's opening ceremony in Seoul on Wednesday. \(SC Bank Korea\)](#)

Document KORHER0020260722em7m003pd

BANKING & FINANCE

UOB taps banking veteran Judy Chan to lead HK private wealth push

Shikhar Gupta

276 words

21 July 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A13

English

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UOB is bolstering its **private banking** ranks in Hong Kong with the appointment of industry veteran Judy Chan as managing director, as the Singaporean lender moves to capture a larger slice of Asia's booming wealth market.

Chan, whose appointment takes effect in July, will oversee client coverage and the delivery of bespoke wealth solutions for high-net-worth (HNW) individuals in the city, the bank announced in a statement.

She will be based in Hong Kong and report directly to Chew Mun Yew, head of group **private bank**.

With a career spanning nearly three decades across both private and commercial banking, Chan brings experience in wealth planning and intergenerational succession.

Her mandate includes driving client engagement, managing large advisory teams and steering the bank's strategic priorities in the territory.

Chan was previously the market head for **private banking** at the Bank of China (Hong Kong) for four years. Before that stint, she spent 17 years at HSBC – two of which were as the director of **private banking**.

The senior hire comes against the backdrop of a competitive wealth management landscape in Asia.

Global and regional lenders are increasingly vying for top-tier talent to cater to the region's swelling ranks of millionaires and the impending massive intergenerational wealth transfer.

UOB stated that Chan's appointment reflects its broader ambition to accelerate growth.

It added that it will continue to invest in senior talent and capabilities in Hong Kong to fortify its footprint in one of the world's most critical wealth creation hubs.

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Standard Chartered Pakistan recognised by Euromoney as Pakistan's Best Mortgage Bank

349 words

18 July 2026

The Nation

AIWNAT

English

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Standard Chartered Pakistan has been recognised by Euromoney as Pakistan's Best Mortgage Bank, reflecting the strength of its mortgage proposition and commitment to delivering a seamless, client-focused home financing experience.

This recognition reinforces Standard Chartered's broader Wealth proposition, which is centred on helping clients build, manage and protect wealth throughout their financial journey. Home ownership remains one of the most important pillars of long-term financial security, and the bank continues to combine tailored mortgage solutions with holistic financial planning and advisory services for its clients.

This accolade comes at a time when expanding access to housing remains an important national priority. As Pakistan advances initiatives aimed at increasing home ownership, including the Government of Pakistan's Wazir-e-Azam Apna Ghar Programme - Ghar Ho Tu Apna, access to financing will play a critical role in expanding home ownership, supporting economic development and building long-term financial resilience.

Standard Chartered's mortgage proposition is designed to help clients navigate the home ownership journey with confidence, offering competitive financing solutions, digital convenience and end-to-end support. Through its Future Focused Move platform, the Bank continues to support both local clients and overseas Pakistanis in achieving their housing aspirations. Commenting on the recognition, Saadya Riaz, Head of Wealth and Retail Banking, Standard Chartered Pakistan, said: 'As Pakistan continues to prioritise greater access to housing, we remain committed to helping individuals and families realise their home ownership aspirations while building lasting financial well-being.'

'We are honoured to be recognised by Euromoney as Pakistan's Best Mortgage Bank. At Standard Chartered, we view home ownership as more than a financial milestone; it is one of the most important foundations of long-term wealth creation. This award reflects the trust our clients place in us and the dedication of our teams to delivering exceptional service and trusted advice.'

With a presence in Pakistan spanning more than 160 years, Standard Chartered continues to connect clients to opportunities through its international network, deep local expertise and differentiated banking solutions.

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Standard Chartered Pakistan recognised by Euromoney as Pakistan's Best Mortgage Bank

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18 July 2026

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With a presence in Pakistan spanning more than 160 years, Standard Chartered continues to connect clients to opportunities through its international network, deep local expertise and differentiated banking solutions.

Document AIWNAT0020260718em7i00036

Business

DBS eyes \$1 trillion in wealth assets by 2030, banks on AI and hiring 600 more staff

Sheila Chiang

667 words

15 July 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

online

English

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SINGAPORE – DBS Bank expects to grow its assets under management (AUM) to more than \$1 trillion by 2030 by hiring more staff and tapping artificial intelligence to expand its wealth business.

The AUM growth will be driven by mass-market and emerging affluent customers, also known as the retail segment, as well as the bank's wealth segment, which spans affluent, high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth clients.

DBS' wealth AUM reached \$492 billion in the first quarter of 2026, putting it on track to surpass its 2027 target of \$500 billion more than a year ahead of schedule.

Shee Tse Koon, DBS group head of consumer banking and wealth management, said on July 14 at the bank's office at Marina Bay Financial Centre: "We have been seeing very good traction, with clients parking more and more of their wealth with us and putting their money to work."

South-east Asia's largest bank by assets also plans to hire an additional 600 front-line advisers – including relationship managers and investment counsellors – and platform engineers across its six key markets by 2028 to support its wealth push. These markets are Singapore, Hong Kong, mainland China, India, Indonesia and Taiwan.

The development comes as DBS announced in June that it will open 18 new wealth centres and upgrade 36 existing wealth centres in what it called the largest physical wealth expansion of an Asian bank.

Banks such as DBS are aggressively pushing into wealth management as falling interest rates shrink net interest margins – the difference between the interest they earn on loans and the interest they pay on deposits.

To support its wealth push, DBS expects to deepen and broaden the integration and application of AI.

For example, starting in mid-August 2026, retail customers will be able to engage in generative AI-powered conversations via digiWealth – a wealth planning platform built into the DBS digibank app – to help them become savvier investors.

Regarding digiWealth, Shee said the bank will incorporate appropriate agentic AI technology with guardrails, with the aim of enhancing the digital experience of retail wealth customers.

The Singapore bank is also embedding AI across all customer journeys – from onboarding to advisory to servicing. It is also ramping up the capability and capacity of each employee, enabling them to do more for every customer.

Generative and agentic AI have uplifted customer and employee experience and continue to deliver positive outcomes, DBS added.

For example, the bank was able to onboard around 20 per cent more high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth clients from January to May 2026 compared with the same period a year ago, as AI adoption reduced the time needed for screening and profiling.

This enabled clients to deploy their funds much faster amid market volatility.

Sharper personalised advice and faster client access enabled by AI have also driven stronger investment engagement, with more clients diversifying their portfolios or taking up new investments beyond their original holdings.

In addition, DBS plans to ink more ecosystem partnerships, such as those with GraniteAsia, Hamilton Lane, JPMorgan and Franklin Templeton, to expand its customer reach and offer more bespoke solutions.

Shee said the bank wants to serve clients along the entire continuum of wealth, from their first \$100 to their first billion.

To capture the retail segment, it has assigned personal wealth planning managers to 3.8 million retail customers since 2023. These eligible customers, aged between 18 and 68, make up roughly eight in 10 of DBS' retail customers.

Reverse inquiries – where customers proactively reach out to their wealth planning managers – tripled in the first four months of 2026, compared with the same period a year earlier.

Earlier in July, local counterpart OCBC Bank rolled out AI avatars and said it will hire 600 additional relationship managers for its consumer banking business over the next three years.

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Document STIMES0020260715em7f0005l

Companies & Markets

DBS targets S\$1 trillion in AUM by 2030 as it steps up AI, hiring push

Tan Nai Lun

906 words

15 July 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

online

English

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[SINGAPORE] DBS is looking to accumulate more than S\$1 trillion in assets under management (AUM) across its retail and wealth segments by 2030, as it doubles down on artificial intelligence, partnerships and regional expansion to capture Asia's growing wealth.

To support its ambitions, South-east Asia's largest bank plans to hire 600 more front-line advisers and platform engineers by end-2028, said Shee Tse Koon, DBS group executive and group head of consumer banking and **wealth management**.

Shee previously targeted S\$500 billion in wealth AUM by end-2026, which excludes the retail segment. But by Q1, AUM already hit S\$492 billion, putting the bank on track to cross the target by the mid-year.

In Q1, some 58 per cent of wealth AUM was actively deployed in investment products.

With the wealth business already one of DBS' largest revenue contributors, Shee said the bank aims to "win in every segment" by serving clients across what it calls a "true wealth continuum", from the mass market to the ultra-high-net-worth.

"The way we look at the entire wealth business is not just about AUM growth, but also how we can help our customers actively deploy this AUM, diversify this AUM, and provide strategic advice to plan for the future," Shee said at a media roundtable on Tuesday (Jul 14).

AI investments reaping benefits

Shee noted that the bank's AI investments – both generative and agentic – have already started to reap benefits.

As at May 2026, DBS has added 20 per cent more new high net worth and ultra high net worth clients, after it reduced name screening time by 75 per cent and cut source-of-wealth profiling time by 20 per cent since last year.

Enhanced portfolio tools for advisers, wider do-it-yourself investments shelf, chatbots for mass market clients and a **wealth management** solution suite across the wealth continuum have also resulted in 30 per cent more customers across the board having diversified portfolios.

AI has also helped to automate manual tasks and improve corporate actions, allowing front-line advisers to have 10 per cent more face time with clients. Shee expects to double this improvement by 2027.

In particular, the digiWealth platform – targeted at mass market and emerging affluent customers – has led to a five times increase on-year in enquiries related to financial planning for wealth planning managers, as well as a 42 per cent rise in adoption of regular savings plans, as at February 2026.

"While we are very big on digital, we recognise that the wealth arena is one that will always still need human beings for certain cases," he said. "No two products are homogeneous, and no two customers are homogeneous, so there will be certain things that they will need human advice."

On hiring, Shee noted that the bank's consistent hiring of relationship managers over the years has fuelled its growth, but talent is "thin" not just in terms of front liners but also in technology, engineers and platform staff.

But even as DBS continues to hire, it is also training staff across functions to scale domain expertise and AI know-how.

"This is something we've done before in the past when we drove the digitalisation journey," he said. "We trained a lot of our people to be digital, then to be data-ready, now we're training them in AI."

New geographies

DBS is also seeking to access new geographies and customer pools.

One way to do so is to have more ecosystem partnerships, similar to the one it signed with Samsung Securities.

Earlier in July, DBS signed a memorandum of understanding with Samsung Securities that would allow the former to gain access to the South Korean market. Clients of Samsung Securities will also be able to tap into DBS' **wealth management** solutions.

Shee said there are "quite a number" of other similar partnerships that the bank is in discussions with, although he declined to name them.

These partnerships would help DBS accelerate access to markets where it does not have a natural franchise by leveraging partners with established customer bases, he noted.

At the same time, the bank wants to deepen its presence in its existing markets.

The bank has previously said that it would add 18 wealth centres in its core markets of Singapore, Hong Kong, China, Taiwan, Indonesia and India – areas "where wealth is being generated in Asia" said Shee.

Hiring will span these core markets as well as other key jurisdictions, such as Dubai and London.

Its hubs in Singapore and Hong Kong – where the bank has booking centres – will also help attract international wealth flows, especially as wealth is shifting into the region, he said.

Currently, DBS has clients from 120 different nationalities, with more from Asia.

Shee noted that the wealth business is already "one of the most cost efficient" in the industry, with a cost-income ratio of less than 50 per cent, and a return on equity (ROE) of 72 per cent. In Q1, the bank's overall cost-income ratio was 39 per cent, and ROE was 17 per cent.

"This really is a proof point that it is not just about the AUM growth, but a very broad-based growth," he said.

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OCBC Bank: Bank of Singapore refreshes Chief Investment Office Global Advisory Council and unveils 2026 Supertrends Report

Distributed by Contify.com

816 words

14 July 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Bank of Singapore refreshes CIO Global Advisory Council with new members from KKR and PIMCO.
- * Unveils Supertrends 2026 report focusing on five structural shifts impacting global investment landscape.
- * Strengthens capabilities to enhance value proposition for **private banking** clients and OCBC Group.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Hong Kong July 14 -- OCBC Bank issued the following news release:

At a glance

- * Bank of Singapore is committed to providing its clients with differentiated, world-class investment insights and thought leadership to navigate an increasingly uncertain and rapidly evolving global landscape.
- * The bank has refreshed its Chief Investment Office Global Advisory Council, welcoming two new members from KKR and PIMCO.
- * Its latest Supertrends report zooms in on a forward-looking framework exploring how capital, risk and opportunity are being reshaped by five structural shifts.

Bank of Singapore has refreshed its Chief Investment Office (CIO) Global Advisory Council ('Council') and unveiled its latest annual publication, Supertrends 2026: Cycles, Halos and Moonshots.

These initiatives underscore the Bank's commitment to providing its clients with differentiated, world-class investment insights and thought leadership. As investors face heightened market uncertainty, having such a holistic view of the upside and downside risks, as well as structural trends impacting the geopolitical and economic landscape is increasingly important. In this environment, timely, diverse and forward-looking perspectives can provide investors with a crucial edge in identifying attractive risk-adjusted opportunities.

As the **private banking** arm of OCBC Group, the continued strengthening of Bank of Singapore's capabilities not only enhances the value proposition delivered to **private banking** clients, but also reinforces its role as an investment sharp point and strategic anchor for investment leadership across the wider OCBC Group.

CIO Global Advisory Council

Established in 2024, the Bank of Singapore CIO Global Advisory Council brings together experts from leading think-tanks and asset managers around the world, designed to augment the Bank's advisory on the most critical issues of the time.

Refreshed annually, the Council comprises members with deep expertise across economics, public policy, geopolitics, asset allocation and investment management. Their insights are widely sought by governments, institutions and global media.

The convening of such a diverse group of renowned experts to benefit ultra-high net worth families and high net worth individuals is one of the first-of-its-kind by a **private bank** in Asia.

In 2026, the council welcomes two new members:

1. John Studzinski CBE, Vice Chairman and Managing Director, PIMCO
2. Lauren Goodwin, Managing Director and Chief Investment Strategist, KKR

They join the following returning members:

1. Dr. Adam Posen, President, Peterson Institute for International Economics
2. Fabiana Fedeli, Chief Investment Officer, Equities, Multi-Asset & Sustainability, M&G Investments
3. John Emerson, Former US Ambassador to Germany and Vice Chair, Capital Group International, Inc.
4. Dr. Kai Guo, President and Senior Fellow, CF40 Institute
5. Robin Hu, Chair Emeritus, Asia, Milken Institute and Advisory Senior Director, Temasek
6. Torsten Slok, Chief Economist and Partner, Apollo Global Management
7. Yuichi Murao, Global Head of Japanese Equity, Nomura Asset Management

Supertrends 2026: Cycles, Halos and Moonshots

The Council plays a central role in shaping Bank of Singapore's annual Supertrends report, a flagship publication first launched in 2024. Updated twice each year, the reports focus on structural trends shaping markets over a five-year horizon. The objective is to encourage investors to move beyond short-term market noise to take a broader view of the trends reshaping the global investment landscape and creating opportunities for long-term wealth creation.

Looking ahead to 2030, investors face an era shaped by geopolitical contests, weaponised chokepoints, economic shocks and climate stress – even as AI driven advancements propel individuals, businesses and governments forward. The third edition of the report – Supertrends 2026: Cycles, Halos and Moonshots – zooms in on a forward-looking framework exploring how capital, risk and opportunity are being reshaped by five structural shifts:

1. Navigating Chokepoints
2. A Whole Portfolio Approach
3. China's Renaissance
4. AI – Anything, Everywhere, All at Once
5. The Longevity Economy

CIO Summit series

Beyond the Supertrends report, the Council's perspectives are brought to life through active dialogue at Bank of Singapore's annual CIO Summit series. These events provide a platform for the Council members to move beyond theory and exchange insights.

Bank of Singapore will host its 2026 CIO Summit in Hong Kong on 14 July, and its Portfolio Summit in Singapore on 16-17 July 2026, bringing together Council members and industry leaders to explore the investment themes that will define the next decade and discuss how investors can navigate the key challenges and opportunities shaping global markets.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Investment Banking, Events and Conferences, Management Changes, Advanced Manufacturing, Economic Performance and Projections, Geopolitics and International Relations]

Source: OCBC Bank

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Lighthouse Canton hires Southeast Asia banker from DBS

Ching Shi Jie

281 words

13 July 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Lighthouse Canton has appointed a new managing director of **wealth management** in Singapore, recruiting the executive from DBS Bank.

In a 13 July release, the Singapore-based external asset manager announced that Angela Saik will focus on building new client relationships across Southeast Asia.

She will also tailor wealth advisory solutions shaped around individual circumstances, family priorities and intergenerational objectives.

Saik joined in November 2025, according to her LinkedIn profile. Prior to that, she was an executive director at DBS. With over 20 years of private wealth experience in Asia, she previously held senior roles at RBC **Wealth Management** and Pictet **Wealth Management**.

Her appointment comes as Lighthouse Canton, with over \$5bn in AUM, looks to strengthen its presence in Indonesia, Malaysia, the Philippines, Singapore, Thailand and Brunei. The firm said it plans to double its assets under management by 2027, according to the release.

In November, the firm [raised \\$40m](#) in a funding round led by Peak XV Partners, with participation from Nextinfinity and Qatar Insurance Company.

Saik's hire follows a string of senior appointments at Lighthouse Canton.

Saik will lead the Asia team alongside Charlene Lin, Stella Lau and Vijay Bhatia. Lin oversees strategic growth for North Asia and Southeast Asia, while Lau covers Greater China.

The firm also added four senior bankers to its offices in Dubai and India. Michael Darriba oversees key clients and institutions in Dubai, while Abhay Lajawala is appointed as CIO for India.

Meanwhile, Gurjeet Sohi has joined as head of **wealth management** for India, and Muffazal Arsiwalla has taken on the role of head of capital solutions and advisory for India.

Document CWIRAS0020260713em7d00003

Business

Singapore investors leverage AI for research but rely on human advisers to decide: HSBC study

Angela Tan

626 words

13 July 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

online

English

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SINGAPORE – Singapore's mass affluent and high-net-worth investors are using artificial intelligence for finance at a faster pace than their global peers, but continue to rely on human advisers to validate insights before making investment decisions, according to new research by HSBC.

A survey of more than 600 investors in Singapore, conducted by Ipsos for HSBC in January and February, found that 76 per cent use AI tools for their research compared with a 72 per cent global average.

Close to 70 per cent of the Singapore investors use AI to support research and analysis, while 44 per cent use it for strategy development and 34 per cent to stress-test ideas.

However, 79 per cent still turn to financial advisers for reassurance, while 71 per cent seek strategic expertise before committing to major decisions.

Only 8 per cent of respondents said AI was the single most influential factor in their most recent investment decision, below the global average of 12 per cent.

While 43 per cent reported that AI has increased their appetite for calculated risks, this remains more conservative than the global figure of 49 per cent.

The preference for a hybrid approach is evident. Some 57 per cent of Singapore investors favour combining AI with human advice, above the global average of 50 per cent.

Among Gen Z investors, 45 per cent prefer using AI to generate ideas before consulting advisers, compared with 38 per cent globally.

Unlike many markets where AI uptake skews younger, adoption in Singapore cuts across age groups.

Among Gen X investors born between between 1965 and 1980, 72 per cent reported using AI in finance versus 65 per cent globally. For baby boomers – those born between 1946 and 1964 – the gap is wider at 72 per cent in Singapore compared with 59 per cent worldwide.

This cross-generational engagement suggests that AI tools are becoming a mainstream component of investment workflows rather than a niche tool for younger, tech-savvy investors, the report said.

Among high-net-worth individuals with at least US\$2 million (S\$2.6 million) in investable assets, AI adoption in Singapore reaches 90 per cent, outpacing the global level of 82 per cent.

These investors attribute an average of 40 per cent of their portfolio returns over the past 12 months to AI influence, above the 31 per cent average across all Singapore respondents.

At the same time, 65 per cent say AI has increased their sense of control over investment outcomes, indicating growing confidence in the technology's role in portfolio management.

The findings come as HSBC Singapore steps up its deployment of "adviser-enabled AI".

Its Wealth Intelligence, launched in September 2025, aggregates insights from more than 10,000 sources to support relationship managers in client discussions. AI Prepare, introduced in May 2026, generates client engagement packs by consolidating portfolio data and financial information.

Separately, HSBC and Google Cloud announced a multi-year strategic AI partnership in June, aimed at developing more than 200 AI use cases across the bank's global operations within two years, including hyper-personalised wealth management.

Ashmita Acharya, head of international wealth and premier banking at HSBC Singapore, said the data shows Singapore's investors are using AI in their financial decision-making with discipline and setting a higher bar for advice.

"They are doing more of their own analysis, arriving at conversations better prepared, and expecting more of the professional advisers who help them as a result," she said.

HSBC's global survey covered 9,993 mass affluent and high-net-worth investors across 10 markets, with 609 respondents from Singapore.

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Standard Chartered completes seven gold transactions through Hong Kong's Gold Central Clearing and Settlement System

Distributed by Contify.com

558 words

7 July 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * First batch of transactions includes corporates Chow Sang Sang, Haitong International Securities, JD Technology, and Shanghai Pudong Development Bank.
- * Standard Chartered supports Hong Kong's development as a global gold hub and international gold trading hub.
- * Bank completes seven gold transactions and settlements through the new gold central clearing and settlement system.

Original Press Release:

Hong Kong, July 7 -- Standard Chartered PLC issued the following news release:

- Accelerating capabilities across the gold value chain in support of the city's development as a global gold hub

Standard Chartered welcomes the trial operation of Hong Kong's gold central clearing and settlement system ("the system") and is pleased to have successfully completed its first batch of seven gold transactions and settlements through the system. This marks a significant milestone in Hong Kong's development as an international gold trading hub, and underscores Standard Chartered's role in supporting the growth of the city's precious metals ecosystem.

As a Board member of Hong Kong Precious Metals Central Clearing Company Limited ("PMCC") and a participating bank of the trial operation, Bill Winters, Group Chief Executive, Standard Chartered, travelled to Hong Kong specifically to attend the trial operation ceremony for PMCC and Shanghai-Hong Kong Gold Market Cooperation held during the Hong Kong FIC & Bond Connect Summit.

Bill Winters said, "Gold is becoming increasingly important as investors and central banks seek diversification in a more uncertain environment. At the same time, the centre of gravity of the gold market is shifting towards Asia, creating new opportunities for international hubs such as Hong Kong. Combining our extensive experience in the Loco London bullion market with our deep knowledge of Asian markets, Standard Chartered is well positioned to support that growth through the continued enhancement of its capabilities across the gold value chain in Hong Kong.

As a Board member of PMCC, Standard Chartered is delighted to have completed its first batch of seven gold transactions through the new gold central clearing and settlement system, with corporates including Chow Sang Sang, Haitong International Securities, JD Technology and Shanghai Pudong Development Bank. We are particularly pleased to have collaborated with counterparts across Hong Kong and Shanghai in this historic trial, which demonstrates the strong synergies from deeper financial cooperation and enhanced market connectivity between the two cities. We look forward to supporting Hong Kong's development as a gold trading hub and helping clients capture opportunities in a market that continues to evolve."

Standard Chartered is one of the leading participants in Asia's gold market, and among the few international banks with a long-established and dedicated precious metals trading desk in Hong Kong and is currently providing a full suite of services to institutional clients, spanning from physical gold trading, financing solutions and services linked to gold derivatives and options.

Standard Chartered

We are a leading international banking group, with a presence in 54 of the world's most dynamic markets. Our purpose is to drive commerce and prosperity through our unique diversity, and our heritage and values are expressed in our brand promise, here for good.

Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

[Category: Investment Banking, Gold, New Offerings, Trade Relations]

Source: Standard Chartered PLC

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COMPANIES & MARKETS

DBS, Samsung Securities to collaborate on **wealth management** across Asia

Chloe Lim

281 words

3 July 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A5

English

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DBS and Samsung Securities on Thursday (Jul 2) signed a memorandum of understanding (MOU) to collaborate in **wealth management**, to enhance their services for clients in Asia.

The two parties will work together in four areas.

First, DBS clients will gain access to the South Korean market through investments in solutions offered by Samsung Securities.

Second, broader global solutions will be available to clients of Samsung Securities, including access to the Singapore lender's multi-asset global wealth solutions.

Third, in terms of client connectivity, advisory services will be offered to serve clients' global **wealth management** needs.

Fourth, the two will facilitate joint learning and innovation development in areas such as artificial intelligence and thought leadership in **wealth management**.

Park Jong-moon, president and CEO of Samsung Securities, said: "By pairing Samsung Securities' strength in South Korea's capital markets with DBS' regional and global wealth platform, we can offer clients a more connected and differentiated wealth experience."

The signing of the MOU comes as clients increasingly seek professional advice to grow their wealth and businesses, and as Asia cements its place as a global **wealth management** hub.

Tan Su Shan, CEO of DBS, said: "Asia is fast becoming the world's wealth engine, and clients increasingly want to manage their wealth seamlessly across markets."

She added that she sees **wealth management** as "just the start".

"Over time, we hope to bring the full strength of DBS as one bank to serve clients across their wealth and business alike."

DBS seen to benefit from China's tighter grip on wealth flows: report, Page 12

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Document STBT000020260703em7300008

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** partners with Cambridge institute to advance leadership capabilities

Distributed by Contify.com

928 words

2 July 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** launches bespoke leadership development programme with University of Cambridge's CISL.

- * Programme aims to equip senior leaders with mindset, skills, and knowledge to deliver differentiated perspectives for clients.

- * 30 Market Heads and Team Leaders from Singapore, Hong Kong, Dubai, and UK participate in the first cohort.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, July 2 -- Standard Chartered PLC issued the following news release:

- Among the first global **private banks** to introduce bespoke leadership development programme for its leaders

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** ("the **Private Bank**") and the University of Cambridge's Institute for Sustainability Leadership ("CISL"), today announced the launch of Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** Mastery Programme – Leadership and Legacy at a two-day Kick-Off Seminar in Singapore. The Leadership and Legacy programme is a four-month executive development programme for the **Private Bank**'s most senior leaders including Market Heads and Team Leads. This programme is aligned with Standard Chartered's strategic priority to grow its Affluent business through investment in its people.

With a backdrop of rapidly evolving macroeconomic, geopolitical, and technology trends expected over the next two decades, the **Private Bank** and CISL co-curated this programme, with specific insights from its Regional Heads, to equip senior bankers with the mindset, skills and knowledge to deliver differentiated perspectives that the Bank's clients and their next generations truly value. The first part of the programme kicks off in Singapore with its first cohort of 30 Market Heads and Team Leaders from the **Private Bank**'s advisory centres in Singapore, Hong Kong, Dubai and UK. Participants will then engage in online modules over the next four months, culminating in a four-day on-campus immersive experience at the University of Cambridge in October 2026.

Beyond the classroom, the curriculum is designed to translate theoretical learnings into practical outcome-focused actions. Led by highly experienced CISL academic fellows, the programme seeks to promote an understanding of how global drivers are impacting ultra-high-net-worth individuals, their businesses, and their families; and to empower our senior bankers with the insights to guide their clients in purposeful stewardship of their wealth today, while preparing the next generation to assume the leadership mantle tomorrow.

Raymond Ang, Global Head, **Private Bank** and Affluent Clients, and Head, Wealth and Retail Banking, Greater China and North Asia, Standard Chartered said: "We are proud to be among the first global **private banks** to introduce a highly curated leadership programme for our senior bankers. As a leading **private bank** in Asia, we continue to earn our clients' trust through tailored advice and bespoke services. Our partnership with CISL reflects our commitment to investing in the professional development of our people and strengthening the capabilities that will help them lead with confidence. Through this programme, we aim to develop future-ready leaders who can continue to support our clients in their life's work, and on their wealth and legacy journeys."

Lindsay Hooper, Chief Executive Officer, Cambridge Institute for Sustainability Leadership said: "CISL is delighted to partner Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** in this bespoke programme focused on leadership and legacy. We look forward to working alongside Standard Chartered executives to build competitiveness and

resilience as they support their clients in this rapidly evolving world of technological change, climate risk, and social pressure, and deliver long-term success for the bank, its clients and the wider society they serve.”

About Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**

Standard Chartered is a leading international banking group with over 170 years of heritage and a presence in more than 50 of the world’s most dynamic markets. Guided by its purpose of driving commerce and prosperity through unique diversity, the Group lives by its brand promise: Here for good.

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** is the Group’s dedicated **private banking** arm, serving UHNW and HNW clients across key advisory centres – Hong Kong, Singapore, the United Arab Emirates, and the United Kingdom. It provides bespoke wealth solutions and a comprehensive suite of services tailored to clients’ needs.

Offerings include access to a broad range of investment opportunities, wealth planning and family advisory, structured lending, corporate advisory, private market opportunities, and dedicated services for external asset managers and family offices.

Leveraging its deep-rooted franchise and international network, Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** connects clients to global opportunities, helping them grow, manage, and preserve their wealth for generations.

sc.com/**private-banking**

The University of Cambridge Institute for Sustainability Leadership (CISL)

CISL is an impact-led institute within the University of Cambridge that activates leadership globally to transform economies for people, nature and climate. Through its global network and hubs in Cambridge, Cape Town and Brussels, CISL works with leaders and innovators across business, finance and government to accelerate action for a sustainable future. Trusted since 1988 for its rigour and pioneering commitment to learning and collaboration, the Institute creates safe spaces to challenge and support those with the power to act. For information please visit [CISL home](#) or follow us on LinkedIn.

Standard Chartered

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Standard Chartered PLC is listed on the London and Hong Kong stock exchanges.

[Category: Investment Banking, Education, Asset and Stake Acquisitions, Partnerships]

Source: Standard Chartered PLC

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Hello, goodbye: Top people moves in June

Citywire Asia Staff

862 words

2 July 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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#1 Exclusive: Ex-BOS market group head joins UOB **Private Bank**

The former market group head for Bank of Singapore will join UOB **Private Bank** in a newly-carved out role as regional market head, according to a 15 June statement seen by Citywire Asia.

Dennis Hong has been recruited by the Singaporean rival as regional market head, Greater China and North Asia.

Read more [here](#).

UOB PB also announced [new changes](#) to its senior management, as the bank looks to solidify its Asean and North Asia market coverage.

#2 Exclusive: UBS GWM rejigs leadership with new business sector heads

UBS Global **Wealth Management** has announced new business sector heads for Asia Pacific, following two key exits, according to an internal memo seen by Citywire Asia.

All changes are effective 1 July. In Asia Pacific, Peter Yang has been named head of GWM private wealth Singapore. He succeeds Dominique Boer, who is leaving the firm.

Yang was most recently market team head and deputy business sector head at GWM Singapore (Greater China).

Read more [here](#).

#3 Bank of Singapore names new Middle East **private banking** head

Bank of Singapore has named a new Middle East head of **private banking**, following the departure of Ranjit Khanna to EFG International.

Lim Leong Guan is taking on the role of **private banking** head for Middle East, South Asia and international, effective 1 July.

Read more [here](#).

#4 Exclusive: Julius Baer Greater China banking veteran exits

A veteran Julius Baer Greater China **private banker** in Hong Kong has exited the Swiss pure-play after more than nine years.

Stephen Kwok, who joined the bank in 2017, also previously had stints at Standard Chartered, where he spent more than seven years, and a 10-year spell with Societe Generale.

Kwok's permissions at the bank ended on 28 May, according to the HKMA database.

Read more [here](#).

#5 Exclusive: UBP's Asia head of private markets group to exit

UBP's head of private markets group, Asia, is departing, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Based in Hong Kong, Steven Xia will leave after being with the Swiss bank for close to five years.

A spokesperson from UBP declined to comment.

Read more [here](#).

#6 Exclusive: Nomura IWM sees double exit from DPM team

Nomura International **Wealth Management** has lost two members of its discretionary portfolio management (DPM) team, Citywire Asia has learnt.

The exits include Louis Shen, discretionary portfolio manager, and Levia Goh, junior portfolio manager.

Nomura declined to comment on personnel moves.

Read more [here](#).

#7 Former Bank of Singapore NRI banker joins RBC

A former Bank of Singapore (BOS) non-resident Indian (NRI) banker has resurfaced at RBC **Wealth Management**.

Sandesh Assao has joined the Canadian **private bank** as a **private banker**, based in Singapore, according to his LinkedIn update. He will cover the global NRI market in Southeast Asia and Dubai and reports to Abhijit Shetty, the bank's global South Asia team head, who joined the **private bank** from Standard Chartered **Private Bank** in May.

Assao had been at BOS since 2024. Previously he was a **private banker** at Nomura and EFG in Singapore. He also worked at Abu Dhabi Commercial Bank and Citi in the UAE.

Read more [here](#).

#8 Exclusive: JP Morgan loses Indonesia, Thailand bankers

Two Singapore-based **private bankers** at JP Morgan have left the firm, Citywire Asia can confirm.

Smith Jingkaojai, an ultra-high net worth banker covering Thailand, and Marc Antoine Haudenschild, an Indonesia-focused banker, have both exited.

A spokesperson for the bank confirmed the departures.

Read more [here](#).

#9 Exclusive: Ares loses Southeast Asia head for wealth

Ares Management's Southeast Asia head for its **wealth management** solutions division is leaving the firm, according to Citywire Asia's understanding.

Based in Singapore, Ashish Jain is departing the US alternatives house after close to three years. He was managing director and head of Southeast Asia within Ares **Wealth Management** Solutions, which oversees the firm's client activities in the global wealth channel.

A spokesperson from Ares has declined to comment.

Read the full story [here](#).

#10 Former AmBank **private banking** head joins BNP Paribas

The former **private banking** head of Malaysia-headquartered AmBank Group has joined BNP Paribas **Wealth Management**.

Keith Chong has moved to Singapore to take on the role as **private banker** after almost seven years at the Malaysian bank.

A spokesperson from BNP Paribas confirmed his hire.

Read more [here](#).

Last month's top stories:

- * Compliance experts [weigh in](#) on whether MAS' target of shorter **private banking** onboarding times is realistic
- * Deutsche Bank's emerging markets DPM head and CIO targets [double DPM penetration](#)
- * **Wealth managers** and financial analysts [discuss](#) implications of China's crackdown on illegal cross-border stock trading
- * Swiss **private bank** Reyl [winds down](#) Singapore operations
- * New report flags why EAMs in Singapore and Hong Kong [struggle](#) to scale up
- * Digital platforms [challenge private banks](#)' traditional grip over EAMs
- * UOB's [potential asset management sale](#) can power **private bank** expansion, experts say
- * **Private banks** see [soaring demand](#) for systematic funds
- * Singapore equities [attract more interest](#) from wealthy individuals amid EQDP push

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Banking & Finance

Great Eastern expands wealth advisory as it deepens push into HNW market

Ranamita Chakraborty

724 words

2 July 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

online

English

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[SINGAPORE] Great Eastern's accredited investor clients can now receive advisory services on both securities and structured products as the insurer deepens its push into the high-net-worth (HNW) segment.

Its wholly owned subsidiary Great Eastern Financial Advisers (GEFA) recently received regulatory approval from the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS) to deliver these services.

The move comes as the 118-year-old insurer deepens collaboration within the OCBC Group, leveraging the expertise of private banking arm Bank of Singapore (BOS) to broaden its wealth advisory offering.

BOS CEO Jason Moo told The Business Times that financial intermediaries have become a "strategic and fast-growing" segment for the bank.

He said the partnership will give GEFA's clients direct access to BOS' investment platform and capabilities, allowing advisers to offer a broader range of wealth solutions to eligible clients.

"This aligns with OCBC Group's vision of a whole-of-wealth proposition, leveraging our strengths as an integrated financial services group across banking, wealth and insurance," added Moo.

Previously, representatives from GEFA were unable to advise on securities and structured deposits. When HNW clients wanted certain pure wealth products, they would have to be referred externally to private banks.

With the recent approval, qualified GEFA representatives can advise eligible clients on a wider range of solutions for HNW clients, including, but not limited to, securities such as listed equities and bonds, as well as structured products such as fixed coupon notes and equity-linked notes.

To support the expanded offering, GEFA is strengthening the capabilities of its advisory force. Its CEO Jesslyn Tan told BT that advisers must complete the necessary capital markets and financial advisory services modules or hold specific relevant qualifications.

Great Eastern is also working with BOS to support its advisers with training programmes, similar to those undertaken by the bank's relationship managers, in areas such as anti-money laundering, source-of-wealth verification, platform usage and product competency.

"This ensures that advisers are equipped with the necessary expertise, governance standards and technical proficiency to operate effectively within this enhanced advisory framework," said Tan.

"Two sides of the same coin"

Based on BT's checks, Great Eastern appears to be the only insurer in Singapore whose financial advisory arm offers advisory services on both securities and structured products to accredited investors.

BT found that Singlife, Etiqa, Manulife and Prudential do not currently offer advisory on both securities and structured products through their financial advisory arms.

However, a Manulife spokesperson said that for accredited investor clients, certain investment advisory capabilities may be available where appropriate. For products outside Manulife's direct offering, its representatives may refer clients to third-party providers.

Great Eastern said MAS' approval strengthens its integrated wealth planning and investment offering after it launched Great Eastern Private, a dedicated proposition serving HNWI individuals and their families, in March this year.

This coincides with an estimated US\$5.8 trillion intergenerational wealth transfer taking place across Asia-Pacific, a trend expected to drive demand for more comprehensive wealth planning solutions.

Tan sees wealth and insurance solutions complementing each other.

"Think of it as two sides of the same coin – both are essential to our client's financial well-being and address different needs," she said.

Eligible clients, she added, will now be able to access insurance and investment advisory through a single adviser rather than being referred across different providers. This is expected to directly attract and benefit the growing pool of accredited investors with sophisticated wealth planning needs across the region and globally.

The insurer reported a record net profit of S\$1.2 billion for 2025, up 21 per cent from a year earlier, supported by stronger investment returns.

Although total weighted new sales fell 15 per cent, reflecting a shift away from short-term single-premium products, new business embedded value – a measure of the future profitability of new policies sold – increased 19 per cent to S\$739.7 million.

Great Eastern has, however, maintained that its expansion into the HNWI market complements, rather than replaces, its core mass-market business.

As more affluent families focus on succession planning, the insurer sees opportunities to broaden the range of financial solutions offered to this client segment.

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Business

OCBC rolls out banking app with AI avatars amid wealth push

Sheila Chiang

784 words

2 July 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

print

A18

English

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OCBC will progressively launch what it says is South-east Asia's first AI-native mobile banking app, introducing two virtual avatars that can engage customers around the clock with personalised **wealth management** insights.

To further support its wealth push, the bank will hire 600 additional relationship managers (RMs) for its consumer banking business over the next three years.

The initiatives are part of the bank's "next frontier" strategy to harness artificial intelligence, digital technology and data to drive growth, said OCBC group chief executive Tan Teck Long at the unveiling of the new app to the media at OCBC Centre on July 1.

"AI-native" describes a technology, system or organisation built from the ground up with AI at its core.

Some 50 OCBC premier private clients – with minimum assets under management of \$1.5 million – and a selected group of the bank's employees in Singapore will be invited to test the beta version of the OCBC WoW app.

OCBC will progressively increase the number of customers testing the app and providing feedback to refine the experience. Subsequent phases of the beta version will be rolled out, with enhancements driven by iterative prototyping and user feedback.

Separate from OCBC's mobile banking app, which enables customers to manage their finances, pay bills and track investments, OCBC WoW is a standalone app featuring two AI-powered avatars that deliver hyper-personalised **wealth management** services in real time.

Customers will interact with "Wendy" and "Wayne" through voice or text, where the avatars will provide them with sophisticated portfolio analysis to better understand underlying exposures and sources of risk.

This helps customers make more informed decisions, optimise portfolio allocation, and improve long-term investment outcomes, said OCBC.

Customers will also be able to see their investment portfolios and stay up to date with personalised market news, real-time data, the bank's expert insights, and curated investment ideas across markets, geographies, currencies and investment themes.

When asked if OCBC will extend the app to retail customers, Tan said it will consider other customer segments after the beta, with a fuller roll-out expected at a later date.

"Our whole focus in the initial launch is on the wealth business, before extending to further customer segments," he said. "It is actually very useful for the retail customer segment, where we can provide some education for retail customers. We did not launch to retail customers at the beginning because we find that the retail segment tends to have simpler needs."

For example, if they want to buy shares or unit trusts, they can do so on OCBC's mobile banking app, he added.

Despite introducing avatars, the bank still sees the human touch as important, hence its parallel push to expand its RM headcount.

“At the end of the day, customers still want the human touch,” said Sunny Quek, OCBC’s head of global consumer financial services. “That’s where the RMs come in and play their role. Other things that are not so important, or can be done at your convenience, the avatar will fill that role.”

He added that each RM typically manages 250 to 300 customers, and the avatars will allow them to engage with their customers more effectively. With the help of avatars, the interaction and engagement are “going to be on a different level”, he noted.

Tan said the revenue and number of transactions between avatar advisers and human advisers are “going to be very different”.

“All RMs will get efficiency, and therefore they should be able to support a higher business volume,” he added.

The avatars will initially engage customers in English, with other languages such as Mandarin, Bahasa Melayu and Bahasa Indonesia to be progressively introduced.

Future enhancements will include tailored insurance solutions and banking services, an expanded range of avatars, and exclusive offers to mark customers’ investment milestones – alongside rewards designed to suit a wide range of lifestyle preferences.

OCBC aims to double its consumer **wealth management** business by 2029, a year ahead of its original 2030 target.

To reach this goal, the bank is bringing together its consumer bank, Bank of Singapore, and its insurance arm, Great Eastern, to drive wealth income growth through integrated digital capabilities, closer collaboration and regional expansion.

In April, Citi rolled out Citi Sky – aimed at delivering timely guidance for clients, including prompts and market insights – to Citigold clients in the US. Initially available in English and Spanish, the agentic AI system on the Citi mobile app features a virtual human avatar that clients can converse with in real time to ask financial questions.

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OCBC unveils avatar banking to transform customer journeys

Distributed by Contify.com

1,183 words

1 July 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * OCBC WoW offers hyper-personalised **wealth management** services through two avatars, Wendy and Wayne.
- * The app provides real-time curated news, market developments, and actionable investment ideas.
- * The app will offer tailored insurance solutions, banking services, and exclusive deals in the future.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, July 1 -- OCBC Bank issued the following news release:

At a glance

- * OCBC deploys first AI-native bank mobile app in the region incorporating two avatars to offer hyper-personalised **wealth management** services on a real-time basis, 24/7.
- * Avatar banking by OCBC WoW is a brand new customer engagement channel.
- * The avatars in OCBC WoW interact seamlessly with customers through voice or text, and anticipate needs using advanced portfolio intelligence.

OCBC unveils avatar banking to transform the way it engages customers. The Bank's new app, OCBC WoW, incorporates two avatars delivering hyper-personalised **wealth management** services on a real-time basis, 24/7. Over time, OCBC WoW will leverage its AI-native environment to extend its range of products and services to meet customers' increasingly sophisticated needs and build deeper and stickier relationships.

With AI, Digital, Data (ADD) at the core of the Next Frontier corporate strategy, OCBC will intensify the build-up of its AI-native environment to support a test-and-learn culture. This approach enables rapid, low-cost experimentation through prototyping, allowing promising ideas to be quickly refined and scaled into agile, high-impact execution.

Spanning **wealth management** to becoming a daily go-to news destination, and from lifestyle rewards to core banking services, OCBC WoW aims to establish itself as a "digital financial companion" seamlessly integrated into customers' everyday lives.

In its beta version, Wendy and Wayne, the two avatars in OCBC WoW – which means OCBC bringing the "Whole-of Wealth" proposition across the Group to customers – will show customers their investment portfolios, and deliver personalised market news and data combined with OCBC Group insights and top investment ideas across markets, geographies, currencies and themes. OCBC WoW anticipates customer needs and incorporates advanced portfolio intelligence.

Wendy and Wayne will interact seamlessly with customers through voice or text. They will provide customers with sophisticated portfolio analysis, so they can better understand underlying exposures and sources of risk. This in turn empowers customers to make more informed decisions, optimise portfolio allocation and improve long-term investment outcomes.

OCBC WoW enhances OCBC wealth advisors' understanding of the investment needs of customers, enabling pro-active engagement with timely, relevant and tailored support. This encourages customers to invest more through OCBC, thus enlarging the share of customers' wallet in OCBC's 'Whole-of-Wealth' push.

OCBC Group CEO, Tan Teck Long, said: "We are changing the 'face of banking'. Starting with **wealth management**, we are transforming how we engage customers with the use of avatars and hyper-personalisation on a real-time basis, 24/7.

"The ability to roll out new features in quick succession in a viable manner is made possible because of an AI-native environment. Hyper-personalisation goes from being a buzz word to being a reality with intelligence built into the foundation. With ADD – AI, Digital, Data – at the core of our growth push, we are very excited that OCBC WoW is only the beginning.

"Welcome to Avatar Banking by OCBC WoW."

First AI-native bank mobile app in South-East Asia

Five compelling features in OCBC WoW in combination will nudge customers to keep coming back to ask Wendy or Wayne for the latest news and insights, tailored to their needs and preferences, and to access actionable investment ideas:

1. Real-time curated news and market developments relevant to the customer's portfolio;
2. Timely market price data from 7 indices and commodities, with planned expansion to 12 over time;
3. Personalised OCBC Group insights and house views as well as their implications on the customer's portfolio;
4. Tracking of the customer's portfolio and how it is impacted by market developments;
5. Actionable investment ideas based on the customer's profile and risk appetite.

The beta version of OCBC WoW will be released to a selected group of employees and customers on an invitation-only basis. Customers who are invited are currently served by OCBC Premier Private Client (with minimum assets under management of S\$1.5 million) wealth advisors. Subsequent phases of the beta version will be progressively rolled out, with enhancements driven by iterative prototyping and user feedback, underpinned by a nimble, scalable approach. A fuller roll-out is expected at a date to be announced.

The new platform is built on four technology architecture layers:

- * The first layer comprises data ingestion of real-time market data, OCBC research and insights, and customers' portfolios, transaction data and behaviour sets;
- * The second layer integrates the AI deterministic guardrails into the platform;
- * The third layer comprises the use of AI agents for building intelligence at scale;
- * The last layer generates the output modules that are seen and experienced by customers.

The outcome is that OCBC WoW can deliver real time, always-on **wealth management** capabilities to customers in a safe and secure environment.

More to come in OCBC WoW

The avatars, Wendy and Wayne, will initially engage customers in English. Languages such as Mandarin, Bahasa Melayu and Bahasa Indonesia will be progressively introduced. Down the line are tailored insurance solutions and banking services, a wider range of avatars and exclusive deals to celebrate customers' investment milestones and rewards that cater to a wide spectrum of lifestyle preferences.

Enhancing customer centricity through AI, digital and data

The rollout of OCBC WoW builds on earlier investments in AI, digital and data.

Earlier this year, OCBC's consumer banking unit rolled out a Gen AI-powered skills training programme for its wealth advisor force in Singapore. The six-month programme coaches wealth advisors on a full range of competencies including investment advisory, client management, product mastery and wealth planning. By

incorporating GenAI, the programme helps minimise bias and emotional influence often associated with traditional, supervisor-led coaching, enabling more objective and consistent development outcomes.

Within the first three months of training, wealth advisors demonstrated a high level of customer engagement, securing double the number of weekly client appointments compared to peers who had not yet completed the programme. There was also a 50 per cent uplift in revenue compared with the previous three months.

Last year, Bank of Singapore, OCBC's private banking arm, rolled out an agentic AI-powered source of wealth (SOW) tool. Embedded directly into Know-Your-Customer workflows, the AI 'agent' independently initiates and coordinates tasks such as extracting, structuring and synthesising information across customer records and supporting documents, identifying data gaps and prompting targeted follow-ups when needed for assessment completion.

This tool helped relationship managers reduce average preparation time for SOW reports from 10 days to just one hour, accelerating client onboarding and periodic reviews. The RMs can then channel the gain in productivity into deepening client relationships and delivering superior experiences.

[Category: Investment Banking, New Offerings, Artificial Intelligence]

Source: OCBC Bank

Document ATINBK0020260703em71000dx

DBS Bank India offers up to 5.6% per annum on USD FCNR(B) deposits

Distributed by Contify.com

923 words

1 July 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * New interest rates effective from 1 July 2026 for tenures ranging from three to five years.
- * DBS Bank India named Asia's Safest Bank for 17 consecutive years by Global Finance.
- * DBS Treasures offers comprehensive banking, wealth, and investment solutions for NRI customers.

Original Press Release:

India, July 1 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

DBS Bank India today revised interest rates on its Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposits for Non-Resident Indians (NRIs), in line with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)'s recent announcement. The new rates are effective from 1 July 2026.

The bank will now offer up to 5.6% per annum[*] on USD FCNR(B) deposits for tenures ranging from three to five years. This provides NRIs with an opportunity to earn attractive returns while maintaining their savings in a foreign currency. Deposits are fully repatriable, with both principal and interest payable in the designated foreign currency, thereby reducing exposure to exchange rate fluctuations at maturity.

DBS has been named Asia's Safest Bank for 17 consecutive years by Global Finance (2009–2025), and the bank's AA- and Aa1 credit ratings are among the highest in the world. DBS Bank India combines the strength of a leading Asian bank with a comprehensive suite of solutions tailored to the needs of NRI customers.

DBS Bank India differentiates itself through DBS Treasures, its NRI banking and wealth management proposition. It brings together a comprehensive suite of banking, wealth, and investment solutions for seamless financial management across geographies, alongside its enhanced FCNR(B) offering.

Eligible NRIs can also benefit from seamless digital onboarding, enabling them to open accounts from overseas with ease, including for FCNR(B) deposits. By taking a holistic view of its clients' financial needs, DBS Bank India delivers integrated banking, investment and financing solutions that help them manage remittances, grow their investments and plan for long-term wealth creation.

Key features of DBS Bank India FCNR(B) deposits:

- * Earn up to 5.6%[*] per annum on USD deposits.
- * Available for flexible tenures ranging from three to five years.
- * Principal and interest payable in foreign currency.
- * Fully repatriable, enabling seamless movement of funds.

Reduced exposure to exchange rate fluctuations at maturity.

DBS was recently recognised at the Euromoney **Private Banking** Awards 2026, where it was named the World's Best **Private Bank** and World's Safest **Private Bank**, reinforcing the Group's position as a trusted partner for clients seeking to protect and grow their wealth.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia, and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world. In 2025, CRISIL Ratings reaffirmed its 'CRISIL AAA/Stable' rating on the corporate credit facility of DBS Bank India Ltd (DBIL). The rating on the certificate of deposits programme was also reaffirmed at 'CRISIL A1+'.

Recognized for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney, and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the world's "Most Innovative in Digital Banking" by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025. DBS Bank India was recognized by CRISIL - Coalition Greenwich as the Best Bank for Corporate Banking and Best Bank for Corporate Cash Management in India in 2025. In the same year, Euromoney also named DBS Bank India the Best Digital Bank for SMEs in India.

As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

DBS Bank has been present in India for more than 30 years, opening its first office in Mumbai in 1994. DBS Bank India Limited is the first among the large foreign banks in India to start operating as a wholly owned, locally incorporated subsidiary of a leading global bank. As a trusted partner, DBS provides a range of banking services for large, medium, and small enterprises and individual consumers in India, focusing on a seamless customer experience that helps them 'Live more, Bank less'. In November 2020, Lakshmi Vilas Bank was merged with DBS Bank India Limited. DBS Bank India is now present in ~350 locations in 19 Indian states.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by supporting businesses for impact: enterprises with a double bottom-line of profit and social and/or environmental impact. DBS Foundation also gives back to society in various ways, including equipping underserved communities with future-ready skills and helping them to build food resilience.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

Footnote:

[*] Mandatory lock-in period of one year, during which premature withdrawals are not permitted.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Asset and Wealth Management, Investment Banking, New Offerings]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

Document ATINBK0020260702em71000jt

HSBC **Private Bank** strengthens Taiwan coverage

Distributed by Contify.com

415 words

30 June 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * HSBC **Private Bank** appoints Gloria Sun as Market Head of Offshore Taiwan.
- * She will lead offshore Taiwan teams in Hong Kong and Singapore.
- * Gloria Sun previously held senior roles at DBS, Deutsche Bank, and Bank of East Asia.

Original Press Release:

June 30 -- HSBC **Private Bank** issued the following news release:

HSBC today announced the appointment of Gloria Sun as Market Head of Offshore Taiwan, HSBC **Private Bank**, effective 13 July 2026. Based in Hong Kong, Sun will report to Kanas Chan, Head of **Private Bank**, North Asia and Hong Kong. She will lead the offshore Taiwan Teams in Hong Kong and Singapore. This appointment further strengthens the Taiwan market coverage for HSBC **Private Bank** in addition to its recent hire of onshore Taiwan Market Headits recent hire of onshore Taiwan Market Head Open In New Window.

Sun brings over 20 years of leadership experience in **private banking** and wealth management across Greater China. She most recently served as Senior Market Head for Taiwan at DBS, and previously held senior **private banking** roles at Deutsche Bank and the Bank of East Asia. Earlier in her career, she built strong expertise in client coverage, team leadership and market expansion across several global financial institutions.

Commenting on the appointment, Kanas Chan, Head of **Private Bank**, North Asia and Hong Kong said, "We are doubling down on Taiwan and committed to growing our market share across Greater China. As an international bank, we are uniquely placed to support entrepreneurial clients and their families with their international needs. With Gloria's leadership and experience, we are confident she will take our offshore Taiwan **Private Bank** business to the next level while strengthening our holistic offerings across the region."

About HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy.

www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 56 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,306 billion at 31 March 2026, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Banking and Financial Services, Investment Banking, Management Changes]

Source: HSBC **Private Bank**

Document ATINBK0020260704em6u00033



Announcements

Union Gas Holdings Limited - Announcements - Change - Announcement Of Appointment :: Appointment Of Independent Director

1,201 words

30 June 2026

ListedCompany.com

LCCSIN

English

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Announcement Title

Change - Announcement of Appointment

Date & Time of Broadcast

Jun 30, 2026 17:40

Status

New

Announcement Sub Title

Appointment of Independent Director

Announcement Reference

SG2606300THRS2UG

Submitted By (Co. / Ind. Name)

Wong Yoen Har

Designation

Company Secretary

Description (Please provide a detailed description of the event in the box below)

Appointment of Independent Director - Mr. Gan Thiam Poh

Additional Details

Date of appointment

01/07/2026

Name of person

Gan Thiam Poh

Age

62

Country of principal residence

Singapore

The Board's comments on this appointment (including rationale, selection criteria, board diversity considerations, and the search and nomination process) The Nominating Committee ("NC") and the Board of Directors of the Company ("the Board") have reviewed and considered the qualifications and working experience of Mr. Gan Thiam Poh ("Mr. Gan") and found Mr. Gan to be suitable candidate for the appointment as independent director of the Company, Chairman of the Remuneration Committee ("RC") and Member of the Audit Committee ("AC") and NC. Accordingly, the NC has recommended and the Board has approved the appointment of Mr. Gan as independent director of the Company, Chairman of the RC and Member of the AC and NC. The Board considers Mr. Gan is independent for the purposes of Rule 704(8) of the Listing Manual of the Singapore Exchange Securities Trading Limited.

Whether appointment is executive, and if so, the area of responsibility

Non-Executive

Job title (e.g. Lead ID, AC Chairman, AC Member etc.)

Independent Director, Chairman of the Remuneration Committee and

Member of the Audit Committee and Nominating Committee.

Professional qualifications

Bachelor of Science (Economics and Mathematics) degree from

National University of Singapore **Private Banking** (Licensed)

Working experience and occupation(s) during the past 10 years

Mr. Gan has worked at DBS Bank since 2002 and is currently the Senior Vice President of **Private Banking**, DBS Bank Ltd responsible for advising ultra-high-net-worth clients. He has served as a Member of Parliament in Singapore from 2011 to 2025. During his tenure, he was a member of the Singapore Parliamentary Committee for Public Accounts and served on various Government Parliamentary Committees, including Transport, National Development, and Sustainability and the Environment.

Shareholding interest in the listed issuer and its subsidiaries

No

Any relationship (including immediate family relationships) with any existing director, existing executive officer, the issuer and/or substantial shareholder of the listed issuer or of any of its principal subsidiaries None.

Conflict of interest (including any competing business)

None.

Undertaking (in the format set out in Appendix 7.7 or Appendix 7H) under Mainboard Rule 720(1) or Catalist Rule 720(1) has been submitted to the listed issuer Yes

These fields are not applicable for announcements of appointments pursuant to Mainboard Rule 704(9) or Catalist Rule 704(8).

Past (for the last 5 years)

Member of Parliament Singapore

Present

Senior Vice President of **Private Banking**, DBS Bank Ltd Independent

Director of AnnAik Limited Independent Director of Soon Hock Enterprise Limited

(a) Whether at any time during the last 10 years, an application or a petition under any bankruptcy law of any jurisdiction was filed against him or against a partnership of which he was a partner at the time when he was a partner or at any time within 2 years from the date he ceased to be a partner? No

(b) Whether at any time during the last 10 years, an application or a petition under any law of any jurisdiction was filed against an entity (not being a partnership) of which he was a director or an equivalent person or a key executive, at the time when he was a director or an equivalent person or a key executive of that entity or at any time within 2 years from the date he ceased to be a director or an equivalent person or a key executive of that entity, for the winding up or dissolution of that entity or, where that entity is the trustee of a business trust, that business trust, on the ground of insolvency? No

(c) Whether there is any unsatisfied judgment against him?

No

(d) Whether he has ever been convicted of any offence, in Singapore or elsewhere, involving fraud or dishonesty which is punishable with imprisonment, or has been the subject of any criminal proceedings (including any pending criminal proceedings of which he is aware) for such purpose? No

(e) Whether he has ever been convicted of any offence, in Singapore or elsewhere, involving a breach of any law or regulatory requirement that relates to the securities or futures industry in Singapore or elsewhere, or has been the subject of any criminal proceedings (including any pending criminal proceedings of which he is aware) for such breach? No

(f) Whether at any time during the last 10 years, judgment has been entered against him in any civil proceedings in Singapore or elsewhere involving a breach of any law or regulatory requirement that relates to the securities or futures industry in Singapore or elsewhere, or a finding of fraud, misrepresentation or dishonesty on his part, or he has been the subject of any civil proceedings (including any pending civil proceedings of which he is aware) involving an allegation of fraud, misrepresentation or dishonesty on his part? No

(g) Whether he has ever been convicted in Singapore or elsewhere of any offence in connection with the formation or management of any entity or business trust? No

(h) Whether he has ever been disqualified from acting as a director or an equivalent person of any entity (including the trustee of a business trust), or from taking part directly or indirectly in the management of any entity or business trust? No

(i) Whether he has ever been the subject of any order, judgment or ruling of any court, tribunal or governmental body, permanently or temporarily enjoining him from engaging in any type of business practice or activity?No

(j) Whether he has ever, to his knowledge, been concerned with the management or conduct, in Singapore or elsewhere, of the affairs of:-

(i) any corporation which has been investigated for a breach of any law or regulatory requirement governing corporations in Singapore or elsewhere; orNo

(ii) any entity (not being a corporation) which has been investigated for a breach of any law or regulatory requirement governing such entities in Singapore or elsewhere; orNo

(iii) any business trust which has been investigated for a breach of any law or regulatory requirement governing business trusts in Singapore or elsewhere; orNo in connection with any matter occurring or arising during that period when he was so concerned with the entity or business trust?No

(k) Whether he has been the subject of any current or past investigation or disciplinary proceedings, or has been reprimanded or issued any warning, by the Monetary Authority of Singapore or any other regulatory authority, exchange, professional body or government agency, whether in Singapore or elsewhere?No
Any prior experience as a director of an issuer listed on the Exchange?

Yes

If yes, please provide details of prior experience.

Ex-Independent Director of Ouhua Energy Limited Independent
Director of AnnAik Limited Independent Director of Soon Hock Enterprise Limited

Document LCCSIN0020260630em6u0005y

Business

HSBC at the centre of \$330mn alleged Lebanese money-laundering scandal

ORTENCA ALIAJ , SARAH WHITE, RAYA JALABI; MERCEDES RUEHL

1,657 words

29 June 2026

Financial Times

FTFTA

1; Main

9

English

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Case involving former central bank governor follows penalty for handling Mexican drug cartel and terrorist funds

In February 2013 a compliance officer at HSBC raised concerns with the bank's financial crimes investigation team about funds flowing through an account held within its **private bank** in Switzerland.

The account was Forry Associates, a company controlled by Raja Salameh, the brother of Lebanon's central bank governor at the time, Riad Salameh. More than a hundred million dollars had passed through the account with little information about the nature of the transactions. The compliance officer found the activity suspicious.

After an initial review by HSBC's investigations team, the issue was escalated to senior managers who oversee assessments of politically exposed persons, according to people familiar with a French judicial probe. They decided to keep the relationship with Forry Associates going.

That decision could prove costly for HSBC. It has helped put Europe's largest lender at the centre of a huge moneylaundering scandal that involves the alleged embezzlement of hundreds of millions of dollars from Lebanon's central bank by its former governor and his associates.

French prosecutors this month confirmed they had brought preliminary charges against HSBC's Swiss **Private Bank** over allegations it helped Riad Salameh embezzle funds. A judge will later decide whether to take the matter to trial or dismiss the charges.

Investigators allege that \$330mn was transferred from the central bank Banque du Liban to Forry Associates between 2002 and 2015. They also traced 174 transactions from Forry Associates to Raja Salameh's personal HSBC account in the period between 2009 and 2016, totalling \$204mn, according to court documents and people familiar with the investigation.

Riad Salameh has long claimed he had "nothing to do" with Forry but Lebanese and European investigators allege the company was central to the alleged scheme to siphon off public funds that ultimately benefited him and his relatives.

The case against HSBC is largely mounted on evidence gathered by Swiss authorities, which are also investigating the company's Swiss unit over alleged aggravated money laundering, as part of a wider investigation into the Salameh brothers.

The Swiss regulator Finma had previously found that HSBC's Swiss unit seriously breached anti-money laundering requirements in its handling of Lebanon-linked clients. In its 2024 decision, it also criticised the bank for taking too long to report its suspicions to the authorities despite mounting red flags.

"The bank failed to recognise the indications of money laundering presented by these transactions," Finma wrote in its finding. "It likewise failed to satisfy requirements for the initiation and continuation of customer relationships with politically exposed persons, and was thus in serious breach of its due diligence obligations," it added.

The period under scrutiny 2001 to 2016 is particularly bruising for HSBC. The bank paid a then record \$1.9bn fine in 2012 to settle allegations in the US that it had allowed itself to be used by Mexican drug cartels and terrorist

financiers for money laundering. US investigators also found that the bank had ignored internal warnings about the flow of funds.

Last year, HSBC warned that the investigations could have a "significant" impact on the group. It has already terminated relationships with more than 1,000 wealthy Middle Eastern clients from countries including Saudi Arabia and Lebanon. The banking group declined to comment on this story.

HSBC's relationship with the Salameh brothers started just before the turn of the millennium when it bought Republic National Bank of New York.

As part of the transaction it inherited banker Sobhi Tabbara, a longtime acquaintance of Riad and Raja Salameh, who had spent more than a decade at the bank. Tabbara described Raja Salameh as someone "very well known to me for over 20 years" in internal communications. The two men had met when Raja Salameh was heading the Beirut office of Republic National Bank of New York, people familiar with the investigation told the FT in 2023.

HSBC opened an account for Forry Associates, a shell company registered in the British Virgin Islands, shortly after it was established in 2001. Mossack Fonseca, the law firm that would go on to be at the centre of the Panama Papers scandal, acted as its administrator and its beneficial owner was Raja Salameh.

The account was set up to receive funds from the Banque du Liban under a 2002 contract signed with Forry Associates. The company would receive commission payments made to Raja Salameh for his role as a broker for the central bank. HSBC did not have a copy of the contract when the account was opened, according to legal documents and people familiar with the investigation.

Internal HSBC records show that Tabbara vouched for the account linked to Raja Salameh, saying Forry Associates was a legitimate business.

But European investigators who later looked into the company, in one of multiple ongoing investigations into the Salamehs, could not verify that Forry Associates had employees, clients or any activities beyond receiving money from the central bank.

HSBC's own compliance monitoring programme raised multiple alerts regarding Forry Associates beginning in 2006, a decade before the bank cut ties with the Salameh brothers.

In 2007, HSBC sought evidence to justify the Banque du Liban payments flowing into the Forry Associates account and Tabbara was scheduled to travel to Beirut.

HSBC wanted so-called resolutions approved by Banque du Liban's Central Council that would purportedly corroborate the transfers of fees and commissions into the Forry Associates account.

It is unclear whether Tabbara made the trip or whether HSBC then received any documents. But in 2009 the bank received a Swift message from the Banque du Liban, which stated that the reference numbers cited on commission payments to Forry Associates matched resolutions adopted by its central council.

Tabbara said he followed up with a Banque du Liban compliance officer, who confirmed that Forry was one of their brokers and the central bank's board was aware of the contract and related transactions. The latter claim was later disputed by investigators.

The communication made through the secure global messaging network Swift, used by thousands of financial institutions, was heavily relied on by HSBC as a reason for maintaining the relationship with Raja Salameh.

"This body [the board] is obviously in full knowledge of the commission levied by Forry," Tabbara told HSBC compliance officers in 2009, according to an internal memo. "I think it would be inappropriate to ask for more details, as they were kind enough to already send us this authenticated Swift."

He added: "I am fully comfortable with their explanation." By 2011 more than \$100mn had passed through the Forry Associates account according to Swiss regulators.

Tabbara was by then leading the lender's **private banking** efforts in the Middle East and north Africa, a role he would stay in for over a decade until his departure in January 2024. He did not respond to requests for comment.

In summer 2015, almost 14 years after HSBC first opened the Forry Associates account, it finally received a contract between the company and the Banque du Liban. But there were discrepancies between the version

provided by Raja Salameh and the original 2002 contract with the Banque du Liban, according to people familiar with the investigation.

The contract provided to the bank in 2015 was signed by Raja Salameh himself, while the original was signed by Riad Salameh and another individual.

The bank's financial intelligence unit requested a new round of verifications. By then roughly \$300mn had passed through the account.

In tracing the flow of transactions, it found the bulk of the funds had been sent from the Forry Associates account to Raja Salameh's personal HSBC accounts before being routed onward to his bank accounts in Lebanon.

The FIU privately concluded that these personal accounts were "likely" being used as a "pass-through" and "most probably aiming to conceal" the source of the funds in question.

In early 2016, HSBC decided to close all relationships linked to Raja Salameh. It maintained the decision was unrelated to money laundering concerns and instead based on "risk appetite," according to people familiar with the investigation.

The net started to close around Riad Salameh in 2019. Years prior, the then central bank governor had turned to what he described as "financial engineering" to keep the country's economy going. He offered commercial banks interest of up to 12 per cent to increase their dollar deposits at the Banque du Liban in an effort to shore up its large stock of foreign reserves.

Banks, in turn, offered high interest rates to their customers on multiyear deposits.

More than two-thirds of Lebanese bank deposits were invested with the state by 2019. Repayments on outstanding public debt made up more than a third of total government expenditure annually in what has been referred to as "a state-sponsored Ponzi scheme."

Today, Riad Salameh is charged with embezzling \$44mn by Lebanon and is under criminal investigation in several European countries for siphoning off hundreds of millions more from the central bank.

He has long denied all allegations of misconduct. His lawyers said: "The suspicions of embezzlement of funds by Riad Salameh correspond neither to [his] lifestyle nor to the financial reality of the case, since his wealth was built before he took office at the [Banque du Liban]." They did not comment on HSBC's alleged role, since an international arrest warrant blocks access to the case file.

In 2020, four years after HSBC had cut ties with the Salamehs and Forry Associates, and as Lebanon's economy was in freefall, the bank filed a report to Switzerland's money laundering reporting office. To Swiss regulators, it was too late.

'The bank failed to recognise the indications of money laundering presented by these transactions'

Document FTFTA00020260629em6t0008m

Exclusive: DBS Private Bank NRI team head exits

Priyanka Boghani

137 words

23 June 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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A team head that covered the non-resident Indian (NRI) market for over a decade at DBS has left, Citywire Asia can reveal.

Shruti Garg has exited her Hong Kong-based role at the Singaporen **private bank**. She covered the NRI and global South Asian markets.

A spokesperson from DBS **Private Bank** declined to comment on her departure.

Prior to DBS, Garg worked at UBS Global Wealth Management, Bank of Singapore, ABN Amro **Private Banking** and Standard Chartered India.

Her departure follows that of Rajat Sood and Saurav Sekhar, who both left DBS Bank to join Julius Baer, as Citywire Asia [reported](#) earlier.

The NRI market in Hong Kong continues to hold a shallow talent pool, with many relocating to Singapore or Dubai to cover the segment.

Document CWIRAS0020260623em6n00001

Exclusive: UOB Private Bank rejigs senior management

Priyanka Boghani

256 words

16 June 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Following a townhall meeting and the external appointment of ex-Bank of Singapore group head Dennis Hong, UOB Private Bank has also reshuffled senior management, Citywire Asia has learnt.

UOB Private Bank's Jolene Ho, who was initially a regional market head for Singapore and North Asia, moves into a strategic client coverage role, while Neo Teng Hwee remains CIO and investment products solutions head.

The Singapore market will now be headed by Shaw Bee Chung, who previously held the roles of head of deposits and wealth management for Singapore and the region at UOB. The Asean region will be covered by Chew Mun Yew on an interim basis, while Hong will be the new Greater China North Asia regional market head and Judy Chan the Hong Kong market head, as Citywire Asia exclusively [reported](#).

Other functions that were named include Alex Sim, the private bank's COO, who moves into a head of business operations and controls role; Angela Tan, the private bank's head of business management, who will take on client experience, Michael Tor to lead sales performance management and Samuel Ang to remain as risk and controls head.

The role of strategic initiatives was still to be named at the 15 June town hall announcement.

Citywire Asia reached out to a spokesperson from the bank.

The bank has been emphasising the importance of the Greater China market to its business, with the aim to capture the growing wealth flows between Greater China and Asean.

Document CWIRAS0020260616em6g00001

Exclusive: Ex-BOS market group head joins UOB Private Bank

Priyanka Boghani

242 words

15 June 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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The former market group head for Bank of Singapore will join UOB Private Bank in a newly-carved out role as regional market head, according to a 15 June statement seen by Citywire Asia.

Dennis Hong (pictured) has been recruited by the Singaporean rival as regional market head, Greater China and North Asia. He will join in September, based in Singapore, and report directly to Chew Mun Yew, UOB Private Bank's head.

In his new role, Hong will lead the growth of UOB Private Bank's Greater China and North Asia franchise, covering key markets including China, Hong Kong, Taiwan and Japan, the bank said, following a townhall meeting today.

Hong will also look to strengthen the bank's advisory capabilities, and lead teams to deliver growth across the region. His role includes further enhancing UOB Private Bank's proposition for high-net-worth clients with cross-border wealth and business needs.

'His appointment to this new role reflects UOB Private Bank's continued investment in talent and capabilities to capture growing wealth flows between Greater China and Asean,' the bank said.

The bank emphasised the importance of the Greater China market to its business.

Most recently, it promoted Paul Zhou as its new market head for Greater China and hired former Bank of China (Hong Kong) private banking market head Judy Chan to lead its Hong Kong business.

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BusinessWorld

Special Report

SPECIAL REPORT: First Quarter Banking Report Financial Ratios

1,626 words

15 June 2026

BusinessWorld

BSWRLD

S4/3

English

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Banks are ranked based on Total Assets

INTERMEDIATION RATIO TOTAL LOANS / TOTAL DEPOSITS
Q1' 26 Q4' 25 Q1' 25

P1 TRILLION AND OVER, IN TOTAL ASSETS

BDO Unibank, Inc.	84.79%	86.91%	84.47%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	75.75%	74.07%	81.86%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	91.21%	91.72%	88.85%
Land Bank of the Philippines	43.48%	42.16%	42.08%
China Banking Corp.	73.49%	73.13%	71.52%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	74.28%	74.21%	72.92%
Security Bank Corp.	73.26%	75.68%	77.52%
Union Bank of the Philippines	74.74%	74.88%	75.75%
Philippine National Bank	77.07%	71.76%	69.22%
Development Bank of the Philippines	69.12%	65.85%	62.10%
MEDIAN	74.51%	74.14%	74.33%

OVER P100 BILLION, BUT BELOW P1 TRILLION

East West Banking Corp.	85.72%	87.93%	85.41%
Asia United Bank Corp.	82.63%	79.07%	82.53%
Citibank NA	13.15%	9.15%	9.49%
Bank of Commerce	66.92%	72.42%	73.31%
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	36.34%	40.45%	47.45%
Philippine Bank of Communications	73.79%	77.71%	84.11%
Philippine Trust Co.	25.17%	24.25%	21.07%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	32.81%	37.73%	35.18%
Standard Chartered Bank	16.60%	19.45%	14.42%
Philippine Veterans Bank	39.63%	42.89%	46.33%
MEDIAN	37.98%	41.67%	46.89%

OVER P50 BILLION, BUT BELOW P100 BILLION

Mizuho Bank Ltd.	62.24%	67.52%	27.04%
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	73.15%	74.20%	78.66%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	4.31%	5.08%	5.04%
CTBC Bank	101.12%	93.30%	100.44%
Bank of China Ltd.	77.04%	117.77%	127.68%
Deutsche Bank AG	41.39%	32.76%	65.63%
Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	57.79%	51.70%	74.41%
MEDIAN	62.24%	67.52%	74.41%

OVER P20 BILLION, BUT BELOW P50 BILLION

ING Bank N.V.	789.46%	303.66%	248.44%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	68.49%	71.36%	60.69%

BDO Private Bank	7.36%	10.60%	8.97%
Bank of America NA	13.87%	9.57%	8.28%
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	51.09%	55.13%	31.29%
KEB Hana Bank	115.38%	112.39%	105.64%
MEDIAN	59.79%	63.25%	45.99%

P20 BILLION AND BELOW

Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	43.21%	56.00%	73.86%
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	275.78%	366.51%	222.50%
Mega International Commercial Bank	64.47%	73.09%	68.67%
Industrial Bank of Korea	331.16%	236.57%	379.62%
Shinhan Bank	208.66%	219.13%	137.63%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	3783.47%	4098.32%	12425.62%
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	627.38%	590.78%	813.49%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	8498.71%	30826.74%	12701.34%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	742.08%	500.22%	889.37%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	431.77%	869.90%	701.18%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	13.77%	13.27%	27.31%
MEDIAN	331.16%	366.51%	379.62%

GRAND MEDIAN	73.37%	73.60%	74.14%
TOTAL LOANS/TOTAL DEPOSITS	72.48%	72.28%	71.52%

STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY RATIO	STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY / TOTAL ASSETS
Q1'26	Q4'25
Q1'25	

P1 TRILLION AND OVER IN TOTAL ASSETS

BDO Unibank, Inc.	11.35%	11.91%	12.32%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	10.39%	10.76%	10.75%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	12.73%	12.78%	13.38%
Land Bank of the Philippines	6.73%	7.87%	8.59%
China Banking Corp.	8.15%	8.44%	8.68%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	9.36%	9.62%	10.54%
Security Bank Corp.	9.54%	9.66%	9.93%
Union Bank of the Philippines	14.63%	17.10%	16.29%
Philippine National Bank	17.44%	17.00%	16.46%
Development Bank of the Philippines	9.55%	9.53%	9.30%
MEDIAN	9.97%	10.21%	10.65%

OVER P100 BILLION, BUT BELOW P1 TRILLION

East West Banking Corp.	13.75%	13.93%	14.05%
Asia United Bank Corp.	16.68%	15.86%	16.04%
Citibank NA	4.88%	7.10%	4.50%
Bank of Commerce 1	1.29%	12.25%	12.83%
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	4.90%	6.64%	4.93%
Philippine Bank of Communications	11.30%	11.92%	12.85%
Philippine Trust Co.	13.60%	13.73%	12.83%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	6.26%	7.16%	7.53%
Standard Chartered Bank	6.27%	8.55%	7.01%
Philippine Veterans Bank	7.28%	9.14%	10.11%
MEDIAN	9.28%	10.53%	11.47%

OVER P50 BILLION, BUT BELOW P100 BILLION

Mizuho Bank Ltd.	19.32%	21.08%	12.48%
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	9.60%	9.91%	10.45%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	7.45%	7.45%	8.11%
CTBC Bank	13.24%	13.47%	11.69%
Bank of China Ltd.	11.66%	13.90%	16.50%
Deutsche Bank AG	3.89%	6.03%	4.95%
Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	22.73%	27.84%	27.73%
MEDIAN	11.66%	13.47%	11.69%

OVER P20 BILLION, BUT BELOW P50 BILLION

ING Bank N. V.	18.36%	29.06%	28.90%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	26.74%	22.12%	21.67%
BDO Private Bank	19.60%	25.26%	24.17%
Bank of America NA	13.65%	16.37%	14.33%
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	14.22%	12.55%	13.58%
KEB Hana Bank	25.36%	29.71%	28.97%
EDIAN	18.98%	23.69%	22.92%

P20 BILLION AND BELOW

Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	27.18%	27.49%	50.64%
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	54.60%	60.77%	53.91%
Mega International Commercial Bank	34.59%	37.89%	33.10%
Industrial Bank of Korea	42.62%	41.37%	46.41%
Shinhan Bank	46.90%	46.55%	44.91%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	38.77%	36.70%	35.20%
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	63.65%	64.08%	73.26%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	34.71%	31.49%	34.49%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	46.00%	49.82%	52.94%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	59.58%	52.41%	62.42%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	4.88%	5.09%	7.80%
MEDIAN	42.62%	41.37%	46.41%

GRAND MEDIAN 13.63% 13.81% 13.48%

TOTAL STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY/TOTAL ASSETS 10.89% 11.39% 11.56%

Stockholders' Equity to Loans Ratio STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY / TOTAL LOANS
Q1'26 Q4'25 Q1'25

P1 TRILLION AND OVER, IN TOTAL ASSETS

BDO Unibank, Inc.	17.20%	17.70%	18.32%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	19.83%	21.36%	20.63%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	18.36%	18.18%	19.48%
Land Bank of the Philippines	17.63%	21.18%	23.21%
China Banking Corp.	16.35%	17.15%	17.92%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	18.93%	19.87%	22.56%
Security Bank Corp.	21.89%	21.48%	21.62%
Union Bank of the Philippines	34.85%	35.93%	36.32%
Philippine National Bank	29.93%	30.80%	31.26%
Development Bank of the Philippines	17.95%	18.88%	18.97%
MEDIAN	18.64%	20.52%	21.13%

OVER P100 BILLION, BUT BELOW P1 TRILLION

East West Banking Corp.	20.76%	21.01%	21.88%
Asia United Bank Corp.	25.41%	24.96%	24.22%
Citibank NA	50.53%	100.84%	78.46%
Bank of Commerce	21.22%	21.60%	23.67%
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	19.37%	24.98%	17.47%
Philippine Bank of Communications	21.29%	22.03%	20.96%
Philippine Trust Co.	63.08%	66.18%	70.57%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	24.10%	30.14%	27.87%
Standard Chartered Bank	56.25%	71.10%	72.65%
Philippine Veterans Bank	21.21%	25.54%	25.80%
MEDIAN	22.69%	25.26%	25.01%

OVER P50 BILLION, BUT BELOW P100 BILLION

Mizuho Bank Ltd.	48.19%	52.89%	60.67%
Maybank Philippines, Inc.	18.39%	18.33%	19.72%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N. A.	232.97%	191.70%	214.61%

CTBC Bank	23.16%	24.13%	18.82%
Bank of China Ltd.	29.91%	29.06%	27.80%
Deutsche Bank AG	17.42%	29.77%	15.23%
Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	64.51%	86.44%	60.06%
MEDIAN	29.91%	29.77%	27.80%

OVER P20 BILLION, BUT BELOW P50 BILLION

ING Bank N. V.	50.84%	52.27%	63.28%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	59.95%	47.66%	50.58%
BDO Private Bank	429.46%	445.59%	508.00%
Bank of America NA	148.34%	249.23%	250.80%
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	51.39%	53.11%	69.82%
KEB Hana Bank	47.07%	56.50%	52.73%
MEDIAN	55.67%	54.80%	66.55%

P20 BILLION AND BELOW

Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	154.60%	145.19%	251.79%
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	63.09%	63.64%	69.70%
Mega International Commercial Bank	91.16%	98.29%	96.03%
Industrial Bank of Korea	68.62%	74.02%	82.90%
Shinhan Bank	109.86%	116.83%	104.27%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	123.92%	118.56%	177.14%
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	78.51%	92.61%	112.95%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	85.00%	48.76%	73.45%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	58.34%	70.63%	69.24%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	110.44%	86.67%	102.75%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	41.96%	45.70%	38.98%
MEDIAN	85.00%	86.67%	96.03%

GRAND MEDIAN	44.51%	46.68%	44.78%
TOTAL STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY/TOTAL LOANS	20.48%	21.45%	22.11%

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Business

Not just for the super rich: 8 in 10 DBS retail customers get dedicated wealth planning managers

Sheila Chiang

783 words

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The Straits Times

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online

English

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SINGAPORE - DBS Bank customer Lim Mei Luan was pleasantly surprised when she received an e-mail from the bank a few months ago informing her that she had been assigned a wealth planning manager.

"I thought wealth planning managers assist only high-net-worth customers," she said.

The 44-year-old small business owner has since met the manager, who helped review her financial portfolio and guided her in using digiWealth – a wealth planning platform built into the DBS digibank app. That meeting gave her the confidence to buy her first investment product with the bank, she added.

Lim is one of 3.8 million retail customers at DBS with access to a personal wealth planning manager since the bank kicked off this initiative in 2023. These eligible customers, aged between 18 and 68, make up roughly eight in 10 of the bank's retail customers.

Nelson Neo, DBS' head of retail banking and head of POSB, said his team started sending personalised e-mails to customers about the service in 2023.

"Over the past three years, we have seen more customers taking action in planning for their future, either through investments via digiWealth, or they started to plan with their wealth planning manager," said Neo.

DBS reinforces engagement by sending customers portfolio updates, market trends and policy changes that could affect their financial plans.

These nudges appear to be working, with reverse inquiries – where customers proactively reach out to their wealth planning managers – tripling in the first four months of 2026 compared with the same period a year earlier.

Nearly one million customers of DBS and its subsidiary POSB now actively invest or hold insurance products through the bank.

DBS aims to double that number by 2030.

The bank also saw growing appetite for more sophisticated investment and insurance solutions. The number of retail customers who opted to "upgrade" to the DBS Treasures segment – reserved for customers with at least \$350,000 in investible assets – rose 130 per cent year on year in the first quarter of 2026.

To cater to this growing affluent segment, DBS said it will open two new Treasures centres in Singapore by the end of 2027, adding to its existing three branches.

This comes as all three local banks are aggressively pivoting to wealth management to offset lower profits from lending on the back of lower interest rates.

At OCBC Bank and UOB, dedicated relationship managers are typically assigned to only clients in the affluent and higher-tier segments, although retail customers can also visit their bank's branches to request advice from a relationship manager.

The human touch

At DBS, more than 70 per cent of its 700 wealth planning managers actively refer customers to digiWealth, where they can invest in products such as unit trusts and exchange-traded funds on their own.

But the bank said access to human advisers remains just as important.

DBS head of digiWealth Jamie Lee said customers often seek deeper conversations that extend beyond investing, including discussions about major life goals such as buying a home or starting a family as well as long-term financial planning. Wealth planning managers, she said, play a key role in these discussions.

This strategy appears to be paying off, as retail wealth revenue almost doubled from 2023 to 2025.

"The initiative enabled us to reach customers much further than other banks and that's why we decided that retail wealth was a viable strategy," said Lee.

DBS senior wealth planning manager Javier Teo, who sees about 15 to 20 retail customers a week, said a common struggle among customers is the difficulty in navigating the vast amount of financial information available online.

"They would come to us to cross-check certain information, so that they can get a fresh perspective from trained financial advisers and wealth planning managers with the bank," he said.

The 28-year-old, who has been with DBS for nearly two years, works with customers ranging from young adults focused on building wealth to seniors planning for retirement and succession.

He said it can be challenging to help some customers understand more complex financial concepts and products.

But he strives to provide clear, actionable advice that aligns with their life goals, financial situation and risk appetite, while ensuring they fully understand the risks and fees involved.

Teo also hopes to correct a common misconception among customers that they need to have a certain sum of money before they can start investing.

"We want our customers to start investing, no matter how small," he said.

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Companies

Singapore banks' rout on China's wealth-flow scrutiny 'overblown': Maybank

Deon Loke

552 words

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STBT

print

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English

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THE recent dumping of Singapore bank shares on concerns of a possible slowdown in **wealth management** growth in North Asia was "overdone", Maybank Securities said on Thursday (Jun 11).

Over the past week, DBS fell 4.6 per cent, OCBC declined 5 per cent and UOB slid 2.3 per cent on news of China's tightening of fund outflows and a broader artificial intelligence-linked pullback across global markets.

Given the Singapore banking trio's focus on **wealth management** as a growth engine – for instance, DBS plans to open 18 new and 36 upgraded wealth centres across the Asia-Pacific by 2027 – some analysts fear the tighter framework could hinder the strategy.

In 2025, North Asia accounted for 22 per cent of profit before tax for DBS, 18 per cent for OCBC and 7 per cent for UOB, Maybank noted.

China's State Council Order No 837, which takes effect on Jul 1, could restrict North Asian **wealth management** pipelines.

The new regulations will for the first time bring resident individuals within mainland China under the official scope of outbound investment filings and security reviews.

The move prompted JPMorgan to downgrade DBS to "neutral" on Wednesday. However, Maybank analyst Thilan Wickramasinghe is maintaining a "positive" rating on Singapore banks, arguing that the direct impact should be limited.

"Onshore Chinese wealth is not a client segment for Singapore banks," he said. "Offshore capital, which is the key segment in North Asia, should be unaffected by the new rules."

Maybank said the regulations appear targeted at closing unregulated outbound flows from China, rather than stopping all outbound wealth movements.

The brokerage believes the key policy objective is to bring flows into approved and compliant channels, which is "supportive of China's own ambition of internationalising the renminbi".

The new rules are aimed mainly at China residents living in mainland China, it added – a segment Singapore banks are not licensed to serve.

The lenders' focus remains on offshore Chinese wealth, including clients whose wealth is generated outside China, or who have businesses, assets or family offices in Hong Kong, Singapore or other overseas markets – not mainland residents.

Such residents already face restrictions on moving wealth out of China, making these rules "more an extension of existing controls, rather than a completely new restriction on a major client segment for Singapore banks", Wickramasinghe said.

Furthermore, while local lenders have been expanding their North Asian wealth investments recently, Maybank understands that the larger proportion of assets under management is still from Singapore and South-east Asia.

Overall, the sector fundamentals remain solid, with “strong execution, asset quality and regional growth” in view. Maybank views the recent stock price weakness as an opportunity to accumulate shares.

“The fundamental drivers of strong execution, asset quality, fee growth, net interest margins bottoming and rising credit demand keep our positive outlook unchanged,” the brokerage said, naming DBS and OCBC as top picks in the report.

It highlighted OCBC for “delivering synergies under One OCBC” – the group’s unified strategy – and shifting its strategic focus to Asean, which the brokerage believes should further limit North Asia uncertainty.

Meanwhile, it favours DBS for continuing to offer “strong capital returns visibility and scale-led execution”.

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HSBC Private Bank launches HSBC Access

Distributed by Contify.com

697 words

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Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * HSBC Access offers institutional-grade solutions, exclusive investment opportunities, and specialist insights.
- * Eligible clients can invest in selected technology and start-up companies through HSBC Innovation Banking.
- * HSBC Access provides a range of investment opportunities, including direct investments and venture capital funds.

Original Press Release:

June 9 -- HSBC Private Bank issued the following news release:

HSBC Private Bank has launched HSBC Access, a proposition designed to give ultra-high net worth (UHNW) and family office clients access to institutional-grade solutions, exclusive investment opportunities and specialist insights.

Eligible clients can invest in selected technology and start-up companies served by HSBC Innovation Banking. This is the first time HSBC Private Bank clients have been able to access this type of opportunity since HSBC Innovation Banking was launched in 2023.¹

HSBC Access offers a range of investment opportunities, including direct investments, co-investments, exclusive private market opportunities and venture capital funds, some of which were previously available only to institutional clients. These opportunities are sourced from HSBC's Corporate and Institutional Banking and Innovation Banking businesses, and are managed and distributed through HSBC's UHNW Solutions Group.

In addition, HSBC Access provides specialist insights and intelligence from across our corporate, trade and innovation banking businesses. The proposition also facilitates curated introductions to individuals and businesses, such as founders of technology start-ups, strengthening HSBC's support for the innovation ecosystem.

As the world's largest trade bank, HSBC has unrivalled access to the real economy, with over 5,000 trade specialists in more than 50 markets. HSBC Innovation Banking operates at the centre of the global innovation economy, capturing around 70 per cent of global venture capital flows.

Following its initial roll-out in Hong Kong, HSBC Access will be launched in more markets to meet the needs of ultra-high net worth clients around the world.

Ida Liu, CEO of HSBC Private Bank, said: "Our UHNW and family office clients want to be closer to the companies, founders and opportunities shaping the innovation economy. HSBC Access gives them a direct route to selected private investment opportunities, backed by the insight, connections and full strength of HSBC's global network."

Jo Miyake, Head of Banking, Asia and Middle East Corporate and Institutional Banking, HSBC, said: "HSBC Access is an important step in supporting business owners and the innovation ecosystem to expand and grow. It will help widen the pool of long-term, informed capital available to entrepreneurs and high-growth companies, while bringing additional expertise and connections to help innovative businesses scale and accelerate progress."

At the launch of HSBC Access in Hong Kong (from left to right): Lok Yim, Regional Head, **Private Bank**, Asia Pacific, HSBC ; Oliver Kadhim, Head of Institutional Client Group, Asia, Corporate and Institutional Banking, HSBC ; Michelle Owen, Global Head of Distribution, **Private Bank**, HSBC ; Jonathan Yip, Head of Innovation Banking, Asia, HSBC ; and Kanas Chan, Head of **Private Bank**, North Asia and Hong Kong, HSBC .

Notes to Editors

1 HSBC Innovation Banking combines the innovation expertise and bespoke financial services of SVB UK, which HSBC acquired in March 2023. HSBC acquired in March 2023 Open In New Window, with newly assembled HSBC innovation teams in 10 of the world's leading innovation hubs: the UK, US, India, Singapore, Australia, New Zealand, Israel, Continental Europe, Hong Kong and mainland China, supported by a network of more than 900 internationally connected sector experts.

About HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy.

www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc , the parent company of HSBC , is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 56 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,306 billion at 31 March 2026, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Asset and Wealth Management, Investment Banking, New Offerings, Investments, Innovation]

Source: HSBC **Private Bank**

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Companies & Markets

OCBC to offer physical gold trading services for institutional, BOS private banking clients from Jun 10

Jermaine Fok

569 words

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Business Times Singapore

STBT

online

English

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[SINGAPORE] From Wednesday (Jun 10), OCBC will offer its institutional clients and high-net-worth customers of its private banking arm Bank of Singapore (BOS) physical gold trading services, the bank announced on Monday.

Eligible clients will be able to buy, sell and custodise the precious metal through OCBC and store their holdings in a Singapore-based vault.

The move comes as OCBC strengthens its precious metals offerings amid rising global demand for physical gold and growing client preference for transacting and holding bullion locally.

Two sizes of gold bars – large bars of about 400 troy ounces, which are 12.4 kg each and kilobars each weighing 1 kg – will be made available.

The bars will be allocated to individual clients and identifiable through serial numbers, allowing investors to own specific bars rather than gain exposure through pooled reserves under an unallocated gold structure.

The new capability also enables BOS clients – who previously transacted in physical gold through a US-based entity – to do so through OCBC.

The physical gold offering forms part of the bank's broader push to strengthen its group-wide gold proposition under its "Next Frontier" corporate strategy, which seeks to deepen its whole-of-wealth offering across banking, wealth management and insurance.

This comes as clients have increasingly expressed interest in storing bullion locally and transacting through Singapore-based entities amid heightened geopolitical tensions and macroeconomic uncertainty, OCBC said.

The lender cited data from the World Gold Council showing that global demand for gold bars rose 50 per cent year on year in Q1 2026.

Reflecting this trend, physical gold holdings among BOS clients have grown more than 40 per cent since end-2025, with the majority of holdings belonging to ultra-high-net-worth clients.

Kenneth Lai, head of global markets at OCBC, said the bank will continue exploring opportunities to extend physical gold and other gold-linked investment and hedging solutions to additional customer segments over time.

Current services

Beyond physical bullion, OCBC has expanded its broader gold investment ecosystem across the group.

Besides fractional gold and silver investments available through the OCBC app, Lion Global Investors launched the LionGlobal Singapore Physical Gold Fund last year, which is Singapore's first physical gold-backed fund that is insured and vaulted locally.

Building on this, the LionGlobal Singapore Physical Gold ETF – Singapore's first home-grown physical gold exchange-traded fund – debuted on the Singapore Exchange in March this year.

More recently, in April, the OCBC-LionGlobal Physical Gold Fund Token was also launched for institutional investors – including banks, hedge funds and asset managers – as well as corporate accredited investors.

The bank said the product is South-east Asia's first tokenised physical gold fund available on a public blockchain.

Clients may also gain exposure to physical gold through investment-linked policies offered by Great Eastern through the GreatLink Singapore Physical Gold Fund, which invests directly in the LionGlobal Singapore Physical Gold Fund.

Jason Moo , CEO of BOS , said that amid market volatility and geopolitical uncertainty, clients are becoming more deliberate about who they transact with and where their gold is stored.

"By leveraging OCBC Group's strengths, we will be able to deliver a secure, trusted and differentiated physical gold offering that addresses our clients' risk concerns," he added.

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Wealth

Private banks turn to health, wellness and education offerings to stand out in **wealth management**

MEERA PATHMANATHAN

802 words

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Business Times Singapore

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As competition for clients intensifies, **private banks** in Singapore are providing lifestyle offerings for affluent clients beyond their traditional **wealth-management** services.

Healthcare access, concierge services and even education advisory are among the services they have rolled out.

The shift reflects how banks are trying to differentiate themselves in an increasingly crowded **wealth management** market and the race to attract and retain high-net-worth individuals (HNWIs).

In a survey of 100 HNWIs in Singapore by HSBC Life, 43 cited healthcare services as a priority. These respondents were part of a wider survey of 908 HNWIs in nine Asia-Pacific markets.

Michael Wei, chief partnership distribution officer at HSBC Life Singapore, said: "For high-net-worth families, wealth planning is about intention, continuity and long-term stewardship rather than short-term outcomes."

With an eye on the long term, some **private banks** are betting on health and wellness offerings; others are focusing on family and next-generation services such as education planning.

HSBC Singapore on May 11 launched an integrated health, wellness and longevity offering for its Premier and Premier Elite clients.

This includes priority healthcare access through a round-the-clock concierge service run by private healthcare services provider IHH Healthcare, preventive care through tailored health-screening packages and longevity-focused wellness programmes.

More holistic view

Ashmita Acharya, head of international wealth and premier banking at HSBC Singapore, said that clients are increasingly taking a "more holistic view of wealth, looking beyond financial outcomes" towards "wellness and healthy longevity".

"With longer lifespans and rising healthcare expectations, clients are placing more emphasis on prevention, quality of care and longevity alongside retirement and legacy planning," she added.

HSBC Premier and Premier Elite customers must maintain a minimum total relationship balance of S\$200,000 and S\$1.2 million, respectively.

Citigroup, meanwhile, has tied up with education consultancies Crimson Education, ED-SG and Onwards Education Consultancy to give its Citigold Private Client customers access to education planning services.

Clients can receive guidance on international education planning, programme selection and university admissions to universities around the world.

The partnerships, which began in March, run until the end of 2027.

Praise Tan, country manager of Crimson Education Singapore, said that the consultancy specialises in admissions to top US and UK universities, particularly the Ivy League and Oxbridge, although it also supports applications to other leading institutions globally.

She added that Crimson Education offers complimentary initial consultations to help families identify “the right fit and target schools”, and assess the prospective student’s profile to understand the level of admissions support needed.

Longer-term support

While one session is “usually sufficient for an initial strategic overview and road map”, families hoping to land places in highly selective universities may require longer-term support focused on “academic planning, extracurricular strategy, university selection, essays, interview preparation and application management”, she said.

Gourab Kundu, head of digital growth and wealth continuum for Asia South at Citi Wealth, said the bank believes that supporting broader life goals fosters “emotional currency”, which helps in attracting and retaining clients.

Citigold Private Client customers typically need to have at least S\$1.5 million in assets under management.

OCBC has also expanded its offerings for affluent clients through its collaboration with insurance arm Great Eastern, with the launch of Great Eastern Private in March.

Susan Tan, head of group segment at OCBC, said the collaboration gives the bank’s Premier Banking and Premier Private Client customers with eligible Great Eastern policies access to “a curated suite of health and wellness benefits”, including tailored medical check-ups.

Great Eastern Private’s Private Client Privileges programme covers seven areas: next-generation leadership, family advisory and trust services, health and longevity, international tax advisory, legal advisory, philanthropy, and global lifestyle concierge services.

The insurer introduced the Hewton Fair Suite, a dedicated client space within Great Eastern Centre, for HNWIs. The suite includes an on-site medical facility operated by Raffles Medical Group, which provides same-day health assessments along with healthy longevity and medi-wellness services.

Greg Hingston, group CEO of Great Eastern, said that Great Eastern Private aims to support clients “in every stage of life and across generations”.

To qualify for OCBC Premier Banking and Premier Private Client, customers must maintain assets under management of at least S\$350,000 and S\$1.5 million, respectively.

Very encouraging response

Private banks are likely to continue serving up such services.

Kundu said that Citi clients have been very interested in the offerings; Acharya described the response of HSBC clients as “very encouraging”.

“Health and wealth will become a single, interconnected ecosystem, with longevity and preventive healthcare woven into **wealth management**,” Acharya added.

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Wealth

Private banks turn to health, wellness and education offerings to stand out in **wealth management**

Meera Pathmanathan

794 words

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Business Times Singapore

STBT

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English

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[SINGAPORE] As competition for clients intensifies, **private banks** in Singapore are providing lifestyle offerings for affluent clients beyond their traditional **wealth-management** services.

Healthcare access, concierge services and even education advisory are among the services they have rolled out.

The shift reflects how banks are trying to differentiate themselves in an increasingly crowded **wealth management** market and the race to attract and retain high-net-worth individuals (HNWIs).

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HSBC Swiss Unit Charged In French Probe Into \$330M Lebanese Central Bank Embezzlement Case

457 words

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Forbes Middle East Online

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English

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France has charged the Swiss subsidiary of HSBC with money laundering and criminal conspiracy in connection with a probe into former Lebanese central bank governor Riad Salameh , the country's National Financial Prosecutor's Office confirmed on Thursday.

What HSBC is accused of

HSBC **Private Bank** Suisse was charged with organized money laundering and conspiracy to commit offenses, including embezzlement of public funds, breach of trust, and bribery of a public official, Le Monde reported the news earlier.

The bank was required to deposit \$87 million (€80 million) as bail, partly due to potential future damages and interest it may have to cover.

The charges followed two days of questioning by two investigating judges handling the French proceedings. Le Monde first reported the charges on May 6, with the prosecutor's office confirming it publicly on June 4.

The French judiciary suspects HSBC 's Swiss **private banking** arm of having helped Salameh embezzle more than \$330 million, currently equivalent to \$308 million (€283 million), from Lebanon's central bank , Banque du Liban , between 2002 and 2015.

The alleged scheme worked through commissions paid by Lebanese commercial banks for the purchase of financial products from Banque du Liban . Those commissions were transferred by the central bank to an entity described as a broker, Forry Associates Ltd.

When [Salameh](#) signed the contract with Forry in 2002, he allegedly failed to disclose that he was the true beneficial owner of the offshore company. The money then flowed through accounts that French investigators believe HSBC **Private Bank** Suisse facilitated.

The investigation was launched in July 2021 following a complaint by the anti-corruption group Sherpa and the Collective of Victims of Fraudulent and Criminal Practices in Lebanon.

Who is Riad Salameh

[Salameh](#) headed Lebanon's central bank for three decades until 2023 and is widely regarded as a central figure in Lebanon's catastrophic economic collapse, which began in late 2019 and wiped out the savings of millions of ordinary Lebanese citizens. He also holds French citizenship.

In May 2023, a French judge issued an international arrest warrant for Salameh. He has repeatedly denied any wrongdoing, saying his wealth comes from private investment and his earlier career at the American investment firm Merrill Lynch .

French authorities have not charged him directly as he did not respond to a French judge's summons, and Lebanon does not extradite its citizens.

[Salameh](#) was detained by Lebanese authorities in September 2024 and charged with embezzlement and money laundering.

At the start of 2026, Lebanese authorities ordered he stand trial for embezzling \$44 million, according to a Lebanese judicial source. His brother Raja was charged in France in August 2024 and released on bail.

Document FRBEN00020260605em65000dz

Business

DBS to open 2 new wealth centres in S'pore to better serve affluent customers

Sheila Chiang

569 words

2 June 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

print

A15

English

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DBS' affluent and high-net-worth customers in Singapore will be able to access two new wealth centres here by the end of 2027, in a move to meet increasing demand for **wealth management** services.

The two new wealth centres will add to three existing DBS Treasures centres – at Marina Bay Financial Centre, Siglap and Ngee Ann City – which offer **wealth management** services.

When asked, a DBS spokesperson said more details on the new wealth centres in Singapore, including their locations, will be announced later.

The minimum investible assets requirement to be a DBS Treasures client in Singapore is \$350,000.

The roll-out is part of 18 upcoming DBS wealth centres across four core markets – Singapore, Hong Kong, mainland China and India – in what the bank called the largest physical expansion of its wealth franchise so far.

The first few wealth centres are expected to open in the third quarter of 2026, with phased roll-outs continuing through 2027, the bank said on June 1.

On top of the new wealth centres, South-east Asia's largest bank by assets will also upgrade 36 existing wealth centres across Asia in the next 18 months.

The wealth centres will enable the bank to serve its clients through a range of services, ranging from portfolio advisory to access to sophisticated wealth solutions.

The centres will also hold more dedicated spaces for meetings between relationship managers and clients, said DBS.

DBS said that more affluent clients are seeking professional advice and guidance to grow, protect and pass on their wealth. Even as investors increasingly switch to digital platforms to manage their wealth, face-to-face meetings still remain important for many of them, it said.

The announcement comes as Asia's affluent segment – households with US\$100,000 (S\$128,000) to US\$1 million in investible assets – is growing at an exponential rate, with the wealth pool projected to hit US\$4.7 trillion by 2026, up from US\$2.7 trillion in 2021.

In a statement, DBS group head of consumer banking Sanjoy Sen said: "A wealth relationship today is not measured in years but in generations. The client who opens an investment account with us in his or her 20s could be the founder we serve through their 40s and the family office principal we work with in their 70s."

Sen said: "What clients tell us, more than anything else, is that the relationship they want with their bank should feel personal, familiar and close to home.

"That is true, whether they are opening their first investment account in Hong Kong, planning succession in Singapore or navigating cross-border wealth from Taipei."

The latest development comes as Singapore's banks are increasingly pivoting to **wealth management**, as falling interest rates reduce profits from lending.

DBS' net profit for the first quarter of 2026 grew 1 per cent to \$2.93 billion, driven by record fee income from its **wealth management** business.

The bank's wealth assets under management reached \$492 billion in the first quarter of 2026, nearly surpassing the bank's publicly stated \$500 billion target by end-2026.

Additionally, up to 40 per cent of the bank's new private banking clients have been existing customers who have moved up the wealth ladder.

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Companies & Markets

DBS to open 18 new and 36 upgraded wealth centres across Apac by 2027

Derryn Wong

511 words

1 June 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

online

English

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[SINGAPORE] DBS will open 18 new and 36 upgraded wealth centres across Asia-Pacific by the end of 2027, in what the lender called the largest physical expansion of its wealth franchise to date.

The centres will be located in Singapore, Hong Kong, China, India, Indonesia and Taiwan, the bank said on Monday (Jun 1), with the first to open in the third quarter of 2026.

DBS did not elaborate on the cost of upgrading and expanding its network of regional wealth centres.

Sanjoy Sen, group head of consumer banking at DBS, said the move will not only strengthen the bank's network, but also bring it closer to its customers.

"What clients tell us, more than anything else, is that the relationship they want with their bank should feel personal, familiar and close to home," he said.

"These wealth centres are not just about expanding our footprint. They are about closing the distance between our clients and the relationship managers who serve them – meeting them where they live, where they work and where they build their lives," he added.

In Singapore and Hong Kong – which are the bank's two largest markets – the centres will serve its Treasures clients. In China, India, Indonesia and Taiwan, the centres will serve Treasures and Treasures Private Client customers.

Going with the flow

The bank said the move will increase its Treasures' wealth centre presence by 50 per cent.

Treasures is the bank's priority banking and **wealth management** service. In Singapore, the minimum investment threshold to qualify for the service is S\$350,000.

Treasures Private Client is a higher tier service, requiring S\$1.5 million of investable assets, but which sits below the Private Bank service, which is for individuals with S\$5 million or more.

DBS said that as investors switch to digital **wealth management** platforms, in-person meetings are still important for many of them, with more than 40 per cent in Hong Kong and Singapore continuing to meet relationship managers face-to-face.

This comes as **wealth management** and other fee income becomes an increasingly important source of revenue for Singapore banks, helping to offset expected reductions in net interest income as interest rates dip.

Singapore's three main banks – DBS, OCBC and UOB – combined non-interest income rose to a record S\$5.16 billion in Q1, from S\$4 billion in the preceding quarter and S\$4.78 billion a year earlier.

For DBS, net fee and commission income in Q1 climbed 16 per cent to a record S\$1.5 billion. This growth was propelled by **wealth management** fees reaching a record S\$907 million, supported by robust bancassurance and investment product sales.

Research from consulting firm McKinsey said high and ultra-high net worth individuals in Apac will transfer about US\$5.8 trillion in assets between 2023 and 2030, presenting a major opportunity for banks, family offices and other asset managers.

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HSBC Private Bank: Q3 2026 Investment Outlook – Where capital meets the future

Distributed by Contify.com

680 words

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Contify Banking News

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English

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC **Private Bank** remains optimistic about the global economy's resilience and expects manageable volatility.

* The bank outlines a portfolio strategy focused on AI, energy independence, and aerospace themes.

* HSBC **Private Bank** prioritizes investing in AI, positioning for security and energy independence, and building portfolio resilience.

Original Press Release:

May 27 -- HSBC **Private Bank** issued the following news release:

AI, energy and security are set to drive the next wave of strategic investment and support global economic and corporate earnings growth, according to HSBC **Private Bank**.

Rising global competition and national security priorities are creating the urgency, funding and policy support needed to sustain capital market activities. The bank also expects an expanded role for private markets to supplement the investment funding gap.

In its Q3 2026 Investment Outlook, HSBC **Private Bank** remains optimistic about the resilience of the global economy and expects volatility to be manageable. Drawing on lessons from the COVID-19 shock and shifting international trade dynamics, the bank cites that governments and businesses have been diversifying supply chains, trade relationships and energy sources to support economic growth.

Willem Sels, Global Chief Investment Officer, HSBC **Private Bank** and Premier Wealth, said: "Volatility is here to stay as global markets react to fast-moving risks and headlines. The priority is to stay disciplined with resilient and diversified multi-asset portfolios that can withstand short-term uncertainty, while keeping sight of longer-term opportunities emerged from structural growth trends."

Against this backdrop, the bank outlines a portfolio strategy focused on longer-term tailwinds relating to AI, energy independence and aerospace themes for its high net worth and ultra high net worth clients. The approach highlights opportunities in technology, industrials, materials and utilities sectors, where investment in innovation remains strong and continues to favour growth-style over value companies.

This quarter's outlook also expects the US Federal Reserve to keep policy rates on hold throughout 2026, reflecting the balance between inflation and growth risks.

HSBC **Private Bank**'s four priorities for Q3 2026:

* Invest in the AI-led future: Strong earnings surprises, easing monetisation concerns and attractive valuations after the software sell-off present opportunities in semiconductors, data centres and AI adopters.

* Position for security and energy independence: Geopolitical shifts are accelerating efforts to diversify energy supply, expand electrification and increase grid investment.

* Build portfolio resilience with multi-asset strategies: Bonds, gold, alternatives and currency diversification remain core building blocks, complemented by infrastructure to provide stable, inflation-linked cashflows.

* Tap into Asia's innovation and income opportunities: A barbell strategy can capture Asia's innovation-led investment cycle while balancing with income opportunities, paired with a geographical overweight in mainland China, Hong Kong, Singapore and South Korea.

Patrick Ho, Chief Investment Officer, North Asia, HSBC **Private Bank** and Premier Wealth, said: "As investment in AI accelerates globally, Asia is well placed to benefit given its leadership in semiconductors and rapid progress in large language models. Beyond AI, investors can also find a broadening opportunity set through income potential in bonds, alongside continued improvements in corporate governance reforms across Japan, South Korea, mainland China and Singapore."

The bank adds that geopolitical developments are contributing to an uneven economic landscape, further stressing the importance of distinguishing potential winners and losers across issuers, sectors and regions.

About HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy.

www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 56 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,306 billion at 31 March 2026, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Aerospace, Defense and Security, Energy, Technology, Economy]

Source: HSBC **Private Bank**

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Business

HSBC Hong Kong targets 7.5 million customers, same number as city's population

Enoch Yiu

751 words

26 May 2026

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SCMCOM

English

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HSBC Hong Kong sees an increase in international clients coming to city to invest as it becomes a global **wealth management** hub

[HSBC](#) is targeting an increase in its Hong Kong client base to match the city's population of 7.5 million, a goal to be driven mainly by international investors, according to its Hong Kong CEO Maggie Ng.

Hong Kong has already seen almost 2 million new customers sign up to the HSBC Hong Kong office over the past two years, bringing its total customers to 7 million at the end of last year.

"It is my short-term target to see the total customers reach 7.5 million. As Hong Kong only has a population of 7.5 million, we have to attract more international investors to come to invest here for us to achieve such a target," she said in a media briefing on Friday.

Do you have questions about the biggest topics and trends from around the world? Get the answers with [SCMP Knowledge](#), our new platform of curated content with explainers, FAQs, analyses and infographics brought to you by our award-winning team.

Hong Kong has become a [global **wealth management** hub](#), with a strong stock market and a growing insurance sector that can serve both mainland Chinese and international investors, she said, citing a study by GlobalData that found 15 million wealthy mainland Chinese customers with a need for offshore **wealth management** services.

"Globally, international investors are seeking diversification of their investment and to achieve growth opportunities in Hong Kong. The future growth opportunities are huge," she said.

Geopolitical tensions, particularly the conflict in the Middle East, have prompted investors to diversify, with Hong Kong seen as a "safe harbour", [Financial Secretary Paul Chan Mo-po](#) said last month.

Since 2023, the Hong Kong government has introduced tax incentives and other measures to encourage wealthy global customers to set up local family offices in the city to manage their wealth.

Ng said the strong stock market sentiment in recent years has also encouraged more international high-net-worth customers to invest here to tap the growing opportunities. The Hang Seng Index gained 28 per cent in 2025, after rising 18 per cent in 2024, making it one of the world's best-performing major indexes over the past two years.

The index's performance was volatile this year, however, as the [US-Israeli war on Iran](#) began in late February, leading the market to slump in recent months and wiping out gains from the first two months of the year. Still, Ng said the bank found many wealthy customers continue to invest in Hong Kong investment products and insurance policies.

"[The] Hong Kong market remains resilient this year as the capital market here is more stable than the other markets," she said.

HSBC saw its deposits rise 9 per cent year on year in 2025, while assets under management by new customers rose 30 per cent. To support the wealth business, HSBC last week opened its fifth luxury **wealth management** centre at Two IFC, with 13,000 sq ft and 34 meeting rooms with harbour views.

The bank has also invested heavily in its AI to serve customers and support its bankers in serving clients, but it has no goal to replace staff with it. Its rival Standard Chartered last week [announced](#) a 15 per cent cut of back-office staff by 2030 due to AI automation.

“HSBC focuses on how AI can grow our business instead of cost-cutting,” she said. “We also aimed at providing more digital banking tools to serve our customers.”

The lender has seen 63 per cent of clients using digital banking apps to open accounts, apply for credit cards or open time deposits this year, while 86 per cent of customers use digital channels to buy stocks and fund products, she said.

The challenges, she said, would be the low interest rate, which erodes profit from its mortgage and other interest income.

The lender also faced rising bad debt provisions in [local commercial real estate](#) last year, but Ng said the situation has improved this year with [rising](#) property prices.

“Our house view is that the property price would increase by 7 per cent this year. I do not think the credit quality is a big concern as the economy and the property market of Hong Kong remain stable,” she said.

Document SCMCOM0020260526em5q0002v

DBS' Carol Wu: AI won't replace team heads, but helps manage more RMs

Priyanka Boghani

1,177 words

24 May 2026

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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DBS is often known as an early adopter of technology in its core operations. It is therefore not surprising that its North Asia **private banking** head Carol Wu has said agentic AI is at a level where it can perform tasks like its team leaders, helping them manage more bankers.

The Singaporean bank has embedded AI into tools like 'Wealth Co-Pilot', giving its relationship managers detailed client oversight, identifying if a client's allocation aligns with its CIO recommendations, she tells Citywire Asia. Its control towers provide real-time data on business drivers and customer indicators, enabling timely interventions and guiding the bank's AI development priorities.

'Can our control towers replace a team head's position? No, but it will help managers manage more efficiently based on data in a structured way,' Wu (pictured) said.

The question comes at a time when team heads have been under the microscope as **private banks** look to cut costs by reducing organisational layers. Standard Chartered and HSBC have just announced plans to cull 7,000 to 20,000 jobs across their back office hubs by accelerating the adoption of AI and automation.

Wu said AI can help improve relationship manager and team head efficiency, providing real-time data on net new money and performance down to the individual relationship manager, doing away with manual spreadsheets.

'We can have one team leader manage more RMs and one RM can manage more clients,' she said.

As AI becomes increasingly embedded into the operations of **private banks**, the current strategy of hiring bankers in droves to grow assets under management via new clients will need to change as well.

North Asia business bump

The North Asia head reports client assets trending upward in the past few years particularly for existing clients who have benefited from Hong Kong's capital markets revival

'North Asia has been growing very strongly over the past few years,' Wu noted. 'This trend has continued because the macro trend is favourable to Hong Kong and Singapore.'

Hong Kong's resurgent IPO market raised HK\$151.4 bn (\$19.3bn) in the first four months of 2026, a staggering 604% increase compared to the same period last year, helping fuel a 16.5% year-on-year surge in the benchmark Hang Seng index.

When it comes to netting new clients, Wu said the bank has received interest from clients who previously used European and US banks as their primary providers. They are now shifting towards Asian banks as their main **private bank** to 'diversify away from the US and European hubs,' she said.

Wu added that the wealth continuum has also contributed new clients to the bank. The mechanism identifies clients with **private banking** 'potential' and introduces them to higher-tier services and it has translated into new business for North Asia and Asia more broadly.

'We are also seeing more inquiries on setting up family offices in Hong Kong and Singapore from the Middle East as well,' she added. 'The asset transfer hasn't happened but there are more questions about how to open accounts and set up firms using various schemes.'

The bank has carried out more events in Hong Kong focused on family offices and succession planning and she said clients are also broaching topics that were once 'sensitive', such as divorce and sibling conflicts.

As a result, DBS is seeing an equal inflow from both existing and new clients, Wu said.

Highs on hires

Though it typically takes longer to translate into business, hiring has also been a pillar of the North Asia growth strategy, Wu said.

'Quite a big portion of our AUM growth came from hires in 2024 and 2025,' she said, adding the bank hired aggressively in Hong Kong in 2024 and focused on new talent in Singapore in 2025.

DBS had a target of hiring around 40 **private bankers** in Hong Kong and Singapore, according to a media report last June, where Wu noted the uptick in interest from mainland Chinese and Taiwanese clients looking to diversify their assets offshore. The bank previously hired more than 50 RMs in Hong Kong in 2024.

In 2026, she said the focus will be on hiring more Treasures Private Client (TPC) relationship managers, looking at building a pipeline of bankers with mainland Chinese backgrounds through various talent schemes.

DBS TPC is a wealth tier that sits below the **private bank**, where investors need to have a minimum of S\$1.5m (\$1.2m) in assets.

Private equity pickup and insurance drive

While the adoption of private credit has slowed down this year, Wu noted that semi-liquid strategies are still popular among clients and private equity funds have seen inflows.

'Healthcare funds in particular have piqued interest, and we have received a lot of enquiries about this space,' she said. 'It is a trend that rides on longevity and some that people resonate with more and more.'

The [healthcare private equity](#) field particularly drew attention after Covid pandemic, where concern around health and longevity came to the fore.

Insurance too has contributed positively to the bank's revenues, in line with [other private banks](#) in the industry, as wealthy clients turn to life products for their tax efficiency and wealth planning utility.

Wu said the **private bank**'s insurance business growth has grown 'tremendously' over the past three years, adding the trend, which started in Singapore, is now also spreading to Hong Kong.

'There was a \$300m insurance solution that was done by my team in Singapore,' she said. 'We are [now also] seeing this trend in Hong Kong as clients are doing more mega solution deals as part of their wealth planning. We are seeing clients view insurance solutions from two perspectives; a stable saving plans for their second generation and a protection plan.'

Interestingly, new enquiries regarding insurance for art collections is growing, Wu noted.

Indeed, the art and sports spaces have become increasingly popular among **private banking** clients in Asia, with some banks launching services or funds targeting them.

Last year, DBS **Private Bank** rolled out a sports fund with Ares. The investment thesis revolves around buying the ancillary media and entertainment assets around sports, as buying teams and franchises outright makes the barrier to entry too high for the average high net worth client. Experts warned, however, that it is still a 'niche strategy' or a 'trophy asset' that may not make it as mainstream.

'We do see some interest from our sports fund, but I do think clients need to be more educated and familiar with this investment opportunity, despite the ongoing interest. We continue to engage with clients on the fund.'

Meanwhile, hedge funds and commodities such as gold are contributing to the bank's AUM growth, as clients seek opportunities in hedge positions amid bouts of market volatility. Wu said while the AUM from these strategies is still less than 10%, from an absolute amount it is a big jump.

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HSBC PB appoints new onshore Taiwan market head

Shi Jie Ching

222 words

22 May 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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HSBC **Private Bank** has promoted from within to appoint a market head for Taiwan, as it looks to strengthen its onshore franchise.

Edward Chiu, taking on the new role, was previously head of Premier Elite at HSBC Taiwan from 2024.

Besides leading onshore **private banking** business in Taiwan, HSBC **Private Bank** said in a 22 May release that Chiu will work closely with the other lines of business to deliver 'holistic' solutions for Taiwanese clients.

HSBC said that he has a strong track record in revenue growth, talent development and client acquisition.

He will report to Kanas Chan, head of **private bank** for North Asia and Hong Kong, as well as Kevin Hu, HSBC Taiwan's head of international wealth and premier banking.

Chiu, who has 20 years of leadership experience in wealth management and affluent banking across Taiwan, has previously held senior leadership roles at DBS and Citibank.

'Taiwan is a strategically important growth market for our North Asia business,' said Chan, adding that Chiu brings expertise in serving high net worth and ultra high net worth clients.

Recently, HSBC **Private Bank** had bulked up its Southeast Asia, India and offshore China desks, with a string of senior appointments across its wealth planning, onshore Thailand, global India and China segments.

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Exclusive: Former BOS NRI market head to join HSBC

Priyanka Boghani

197 words

20 May 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Bank of Singapore's [former](#) Global South Asia market head is tipped to join HSBC **Private Bank** in Singapore along with a team of three-to-four, sources tell Citywire Asia.

Harjeet Singh will join HSBC **Private Bank** Singapore as a non-resident Indian (NRI) team head, bringing a team of three or four **private bankers** from Bank of Singapore, multiple sources said. He is slated to join in the next two months, where he will report to Gautam Anand, who was just took the [broader role](#) of head of Global India.

A spokesperson from HSBC declined to comment.

Singh was at BOS for nine years. Prior to that, he worked at BNP Paribas Wealth Management, JP Morgan and Barclays as well as HSBC in India. His departure at the Singaporean **private bank** followed a string of exits at BOS's Global South Asia team, including Nikhil Jha, as well as Balaji Dhakshinamoorthy and Sandesh Assao.

Meanwhile, HSBC **Private Bank** has seen several reshuffles to its Southeast Asia and NRI desks as well. Most recently, Urban Binggeli, Indonesia desk head and Annie Lim, Singapore desk head [departed](#).

Document CWIRAS0020260520em5k00002

Business

StanChart lifts profitability target for 2030

Enoch Yiu

641 words

20 May 2026

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B3

English

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Bank will strengthen its wealth management and cross-border businesses while using more automation, with HK at centre of its strategy

Standard Chartered has raised its 2030 profitability target to 18 per cent as it expands wealth, cross-border banking and digital businesses, with Hong Kong at the centre of its growth story, according to global CEO Bill Winters.

The London-headquartered lender, which focuses on emerging markets in Asia, the Middle East and Africa, is aiming for a 15 per cent return on tangible equity in 2028 and 18 per cent in 2030, up from 11.9 per cent in 2025.

Investors welcomed the plan, sending the bank's shares up as much as 4.4 per cent in early afternoon yesterday before closing 2.3 per cent higher at HK\$201.20. The stock outperformed the benchmark Hang Seng Index, which rose 0.5 per cent.

Growth will be driven by wealth and cross-border business, alongside a 15 per cent cut in back-office staff via automation by 2030.

Winters unveiled the new targets yesterday ahead of an investor event in Hong Kong, describing the city as "extremely important" and a "key growth driver" in Standard Chartered's strategy.

"Hong Kong is our home market. It is our biggest market and fastest-growing market," he said.

"Standard Chartered is a superconnector, connecting our clients of 55 markets to each other, and Hong Kong is at the centre of a lot of that network flow and wealth flows."

The city was no longer just a gateway to mainland China, but now played a bigger role in trade and capital flows between Asia, Europe and Africa, he added.

The investor event, co-organised by Standard Chartered and HSBC, brought about 50 global fund managers and other institutional investors to Hong Kong for presentations and social activities from yesterday through tomorrow. It was the second such event since 2023.

Geopolitical tensions, particularly in the Middle East, had prompted investors to diversify, with Hong Kong seen as a safe harbour, Financial Secretary Paul Chan Mo-po said last month.

Standard Chartered hosted its presentation at its soon-to-open wealth centre in Causeway Bay, its seventh in the city as it expands in wealth management.

The bank said it was accelerating its target of US\$200 billion in net new money for its wealth business to 2028 from 2029 previously.

It aimed for affluent income – revenue from clients with at least US\$25,000 in assets under management with the bank – to account for 75 per cent of total wealth business by 2028, up from 70 per cent at the end of last year.

The lender also expected fee income to account for more than half of total income in the coming years, up from 47 per cent now and less than 40 per cent a decade ago.

Winters said the shift was designed to generate more fee income and drive growth, as interest income remained flat in a low-rate environment.

He said the bank planned to adopt artificial intelligence and automation to reduce back-office staff worldwide by 15 per cent by 2030, cutting its cost-income ratio to 57 per cent in 2028 from 63 per cent in 2025.

"We do have job role reductions in favour of the machines, and that will accelerate as we go full-bore into AI," Winters added.

"It is not cost-cutting, but it is replacing, in some cases, lower- value human capital with the financial capital and the investment capital that we are putting in."

He also said affected staff members would be offered upgraded skill training or packages to pursue other opportunities, with the bank targeting a 20 per cent increase in income per employee by 2028.

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Document SCMP000020260519em5k0000j

Upfront

Court nod to wind up 1MDB scandal-linked entities paves way for bank claims by foreign liquidators

Tessa Oh

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THE Singapore High Court has approved applications to wind up three British Virgin Islands-incorporated entities linked to the 1Malaysia Development Berhad (1MDB) scandal, the firms' liquidators confirmed on Friday (May 15).

In a statement, the liquidators, Angela Barkhouse and Toni Shukla from Kroll, said that the winding-up orders will pave the way for them to file statutory claims against Standard Chartered Bank Singapore (StanChart) and BSI Bank's Singapore operations.

"The Singapore court's latest decision will allow the court-appointed liquidators to hold those who facilitated fraudulent acts against the companies fully to account," they noted. "The statutory claim(s) will be pursued in addition to other ongoing claims brought against these banks, which includes claims for dishonest assistance, breach of the banks' duties of reasonable skill and care, and/or breach of their banking mandate, in respect of the companies now entering liquidation in Singapore."

They added that the statutory claims will be filed "in short order".

The four entities – Alsen Chance Holdings, Brightstone Jewellery, Brazen Sky and Blackstone Asia Real Estate Partners – were placed into liquidation in the British Virgin Islands between December 2021 and March 2024 for the purposes of investigating their alleged involvement in fraudulent transactions. Their foreign liquidations were granted recognition under Singapore's cross-border insolvency framework between 2022 and 2024.

The winding-up applications were filed in November 2025 as a workaround to an earlier ruling by the Singapore court, which had found that Singapore's Model Law on cross-border insolvency barred foreign representatives from bringing avoidance claims relating to transactions that predated its introduction. By obtaining local winding-up orders, the liquidators sought to pursue those pre-2020 transactions through Singapore-appointed liquidators instead.

Barkhouse and Shukla said that the overall objective is to "recover assets from the individuals and institutions our investigations have identified as having culpability for the misappropriation of assets from the companies". They added that such assets are "ultimately traceable to funds which were originally meant to benefit the people of Malaysia but were siphoned off".

The ruling follows a separate High Court decision in March that rejected bids by StanChart and BSI Bank to intervene in the winding-up proceedings.

Justice Aidan Xu found that neither bank had standing to participate, dismissing their arguments that they qualified as contingent creditors of the British Virgin Islands entities based on the possibility of future costs orders being made against the firms.

In response to queries, a StanChart spokesperson said: "More than 13 years ago, these shell companies deceived the bank and abused its services by using their accounts to launder money misappropriated from 1MDB."

The spokesperson added that StanChart will "vigorously defend against their attempts to now obtain from the bank the money they paid away".

“Our position on these unmeritorious claims remains unchanged as set out in our (previous) statement on our website.”

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Companies

OCBC Hong Kong to raise wealth relationship manager headcount as revenue heads for double-digit growth

Renald Yeo

801 words

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OCBC'S Hong Kong franchise will hire 30 to 50 **wealth management** relationship managers in 2026, raising headcount by at least 30 per cent as it ramps up its wealth business.

The hiring push comes as OCBC Hong Kong's **wealth management** income rose 1.5 times from a year earlier in the first quarter ended Mar 31, 2026.

This was driven by growth in its customer base, with the number of premier banking customers in Hong Kong and Macau rising 22 per cent year on year, while offshore premier banking clients jumped 34 per cent.

Investment income climbed 60 per cent, while insurance income rose 38 per cent.

The lender will also open its first Premier Private Client Centre at its flagship branch in Hong Kong's Central district, said Josephine Lee, head of consumer financial services at OCBC Hong Kong, on Friday (May 15).

The centre will serve clients with at least US\$1 million in funds. To qualify as a premier banking client, customers need at least HK\$1 million, or about US\$128,000, in funds.

The wealth push comes as OCBC's Hong Kong franchise delivered a "very strong" performance in the first four months of 2026, putting it on track for double-digit revenue growth this year, said Wang Ke, the bank's head of Greater China.

"If I look at the full-year outlook – with the uncertainty still surrounding us in the external environment – I'm quite confident our top line (will) probably grow in the range of double digits," said Wang, who is also CEO of OCBC Hong Kong.

"With that, I believe our profitability will (also) be much better compared to last year," he added at a media briefing in Hong Kong, which was also streamed virtually.

For the first quarter, OCBC Hong Kong posted an 18 per cent increase in revenue to HK\$2.2 billion (S\$358.8 million). The figure includes contributions from Macau.

Operating profit rose 31 per cent in the quarter, while profit before tax surged 90 per cent. OCBC Hong Kong does not typically disclose individual non-revenue figures.

If the lender meets its full-year 2026 **wealth management** income target, it would have grown fees by five times since 2023, Wang noted.

As part of the bank's broader wealth continuum push under new OCBC CEO Tan Teck Long's "Next Frontier" strategy, the Hong Kong franchise will work closely with Bank of Singapore, OCBC's private banking arm, to refer clients as their wealth grows and they meet new thresholds, Lee added.

Wang said that if the bank maintains its current momentum and continues to grow revenue at a double-digit pace year on year, it is also "most likely" to meet its medium-term aspiration of becoming a "top 10 bank in Hong Kong" by 2030.

The target, first announced in 2024, is measured on two fronts: scale, which refers to being among the top 10 by total assets or total income; and profitability, which refers to being among the top 10 by operating profit before provisions, or profit after tax.

OCBC Hong Kong is currently ranked around 13th or 14th, depending on the metric used, Wang noted.

“(The) bottom line is: we need to take over three of our competitors in order for us to get there,” he said.

The faster pace of projected revenue growth is also expected to lift profits. Wang stressed, however, that the lender is “not cutting costs”, but that “revenue is growing much faster than the growth rate of our cost base”.

Friday’s briefing came a week after OCBC posted a 5 per cent increase in first-quarter net profit at the group level to S\$1.97 billion, exceeding the S\$1.88 billion consensus estimate in a Bloomberg survey.

This came as group total income rose 5 per cent year on year to S\$3.83 billion, driven by a 23 per cent jump in non-interest income.

Wang said Greater China accounted for 23 per cent of group operating profit in the first quarter, up from 21 per cent in the year-ago period.

On wealth flows from the Middle East, Wang said the Hong Kong franchise has fielded “some inquiries”, but has not seen “a lot of money coming over”.

Describing the implications of the ongoing conflict in the Middle East as medium-to-long term, he added: “I personally am quite certain it will benefit Hong Kong – even Singapore – as a safe haven, as a financial centre.”

Shares of OCBC fell 0.1 per cent or S\$0.02 to close at S\$22.93 on Friday.

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Business

OCBC steps up **wealth management** push in Hong Kong

Sheila Chiang

603 words

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The Straits Times

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OCBC Bank is stepping up its **wealth management** push in Hong Kong as it continues to capture growing business and investment flows between Greater China and ASEAN.

At a virtual media briefing on May 15, head of OCBC Hong Kong consumer financial services Josephine Lee said the bank will launch its premier private client banking segment later in 2026, targeting customers with at least US\$1 million (S\$1.27 million) in assets under management.

The service will be rolled out at its flagship branch in Queen's Road Central first before expanding to other key branches.

The bank will grow the number of **wealth managers** by about 30 per cent, equivalent to roughly 30 to 50 new hires, in 2026.

Artificial intelligence will be used to boost employees' efficiency while clients can benefit from faster insights and more personalised services, the bank said.

In the first quarter, its premier banking customer base across Hong Kong and Macau grew by 22 per cent compared with a year ago, said Ms Lee.

Its 2026 wealth income is expected to grow fivefold from 2023 levels, said Greater China head and chief executive Wang Ke.

Head of emerging business Ruby Yiu said new-to-bank customers in the first quarter increased by 25 per cent year on year, driven largely by mainland Chinese small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs).

She noted that mainland Chinese SMEs are increasingly using Hong Kong as their regional operating hub while eyeing expansion into ASEAN – where OCBC has strong presence and local expertise.

Wealth income from SME customers grew four times year on year, showing that SMEs today are managing not just their own cash flow but also longer-term wealth and protection needs, she said.

Mr Johnny Wei, head of wholesale banking at OCBC Hong Kong, said it is deepening network collaboration through the Hong Kong-Singapore twin-hub model, with Hong Kong being the hub of Greater China and Singapore being the hub of ASEAN.

"There are a lot of trade flows, capital flows and investment flows between the two hubs and we are very well-positioned to capture these flows through our twin-hub model," he added.

Banks are increasingly pivoting to **wealth management** as falling interest rates shrink net interest margins.

OCBC group on May 8 reported that strong growth in **wealth management** boosted non-interest income to a new high in the first quarter, lifting the bank's net profit by 5 per cent to \$1.97 billion.

OCBC Hong Kong's first-quarter operating profit rose 31 per cent year on year while profit before tax surged 90 per cent.

Wealth management income increased 1.5 times, and corporate wealth income grew more than threefold compared with the same period in 2025.

Collaboration revenue increased by 17 per cent year on year, driven by OCBC's "One Group" and twin-hub strategy.

Said Mr Wang: "This reflects stronger cross-business and cross-border collaboration supported by our investment in products and service capability to meet the needs of Greater China customers expanding into ASEAN and ASEAN customers accessing Greater China."

He noted that OCBC Hong Kong remains committed to its ambition to become a top 10 bank in Hong Kong by 2030 in scale and profitability through three strategic focus areas.

These are winning as one group in corporate and commercial banking, developing a regional **wealth management** solution and growing the emerging business segment via digital penetration.

"Our business momentum will continue despite the Middle East situation," he added.

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Top Stories

Wealth ambitions, AI threats and war risks: 4 takeaways from Singapore banks' Q1 results

Renald Yeo

854 words

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Another quarter, another results season wrapped up for Singapore's trio of local lenders.

DBS, UOB and OCBC all posted earnings that beat street expectations for the first three months of 2026, even as lower interest rates continued to weigh on net interest income.

DBS on Apr 30 posted a net profit that edged up 1 per cent to S\$2.93 billion. On Thursday (May 7), UOB reported a 4 per cent decline in net profit to S\$1.44 billion. OCBC, which released its results a day later, reported that its net profit rose 5 per cent to S\$1.97 billion.

Several themes stood out: wealth income becoming a bigger earnings driver, rising concerns over AI-related cyber threats, and closer scrutiny on the potential fallout from the Middle East conflict.

And as competition ramps up, bank hiring is another one to watch.

Here are four key takeaways from their latest earnings briefings:

1. Wealth income took centre stage

Fees from **wealth management** and other non-interest income were a key bright spot among the local banks, helping to cushion earnings as declining interest rates weighed on their margins.

For DBS, **wealth management** fees reached a record S\$907 million, helping to offset a 5 per cent decline in group net interest income.

It also reported "particularly pleasing" growth in Taiwan, with **wealth management** fees up 30 per cent in the market, DBS chief executive Tan Su Shan said at the Apr 30 earnings call.

OCBC, whose **wealth management** fees climbed 34 per cent to S\$422 million, went a step further. In the same week it reported earnings, it announced the acquisition of HSBC's wealth and retail businesses in Indonesia.

The deal is expected to drive cost and revenue synergies, while strengthening OCBC's wealth ambitions in the region, said group chief executive Tan Teck Long on Friday.

For UOB – despite a decline in net fee income – gross wealth fees rose 2.8 per cent to S\$219 million.

The lender aims to double its **wealth management** income by 2030, as it looks to deepen its reach in the affluent segment across Asean, said deputy chairman and chief executive Wee Ee Cheong on Thursday.

2. AI risks are moving up the agenda

Questions on leading artificial intelligence (AI) firm Anthropic's Claude Mythos model, and its potential cybersecurity impact on Singapore's banks, featured at all three earnings briefings.

On May 5, Senior Minister of State for Digital Development and Information Tan Kiat How said in Parliament that the chief executive officers of major financial institutions in Singapore have met the Monetary Authority of Singapore to discuss collective action against cyberthreats posed by advanced AI models such as Mythos.

All three bank leaders said their teams were aware of the potential risks.

DBS' Tan noted that while Mythos can be used by attackers to detect vulnerabilities faster, it can also be used by banks and cyber teams to identify the same vulnerabilities.

"The immediate task at hand is to make sure that you've got all the patches, (and) you have your strong internal hygiene, inside and out," she added.

3. Middle East risks are being watched

The banks reiterated that they do not have material loan exposure to the Middle East.

Stress tests have been conducted repeatedly and remain ongoing, the three chief executives said. They also indicated that existing provision buffers are sufficient for unexpected scenarios.

But beyond the direct impact – or what they described as the “first-order” impact – it is the secondary and tertiary effects that are keeping lenders watchful.

These include inflationary pressures and a potential drag on regional economic growth from elevated oil and energy prices, which management teams flagged as key risks to monitor.

UOB, because of its exposure to loans to small and medium-sized enterprises, continues to run stress tests in this area

Wee reaffirmed the bank's commitment to small-business owners, saying that the lender will “stand by” its clients and that it is “not the time to de-risk” from them.

4. Hiring will be selective

As all three banks look to grow **wealth-management** income to offset pressure from lower interest rates, their leaders indicated that they intend to step up hiring in related areas in 2026, including relationship managers.

In 2025, the three lenders posted year-on-year declines in staff count, with their combined employee figures falling by almost 3,000 positions, The Business Times reported before the start of banks' earnings season in April.

In 2026, however, hiring for wealth-related roles may not necessarily translate into a sharp rise in group headcount. This is because staff numbers in other functions could fall correspondingly, leaving overall headcount broadly stable.

For instance, UOB's Wee said the bank is using AI tools to automate certain job functions such as those in call centres, though the lender stressed that any reduction in staff count would be managed over time through natural attrition.

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Business

OCBC, UOB target wealth management growth as demand rises

Kang Wan Chern

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More companies uploaded the minutes of their annual general meetings (AGMs) held in April to SGXNet last week, in line with stock exchange rules requiring such records to be published within one month of the meeting.

The filings come amid growing demand from shareholders and market watchers for AGMs to become more relevant for retail shareholders rather than just an “annual general makan”, a long-running stereotype that portrays such meetings as opportunities for free buffet meals, The Straits Times reported.

Analysts said improving the quality and accessibility of AGMs as an avenue for company-shareholder engagement is important as regulators seek to boost liquidity and address undervaluation in the local stock market.

However, most AGMs are held on weekday mornings or afternoons and are clustered heavily around the April 30 deadline for companies with December financial year ends, making it difficult for working shareholders to attend sessions.

The other issue is transparency, with most AGMs remaining closed to the media, limiting timely reporting for shareholders unable to attend.

Banking on **wealth management**

Both OCBC Bank and UOB reported first-quarter earnings supported by rising demand for **wealth management** services last week.

Strong growth in **wealth management** boosted OCBC's non-interest income to a new high in the first quarter, helping to offset a decline in interest income as a result of lower interest rates.

This helped lift OCBC's total income by 5 per cent over the first quarter of 2025 to \$3.83 billion, while net profit for the period rose 5 per cent to \$1.97 billion.

Wealth management at OCBC – spanning private banking, premier private client, premier banking, insurance, asset management and stockbroking – now contributes 39 per cent to the bank's total income, up from 37 per cent previously.

To capitalise on higher demand, OCBC on May 4 said it will acquire parts of HSBC's wealth and premier banking portfolio in Indonesia, reportedly beating out UOB and other banks such as DBS, Malaysia's CIMB Group and Japan's Sumitomo Mitsui.

At the bank's results briefing on May 8, OCBC group chief executive Tan Teck Long said the acquisition is expected to contribute positively to the bank's earnings and aligns with its new strategy to grow and deepen its wealth business in Indonesia.

Shares of OCBC closed the week flat at \$21.92.

OCBC can expect to see some competition from UOB, which is also eyeing growth in **wealth management**.

UOB's total income for the first quarter of 2026 fell 6 per cent from a year ago to \$3.42 billion, despite stronger contributions from its **wealth management** business, while net profit slipped 4 per cent over the same period to \$1.43 billion.

The bank said it faced pressure from lower interest rates, and raked in less fee income as investment and loan-related activities softened.

Nevertheless, UOB aims to double its wealth income by 2030 by better serving a growing pool of affluent customers, deputy chairman and CEO Wee Ee Cheong said on May 7.

Shares of UOB closed the week flat at \$36.56.

JustCo files for SGX IPO

Stock market investors in Singapore will soon see a fresh counter on the Singapore Exchange (SGX) mainboard after home-grown co-working operator JustCo lodged its preliminary prospectus on May 7.

Details such as the size of the offering, pricing and implied valuation have yet to be disclosed.

Founded here in 2011, JustCo operates 54 co-working spaces across 12 cities in Singapore, Japan and Thailand.

The company has since received backing from sovereign wealth fund GIC, which holds 29.06 per cent, and Frasers Property, which owns 22.52 per cent.

The company recorded a net profit of US\$2.7 million (S\$3.4 million) for 2025, reversing losses of US\$10.1 million in 2024 and US\$12.5 million in 2023. Revenue rose to US\$150.8 million in 2025, up from US\$113.8 million two years earlier.

Now, JustCo is seeking to raise funds through an initial public offering to expand into new markets, such as India, Malaysia, the Philippines, Hong Kong, Dubai and Saudi Arabia.

The company has already secured backing from several cornerstone investors, which have agreed to subscribe for 74.3 million shares ahead of the listing.

These include fund managers selected under a government-led initiative to invest \$6.5 billion in the Singapore stock market, such as JPMorgan Asset Management, Amova Asset Management, Fullerton Fund Management and Avanda Investment Management.

Some firms report first-quarter results

Several SGX-listed firms reported first-quarter results last week.

This included StarHub, which on May 7 reported a sharp drop in first-quarter earnings due to weaker performance in its consumer mobile and broadband services.

Net profit for the three months ended March fell 81.3 per cent to \$5.9 million, while revenue slipped 6.1 per cent to \$507.3 million.

The telco said consumers spent less on roaming, SMS and other add-on services, while the number of mobile subscribers declined to 2.2 million from 2.4 million a year earlier.

Meanwhile, the number of broadband customers dipped slightly to around 571,000, while average monthly spending per broadband user fell to \$33 from \$36 a year ago.

StarHub shares fell 3.8 per cent through the week, ending on May 8 at \$1.01 each.

Transport operator SBS Transit on May 8 reported a slight decline in first-quarter profit, despite its revenue rising 4.8 per cent year on year to \$391.8 million for the period, driven mainly by increased bus service fees as well as stronger rail fare collections from higher fares and rising commuter numbers.

Average daily ridership on the North East Line rose 2.7 per cent to about 611,000, while the Downtown Line saw a 2.1 per cent increase to around 475,000 commuters, according to company data.

But net profit for the three months fell 2.2 per cent to \$15.6 million, after operating costs climbed 4.9 per cent to \$374 million because of higher fuel and electricity prices, alongside increased staff costs.

SBS Transit closed the week at \$3.60, down 2.4 per cent.

In contrast, Venture Corp's shares rose more than 10 per cent through the week, ending on May 8 at \$18.23 apiece after it reported a strong set of first-quarter results on May 5.

Revenue rose 1.9 per cent year on year to \$628.5 million, while net profit edged up to \$56.3 million from \$55.9 million a year earlier.

The group said demand was driven mainly by customers in areas linked to artificial intelligence infrastructure, including test and measurement equipment, networking and communications, and semiconductor-related equipment.

Other market movers

Jardine Matheson jumped by almost 1.6 per cent to US\$71.28 on May 8 after Bloomberg reported that the group is considering selling its car dealership in Malaysia and Singapore, citing people familiar with the matter.

SGX-listed Jardine Matheson holds about 85 per cent of Jardine Cycle & Carriage, the owner of the dealership, which retails and provides after-sales services for new and used vehicles in Malaysia and Singapore. Brands offered include Mercedes-Benz, Mitsubishi, Kia, Citroen and Peugeot, its website shows.

Shares of Jardine C&C, which are also listed here, rose 1.5 per cent on May 8, ending the day at \$32.88.

Bloomberg reported that Jardine C&C is working with an adviser on a possible sale of the dealership and has reached out to potential buyers. A transaction could value the business at US\$250 million to US\$350 million. Deliberations are ongoing and might not result in a sale.

Shares of Hongkong Land, another Jardine Matheson subsidiary, jumped after Bloomberg on May 7 said the developer and CapitaLand were among possible bidders for Singapore's Marina One integrated development.

The development comprises office and retail space as well as residential units. The report added that discussions are still at an early stage and may not lead to a deal.

The speculation comes after Hongkong Land said in March that it is prepared to step up investments after recycling US\$3.6 billion of capital to improve earnings and shareholder returns.

Hongkong Land rose by more than 9 per cent to US\$8.70 on May 7, but pared gains to close the week at US\$8.25.

What to look out for this week

Singapore Airlines (SIA) will announce its financial results for the year ended March 31 on May 14, when its management could address concerns relating to widening losses at Air India, in which SIA holds a 25.1 per cent stake.

Air India in April reported losses amounting to 220 billion rupees (\$2.95 billion) for its financial year ended March 31, owing to a plunge in sales following the deadly crash of a Boeing 787 Dreamliner, the closure of Pakistani airspace to Indian carriers, and the Middle East conflict.

Air India has reportedly asked its shareholders, Tata and SIA, for additional financial support to bridge its multibillion-dollar losses. SIA has already pumped around \$1.2 billion into the Indian airline since 2024.

Air India is also searching for a new chief executive after its former CEO Campbell Wilson resigned in April.

Shares of SIA closed on May 8 at \$6.31.

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Companies & Markets

OCBC consumer banking chief Sunny Quek aims to double wealth business by 2029

Jude Chan

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[SINGAPORE] OCBC head of global consumer financial services Sunny Quek has big ambitions.

After doubling the lender's consumer banking wealth business since he stepped into his current role in 2022, he is ready to do it again – this time from a bigger base.

"I'm going to double this business again by 2029," he said in an exclusive interview with The Business Times. "My original target was to double our wealth business by 2030. Now, I think we can do it faster."

It is a bold statement to make, in a market filled with similar promises. But as a 30-year veteran of the banking industry, Quek knows the odds.

He has spent 14 years at OCBC, where he has seen three group chief executives come and go. He has lived through the usual cycles of grand banking strategies and corporate reshuffles.

Yet, he strongly believes the bank has finally found the right tool to force actual change: its newly minted **wealth management** committee.

"My confidence comes from the experience I've had in the last four months with the **wealth management** committee," he said. "I can feel the difference."

The **wealth management** committee took shape at the start of 2026. It is the main engine powering new group chief executive Tan Teck Long's "Next Frontier" strategy, as the bank pivots towards a "whole-of-wealth" model.

Tan designed the committee to tear down historic walls dividing the consumer bank, private wealth arm, and insurance unit. It compels OCBC's consumer banking head to sit at the same table with the CEOs of Bank of Singapore and Great Eastern.

The central mandate forces these divisions to operate under shared financial targets. It ensures they stop fighting over the same lucrative clients and start pooling their resources to lock in regional assets.

Tan chairs the group, and having the chief executive in the room means everyone faces real consequences if they fail to align.

Structural advantage

Quek acknowledged, however, that almost every financial institution has drawn up similar playbooks.

"All of us have a wealth strategy. What's really going to differentiate one bank from another is the execution," he said.

And OCBC has a clear structural advantage in Singapore: it owns an insurance company.

"No other Singapore bank has that," Quek said. "An insurer's CEO does not sit in a committee with other banking heads; they are not part of that value chain. For us, however, whatever is built by any of the three of us is built for the whole group."

This means the bank pulls all three entities together under unified leadership, unlike its peers, Quek said.

If they can get the banking app to talk seamlessly to the insurance database without duplicating costs, they might just have a winning formula.

But Quek will have his work cut out for him – the base he intends to double is already massive.

The bank's full-year performance for 2025 also laid down a formidable bedrock of wealth momentum.

Lifted by income growth across the wealth continuum, group **wealth management** income soared 14 per cent to a record S\$5.6 billion in 2025. This lucrative segment now represents 38 per cent of the group's entire income, which rose a record S\$14.6 billion.

A key driver was **wealth management** fees. These surged 33 per cent to an all-time high, and drove a 22 per cent increase in total net fee income to S\$2.4 billion.

The bank scooped up more assets, and rode on positive market valuation to push its banking wealth assets under management (AUM) up 15 per cent to S\$343 billion.

Digital channels saw even sharper spikes during the year. Digital wealth revenue in the city-state surged by over 80 per cent. Even gold and silver are glittering brighter, with precious metals revenue rocketing more than eight times year on year.

Regional push

The hunger for wealth extends well beyond Singapore's borders. The city-state's offshore wealth fees grew more than 30 per cent.

Hong Kong, the other half of OCBC's "twin hubs" strategy, grew its Premier Banking customers by more than 30 per cent; offshore customers there expanded by over 40 per cent.

In Malaysia, wealth fees grew more than 10 per cent, accompanied by a near 15 per cent rise in new affluent customers.

To service this regional influx, the bank plans to hire close to 250 relationship managers in Singapore and Hong Kong.

Not content with organic growth, the bank is also making a grab for scale in South-east Asia's largest economy.

On May 4, it announced that its Indonesian subsidiary had agreed to acquire the retail banking and **wealth management** operations of Bank HSBC Indonesia, in a deal which instantly injected 336,000 customers into the OCBC Indonesia franchise.

It brings across S\$6.6 billion in AUM. This sizeable chunk of wealth includes S\$4.3 billion in customer investments in mutual funds, bonds and insurance, along with S\$2.3 billion in deposits.

When completed in the second quarter of 2027, the move will boost OCBC Indonesia's AUM by 25 per cent and add about 1,300 staff to its talent pool. It firmly anchors the bank's ambitions in a critical regional market.

Momentum is certainly building for this overarching strategy. The traction was clearly visible in OCBC's Q1 financial results released on May 8. This was the first quarter since the **wealth management** committee convened and Tan's Next Frontier strategy was put in place.

The lender posted a 5 per cent rise in net profit to S\$2 billion for the three months ended Mar 31, neatly beating market estimates.

While a lower interest rate environment dragged net interest income down by 5 per cent to S\$2.2 billion, **wealth management** was the undeniable hero of the quarter as record-high non-interest income plugged the gap.

Wealth fees in Q1 surged 34 per cent to S\$422 million, driven by robust customer activity across all channels. Overall **wealth management** income climbed 11 per cent to S\$1.5 billion, representing 39 per cent of the group's total income.

The chief executive explicitly called out this wealth-led performance as crucial support against geopolitical tensions and inflation risks.

Shifting attitudes

OCBC's pivot comes amid shifting consumer attitudes towards wealth. As digital platforms democratise market access, younger consumers expect to start their investment journeys earlier, with far less capital.

"Consumers don't think about their life goals holistically," Quek said. "You often hear: 'I'm too poor to think about retirement'..."

"What we are seeing globally, not just in Singapore, is the growing need for better financial literacy, earlier retirement planning, and much more structured wealth advice across different life stages," he added. "These trends are reshaping how we think about **wealth management**."

The bank is adapting its tools to capture this new generation. Its mobile app now offers fractional investment solutions to sharply lower the barrier to entry.

Customers can start small with products such as the Blue Chip Investment Plan, RoboInvest, unit trusts and even fractions of precious metals down to 0.1 grams of gold.

The goal is to hook customers early and use the new committee structure to seamlessly pass them up the wealth chain as their assets grow.

While digital channels provide the volume, Quek stresses that managing significant wealth remains deeply rooted in trust and human advice. To execute its ambitious plans on the ground, OCBC is heavily equipping its relationship managers with advanced tools.

The bank recently rolled out an artificial intelligence training programme for its wealth advisors, and the early results underscore Quek's confidence about execution.

Advisers who completed the programme booked twice as many client appointments as their peers. Their monthly revenues jumped 50 per cent from that in the three months prior to the training.

Indeed, changing entrenched corporate culture and erasing silo mentalities take significant time and are a massive undertaking.

With a firm hand from the top, a clear road map for South-east Asia, and a fresh war chest of Indonesian assets, OCBC is laying the groundwork.

But while the mandate to double the consumer wealth business by 2029 sets a high bar, Quek sees a clear path forward. And if his infectious confidence spreads, that ambitious target could be well within reach.

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UOB PB names new Greater China market head amid hiring blitz

Cheryl Heng

310 words

11 May 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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UOB **Private Bank** has promoted internally for a new market head for Greater China, effective 11 May 2026, as the Singaporean lender accelerates its regional expansion strategy.

Based in Singapore, Paul Zhou has taken on the new role, and will be responsible for driving the growth and strategic development of the bank's Greater China business, according to a 11 May release.

Zhou makes the move to the **private bank** from UOB China, where he has served as head of sales and distribution since 2018. In that role, he oversaw wealth management and secured lending sales, alongside specialist teams in investment and insurance.

During his eight-year tenure at UOB China, Zhou also expanding the bank's customer base, driving assets under management and deposit growth,

Prior to that, Zhou held senior leadership positions at Ping An Trust and Citibank, where he managed investment strategies and customer acquisition across multiple Chinese cities. He began his career at The Bank of Tokyo-Mitsubishi and later worked at HSBC.

Zhou's appointment comes as UOB PB plans to bolster its Greater China franchise. The bank said it will hire several experienced relationship managers and team leaders across May and June.

UOB PB has also hired former Bank of China (Hong Kong) **private banking** market head July Chan to lead its Hong Kong business. Chan joins UOB PB in Hong Kong as its head, with the remit to expand the operations and hire aggressively in Hong Kong, Citywire Asia reported [exclusively](#) last week.

UOB is aiming to double its wealth income by 2030 versus 2025, its latest earnings revealed. It has a team of 40 relationship managers based in Hong Kong and is also exploring a second booking centre outside of Singapore, according to OCBC research note on 7 May.

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OCBC Group First Quarter 2026 Net Profit Up 5% Year-on-Year to S\$1.97 billion

Distributed by Contify.com

1,624 words

8 May 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * Record non-interest income, led by strong growth in **wealth management**.
- * Total weighted new sales (TWNS) and new business embedded value (NBEV) grew 16% and 31% respectively.
- * Acquisition of HSBC's wealth business in Indonesia to strengthen wealth business in Indonesia.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, May 8 -- OCBC Bank issued the following news release:

- The Group's solid 1Q26 performance was underpinned by record non-interest income, led by strong growth in **wealth management**.

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corporation Limited ("OCBC") reported net profit of S\$1.97 billion for the first quarter of 2026 ("1Q26"), 5% above S\$1.88 billion a year ago ("1Q25"), and 13% higher than S\$1.74 billion in the previous quarter ("4Q25").

The Group's solid 1Q26 performance was underpinned by record non-interest income, led by strong growth in **wealth management**. Non-interest income was up by more than 20% from the previous year and the prior quarter, with broad-based increase across fee, trading and insurance income. Total income rose by 5% year-on-year and 6% quarter-on-quarter to a new high. Operating expenses were well managed, with cost-to-income ratio ("CIR") below 40%. Loans and deposits were higher, supported by continued momentum in strategic growth areas. Asset quality remained sound with non-performing loan ("NPL") ratio steady at 0.9%. Given the heightened risks in the macroeconomic environment, the Group prudently set aside S\$191 million of allowances for non-impaired assets. Total allowance coverage for non-performing assets ("NPAs") increased to 163%. The Group's capital, funding and liquidity profile remained strong, positioning the Group well to pursue growth and navigate uncertainties. On an annualised basis, earnings per share was higher at S\$1.76 and ROE stood at 13.0%.

Disclaimer: Table can be viewed

at: <https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2026/ocbc-group-first-quarter-2026-net-profit-up-5percent.page>

1Q26 Year-on-Year Performance

Group net profit increased 5% to S\$1.97 billion, underpinned by record non-interest income.

- * Net interest income declined by 5% to S\$2.22 billion, amid a lower interest rate environment. A drop in asset yields was partly mitigated by lower funding costs and a 10% growth in average assets. Net interest margin ("NIM") was 1.76%, 28 basis points below the previous year.
- * Non-interest income rose 23% to S\$1.61 billion, and comprised more than 40% of total income.
- Net fee income grew 24% to S\$675 million on broad-based growth. **Wealth management** fees increased by 34% with robust contributions across all wealth product channels on increased customer activities. Investment banking, trade-related and loan-related fees were also higher compared to the previous year.

- Net trading income rose 10% to S\$434 million. This was largely driven by a 35% growth in customer flow income to a record high, from sustained momentum in wealth-related activities and hedging demand from corporate customers.
- Insurance income improved by 34% to S\$409 million, supported by robust insurance performance and a release in reserves reflecting positive experience and strong underlying fundamentals. Total weighted new sales ("TWNS") and new business embedded value ("NBEV") grew by 16% and 31% respectively. This was driven by improving sales and a strategic shift in product mix, with NBEV margin rising from 43.1% in the previous year to 48.6%.
- * The Group's **wealth management** income, comprising income from private banking, premier private client, premier banking, insurance, asset management and stockbroking, was S\$1.48 billion, up 11% year-on-year, and contributed 39% to the Group's total income, higher as compared to 37% in the previous year. Banking **wealth management** AUM was S\$342 billion, up 12% from S\$306 billion a year ago, driven by net new money inflows across all wealth segments.
- Operating expenses were S\$1.50 billion, 6% above 1Q25, mainly due to increased staff cost to support business growth, and continued IT investments. CIR was 39.3%, slightly higher than 38.7% a year ago.
- * Total allowances increased 2% to S\$216 million, largely due to higher allowances for non-impaired assets being set aside.
- * Share of results of associates rose by 14% to S\$312 million.

1Q26 Quarter-on-Quarter Performance

Group net profit was 13% higher than the previous quarter, underpinned by record total income and lower expenses.

- * Net interest income of S\$2.22 billion was 3% below 4Q25, largely due to lower benchmark rates for SGD, HKD and USD, and the effect of a comparatively shorter quarter. On a day-adjusted basis, net interest income was a notch lower by 1%. The impact of lower interest rates was partly compensated by a decline in deposit costs and a 4% growth in average assets, driven by 3% average loan growth and a 7% rise in high-quality assets. NIM was 10 basis points lower at 1.76%, which reflected loan yield compression and the strategic growth in income-accretive high-quality assets.
- * Non-interest income was 22% higher at S\$1.61 billion, driven by double-digit growth across fee, trading and insurance income, underscoring the strength of the Group's diversified franchise.
- * Operating expenses were 4% lower compared to 4Q25, mainly attributable to higher technology costs incurred in the previous quarter.
- * Total allowances of S\$216 million, which mostly comprised allowances for non-impaired assets, were 8% higher as compared to S\$200 million in the prior quarter.
- * Share of results of associates was S\$312 million, 20% above 4Q25.

Disclaimer: Table can be viewed at:

<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2026/ocbc-group-first-quarter-2026-net-profit-up-5percent.page>

- * As at 31 March 2026, total NPAs were S\$3.12 billion, 7% higher than a year ago.
- * Compared to the prior quarter, NPAs declined by 4%. New corporate NPA formation was S\$123 million for 1Q26, lower as compared to S\$399 million in 4Q25, and was more than offset by higher net recoveries and upgrades.
- * NPL ratio was unchanged for eight consecutive quarters at 0.9%, and total NPA coverage increased to 163%.
- * Total allowances for loans and other assets were S\$216 million, which comprised:
 - Allowances for impaired assets of S\$25 million, substantially lower than 4Q25 and the previous year; and
 - Allowances for non-impaired assets of S\$191 million, which included additional management overlays set aside to reflect the elevated uncertainties in the operating environment.

* Total credit costs for 1Q26 were 23 basis points on an annualised basis.

Strong Funding, Liquidity and Capital Position

Disclaimer: Table can be viewed at:

<https://www.ocbc.com/group/media/release/2026/ocbc-group-first-quarter-2026-net-profit-up-5percent.page>

* As at 31 March 2026, customer loans were S\$347 billion, 9% higher than the previous year and up 2% from a quarter ago, on a constant currency basis.

- On a quarter-on-quarter basis, loan growth was broad-based across industries, and by geography, it was mainly driven by Singapore, Malaysia and the Group's international markets.

- Sustainable financing loan portfolio grew 17% from a year ago to S\$59.7 billion and comprised 17% of Group loans, while total commitments were S\$83.0 billion.

* Customer deposits rose 10% year-on-year to S\$444 billion, largely driven by a 13% growth in CASA deposits, with CASA ratio improving to 50.2%. Compared to the previous quarter, customer deposits grew 4%, with CASA deposits rising 3%.

* Loans-to-deposits ratio was 77.2%, compared to 78.6% a quarter ago.

* The Group's CET1 CAR is subject to MAS' final Basel III reforms requirements which came into effect on 1 July 2024 and are being progressively phased in between 1 July 2024 and 1 January 2029. Group CET1 CAR as at 31 March 2026 was 17.0%, and on a fully phased-in basis, it was 15.2%.

Message from Group CEO, Tan Teck Long

"We delivered a good start to 2026, with Group net profit rising 5% year-on-year to S\$1.97 billion, underpinned by resilient performance across Banking, **Wealth Management** and Insurance as we execute our Next Frontier strategy.

We achieved a new high for non-interest income, led by our wealth business, which helped us offset lower net interest income amid a low-interest rate environment. Our wealth fees grew 34% year-on-year to hit S\$422 million.

Even as we sustained our loan growth at 9% year-on-year, asset quality remained sound, underscoring the resilience of our portfolio amid a more challenging macroeconomic climate.

Against this backdrop, we continued to make disciplined strategic investments to strengthen our long-term growth engines. The acquisition of HSBC's wealth business in Indonesia fits well into our Next Frontier strategy under the Franchise Shift of building up our wealth business in Indonesia. It is a high-quality portfolio with significant assets under management (AUM), including deposits with sizeable CASA balances. The portfolio is highly complementary to our existing Indonesia franchise, with clear synergies across customers and capabilities.

Looking ahead, global conditions remain uncertain amid geopolitical tensions and elevated inflation risks. Much of the near-term outlook will depend on how the war in the Middle East, with its impact on energy supply and prices, evolves, while the ongoing trade tariff situation is also being closely monitored.

With our strong capital, funding and liquidity position, diversified income streams and disciplined risk management, we are well positioned to navigate uncertainties and deliver sustainable long-term value."

[Category: Investment Banking, Insurance, Investments, Financial Performance]

Source: OCBC Bank

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Banking

OCBC's wealth business drives Q1 profit up 5% to \$1.97 billion, more than expected

Sheila Chiang

595 words

8 May 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

online

English

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SINGAPORE - Strong growth in **wealth management** boosted OCBC's non-interest income in the first quarter to a new high, lifting the bank's net profit by 5 per cent.

Earnings for the quarter ended March 31 were \$1.97 billion, from \$1.88 billion a year ago, beating a forecast of \$1.79 billion by analysts in a Bloomberg poll.

Net interest income declined by 5 per cent to \$2.22 billion, amid a lower interest rate environment. Net interest margin (NIM) was 1.76 per cent, 28 basis points below 2.04 per cent a year ago.

Non-interest income rose 23 per cent to \$1.61 billion, and comprised more than 40 per cent of total income.

Net fee income grew 24 per cent to \$675 million on broad-based growth. Of this, **wealth management** fees increased by 34 per cent with robust contributions across all wealth product channels on increased customer activities. Investment banking, trade-related and loan-related fees were also higher compared to the previous year.

The group's **wealth management** income - from private banking, premier private client, premier banking, insurance, asset management and stockbroking - surged 11 per cent to \$1.48 billion.

The wealth business's share of the bank's total income rose to 39 per cent from 37 per cent a year ago.

In his first quarter as OCBC chief executive, Mr Tan Teck Long said resilient performance across banking, **wealth management** and insurance helped to cushion the impact from lower interest rates.

"We achieved a new high for non-interest income, led by our wealth business, which helped us offset lower net interest income amid a low-interest rate environment," he said.

Wealth fees grew 34 per cent year-on-year to hit \$422 million.

"Against this backdrop, we continued to make disciplined strategic investments to strengthen our long-term growth engines," he said.

OCBC on May 4 said it struck a deal to acquire parts of HSBC's wealth and premier banking portfolio in Indonesia, reportedly beating out UOB and other banks such as DBS, Malaysia's CIMB Group and Japan's Sumitomo Mitsui.

Mr Tan said that the acquisition is aligned with the bank's new corporate strategy to grow and deepen its wealth business in Indonesia, as well as strengthens its position as one of the top privately owned banks in the country.

He noted that HSBC's wealth and premier banking portfolio in Indonesia is a high-quality one with assets under management of \$6.6 billion, bringing scale and synergy to the group.

Looking ahead, Mr Tan said global conditions remain uncertain amid geopolitical tensions and elevated inflation risks.

Much of the near-term outlook will depend on how the war in the Middle East, with its impact on energy supply and prices, evolves, while the ongoing trade tariff situation is also being closely monitored, he noted.

But OCBC is well-positioned to navigate uncertainties with its strong capital, funding and liquidity position, as well as diversified income streams and disciplined risk management, he said.

OCBC is the last of the three local banks to report first-quarter earnings.

UOB on May 7 posted a 4 per cent fall in net profit to \$1.44 billion on the back of what it called a softer operating environment. DBS on April 30 said its earnings grew 1 per cent to \$2.93 billion on record **wealth management** fees.

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Companies & Markets

OCBC Q1 profit rises 5% to S\$1.97 billion, beats estimates

Renald Yeo

365 words

7 May 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

online

English

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[SINGAPORE] OCBC's net profit for the first quarter rose 5 per cent, driven by strong growth in **wealth management**, the lender said on Friday (May 8).

Net profit for the three months ended Mar 31, 2026 stood at S\$1.97 billion, versus S\$1.88 billion a year earlier.

This was above the S\$1.88 billion consensus estimate in a Bloomberg survey of five analysts.

Net interest income fell 5 per cent to S\$2.2 billion, amid a lower interest rate environment, as net interest margin narrowed by 28 basis points to 1.76 per cent, from 2.04 per cent previously.

Non-interest income rose 23 per cent to a record S\$1.61 billion, as **wealth management** fees increased by 34 per cent to S\$422 million, with contributions across all wealth product channels on increased customer activities.

The non-performing loan ratio was unchanged at 0.9 per cent. Total allowances rose 2 per cent to S\$216 million, largely due to higher allowances for non-impaired assets.

Tan Teck Long, group chief executive officer of OCBC, said: "We achieved a new high for non-interest income, led by our wealth business, which helped us offset lower net interest income amid a low-interest rate environment."

However, he noted that global conditions "remain uncertain amid geopolitical tensions and elevated inflation risks".

"Much of the near-term outlook will depend on how the war in the Middle East, with its impact on energy supply and prices, evolves, while the ongoing trade tariff situation is also being closely monitored," he added.

OCBC rounded off the first-quarter earnings season for Singapore's three local banks, following DBS on Apr 30 and UOB on May 7.

Earlier this week, on May 4, OCBC announced that its subsidiary, Bank OCBC NISP Tbk, will acquire the assets and liabilities of HSBC's retail and **wealth management** operations in Indonesia.

Shares of OCBC closed 0.6 per cent, or S\$0.12, lower at S\$21.88 on Thursday, ahead of the results release.

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Business

OCBC to buy HSBC Indonesia's retail banking business in first major deal under new CEO

Cheong Poh Kwan

463 words

4 May 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

online

English

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SINGAPORE – OCBC Bank has struck a deal to acquire parts of HSBC Indonesia's retail banking and wealth management operations, adding over 300,000 customers to its Indonesian subsidiary and potentially opening doors for Singapore-based staff seeking overseas exposure.

This marks the first major acquisition under OCBC's new group chief executive, Mr Tan Teck Long, as the bank expands its presence in South-east Asia's largest economy.

Announced on May 4, the deal involves OCBC taking over the assets and liabilities of HSBC's International Wealth and Premier Banking (IWPB) operations in Indonesia – a portfolio covering customer deposits, mutual funds, bonds, insurance products, credit cards and retail loans.

The acquisition will add 336,000 customers and \$6.6 billion in assets under management (AUM) to OCBC Indonesia, including \$4.3 billion in customer investments in mutual funds, bonds and insurance, as well as \$2.3 billion in deposits.

The deal will also bring about 1,300 HSBC Indonesia staff into the OCBC fold, expanding the bank's wealth management talent pool.

An OCBC spokesperson said job opportunities in its Indonesia subsidiary will be made available to Singapore-based staff seeking overseas exposure.

The final price tag of the deal will be based on the net asset value of the business at closing, plus a premium of up to about \$480 million.

OCBC said the purchase will be funded internally and is not expected to have a material impact on its net tangible assets, earnings per share and capital position.

Excluding one-off transaction costs, the deal is expected to increase the bank's earnings per share when it is completed in the second quarter of 2027.

In its press release, OCBC said: "IWPB Indonesia's customer base is highly complementary to the OCBC Indonesia franchise, giving it considerable scope to grow its wealth business."

It added that the deal is expected to increase OCBC Indonesia's AUM by about 25 per cent and boost its credit card balances by more than 150 per cent.

OCBC already operates in Indonesia through its Jakarta-listed subsidiary, PT Bank OCBC NISP.

Bloomberg reported earlier in April that OCBC emerged as the preferred bidder after out-competing rival suitors.

Mr Tan said this acquisition fits well into the bank's "next frontier" strategy.

"It follows our successful 2024 acquisition and integration of PT Bank Commonwealth Indonesia, in further expanding our market penetration in South-east Asia's largest economy," he said, adding that Indonesia remains a key growth market.

OCBC's shares closed 0.1 per cent or 3 cents lower at \$21.87 on May 4 before the announcement.

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NTB completes transfer of HSBC Sri Lanka's Retail Banking portfolio

415 words

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Daily FT

DAFTSL

English

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Nations Trust Bank PLC (NTB) yesterday announced that the transfer of Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation's (HSBC) Retail Banking business in Sri Lanka to NTB has officially been completed, with the acquired portfolio transitioning to NTB effective 1 May 2026.

NTB has integrated HSBC Sri Lanka's retail banking customers into its operations, ensuring continuity of service and relationship management. The transition also includes the onboarding of HSBC Sri Lanka staff as part of the integration process.

The transition has been carried out with a focus on operational stability and minimal disruption, with ongoing support in place as customers familiarise themselves with their banking arrangements at NTB.

In a statement, the bank said the migration brings approximately 200,000 retail customer accounts under NTB, encompassing savings and current accounts, fixed deposits, credit and debit cards, retail loans and a high-net-worth customer segment that now joins NTB **Private Banking**.

Through this transfer, NTB's countrywide network expands to 96 branches. The transition adds seven branches to the network, with locations in Bambalapitiya, Flower Road, Union Place, and Pelawatte operating as dedicated **Private Banking** Centres, while three other branches are located in Nugegoda, Jaffna, and Kandy.

To support customers during the transition period, NTB has ensured that multiple access points and support channels remain available. Customers may continue to bank through the nearest NTB branch, contact NTB's 24-hour Help Desk via +94 11 441 4151, and access digital banking services through the Nations Direct mobile app. Dedicated transfer-related information and FAQs are also available at <https://migration.nationstrust.com>.

Additionally, arrangements were made to extend branch support across two weekends as part of the transition program. 19 NTB branches were opened on 2 and 3 May, and will also be open on 9 and 10 May, from 9 a.m. to 12 noon to support customers with any banking requirements.

The branches are the **Private Banking** Centre at Horton Place, Mount Lavinia, Panadura, Negombo, Maharagama, Pettah Bankshall Street, Nugegoda, Kurunegala, Kiribathgoda, Thalawathugoda, Kohuwala, Ratnapura, Batticaloa, Havelock Town, Wattala, Matara, Galle, Kandy, and Jaffna.

Following the initial Sale and Purchase Agreement signed with HSBC Sri Lanka in September 2025, NTB received Central Bank of Sri Lanka (CBSL) approval in December 2025 to acquire HSBC Sri Lanka's Retail Banking business for Rs. 18 billion. These key milestones enabled NTB to complete the acquisition of the business as planned in the first half of 2026.

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Business

Lenders dangle perks to lure mainland visitors

Enoch Yiu

673 words

2 May 2026

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Gold bars, cruises, Dior beauty services and Rosewood Hong Kong vouchers are just some of the incentives Hong Kong's major lenders are offering in hopes of capturing wealthy clients, as visitors from the mainland began to arrive in the city during the "golden week" Labour Day holiday starting yesterday.

HSBC, Standard Chartered, Bank of China (Hong Kong), Citigroup, DBS Hong Kong, ICBC (Asia), Bank of East Asia and Hang Seng Bank have all extended the hours of certain branches through the weekend to sign up new customers, offering them cash awards and other incentives.

The five-day holiday that runs until Tuesday is a prime opportunity for banks to sell investments, insurance and other products that fall under the **wealth management** category, a major growth engine for them.

The Immigration Department expects about 980,000 mainland visitors to enter the city between yesterday and Tuesday, an increase of 7 per cent over the same period last year. The number of entries and exits during the five-day period is expected to reach 6 million.

"Golden week is a rare window when many mainland customers are in Hong Kong at the same time," said Frankie Yan, head of retail and wealth distribution, retail banking and wealth at HSBC Hong Kong.

"Instead of just a holiday excursion, we know they want to get personal chores done, including banking."

HSBC Life, the city's biggest life insurance company in terms of new sales, has teamed up with Dior Beauty to offer personal beauty services at the bank's wealth centre, and is offering a horse racing lunch at Sha Tin Racecourse tomorrow.

The lender is also offering an HK\$18,000 Royal Caribbean cruise suite to customers who invest at least HK\$20 million and meet certain other requirements, in addition to a standard HK\$88,000 welcome offer.

Standard Chartered is holding a lucky draw for new cross-border private banking or priority banking clients, with a Rosewood hotel stay worth more than HK\$10,000 as the top prize, on top of a cash rebate of HK\$68,888 if they meet certain investment criteria.

Eliza Law, head of the affluent segment and distribution at Standard Chartered Hong Kong, said offering both **wealth management** advice and a range of entertainment options during golden week had proved useful to expand its business.

"Demand for cross-border **wealth management** services remains strong," Law said. "In May last year, the number of new priority private and priority banking clients recorded double-digit year-on-year growth, reflecting strong demand for **wealth management** services among visitors to Hong Kong."

BOCHK has focused on the rising price of gold as a selling point, offering a lucky draw for cross-border customers with the top prize of a 50-gram gold bar, priced at around HK\$58,000 based on the price at the end of last month.

The lender recorded a 30 per cent increase in sign-ups by wealthy cross-border customers during golden week last year, compared with normal weeks.

Golden week was a period when customer footfall in key districts typically increased, owing to overlapping public holidays in Hong Kong and on the mainland, said Maggie Yung, head of DBS Treasures and distribution at DBS Hong Kong.

"For DBS, it is an opportunity to engage walk-in visitors, maintain service accessibility and reinforce our presence in high-traffic locations," she said.

New customers who open a new DBS Treasures account at select branches during golden week can get top-up cash awards.

Citibank is offering HK\$170,000 in cash to new private banking customers and HK\$70,000 to Citigold customers, provided they join the city's investment migration scheme and meet the investment criteria.

Greater Bay Area customers who sign up to use the **Wealth Management** Connect service through Citibank and invest 3 million yuan (HK\$3.4 million) will get a cash rebate of HK\$13,000.

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Business

StanChart profit up 19% on wealth management lift

Enoch Yiu

689 words

1 May 2026

South China Morning Post

SCMP

B1

English

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Pressure from lower interest rates and increased cost of bad debts offset some of the bank's gains

Standard Chartered's first-quarter profit rose 19 per cent after a strong **wealth-management** performance, though this was offset by lower interest rates and rising bad debt provisions due to the Middle East conflict.

Net profit increased 19 per cent year on year in the first three months of 2026 to US\$1.9 billion, or 74.2 US cents per share, from US\$1.59 billion a year earlier, the bank said yesterday. The result was better than analysts' estimates of US\$1.33 billion.

The bank's pre-tax profit rose 17 per cent to a record US\$2.5 billion in the quarter, compared with US\$2.28 billion a year earlier and above market estimates of US\$2.14 billion.

"Despite ongoing geopolitical tensions and global economic uncertainty, our advantaged market presence and disciplined risk management give us confidence in our ability to perform," CEO Bill Winters said in an earnings statement to the Hong Kong stock exchange.

The bank recorded credit impairment charges of US\$296 million during the quarter, up 36 per cent from a year earlier. The bad debts were equivalent to an annualised loan-loss rate of 32 basis points, including a precautionary management overlay of US\$190 million reflecting uncertainty related to the Middle East conflict.

The Middle East provision includes severe downside scenarios from the bank's capital stress test and sustained conflict, according to Peter Burrill, interim group chief financial officer at Standard Chartered.

"With the economic contraction across a number of different geographies, as well as sustained high oil prices for a period of time, we think they are a good indication of the potential impacts of a prolonged conflict," Burrill said in a media briefing.

"It is too early to tell how things will actually play out. It was important to us to take an estimate and try to be prudent about how these things could impact us."

The company has more than 2,000 employees in the Middle East, but there has been no significant disruption.

Burrill said there was some wealth migration from the Middle East to Singapore and Hong Kong, but the sums were not substantial.

The bank's pre-tax profit in Hong Kong stood at US\$845 million, or 34 per cent of the total, making the city its single largest market.

"Hong Kong had a very strong quarter, which is our biggest **wealth management** business," he said.

The bank's credit quality in the city remained stable as residential and prime office markets had shown signs of recovery.

"We don't have a lot remaining on our books from China commercial real estate, and in Hong Kong our exposures are stable and we have not seen any net deterioration," Burrill added.

Winters said in March last year that Hong Kong would be the focus of Standard Chartered's US\$1.5 billion investment in its **wealth-management** business over the next five years.

The bank's shares jumped 5.2 per cent to HK\$197 early yesterday after the results announcement, before retreating to close at HK\$190.80. They have risen 1.5 per cent this year, compared with a 1 per cent drop for the Hang Seng Index over the same period.

The London-based bank, which generates most of its business in Hong Kong and other markets in Asia, the Middle East and Africa, said its **wealth-management** division revenue jumped 32 per cent to US\$1.04 billion, from US\$778 million a year earlier.

This growth was supported by US\$18 billion in net new money and 73,000 new clients onboarded in the first quarter of 2026.

Net interest income in the quarter rose 1 per cent to US\$2.9 billion from a year earlier, while the bank's net interest margin, a key measure of profitability, narrowed 7 basis points year on year to 2.05 per cent.

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Document SCMP000020260430em510001e



Business

StanChart profit rises 19% as wealth management offsets lower rates and rising bad loans

Enoch Yiu

736 words

30 April 2026

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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Wealth management gains support earnings, but margin pressure from lower rates and rising credit costs weigh on overall performance

Standard Chartered's first-quarter profit rose 19 per cent as it achieved strong **wealth-management** performance, which was offset by lower interest rates and rising bad debt provisions due to the Middle East conflicts.

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The bank's credit quality in Hong Kong remains stable as the city's residential and prime offices have shown signs of recovery.

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Document SCMCOM0020260430em4u0008i

DBS Bank: First-quarter net profit rises to SGD 2.93 billion as total income reaches a new high, led by record **wealth management performance; ROE at 17.0%**

Distributed by Contify.com

1,351 words

30 April 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Total income reached a record SGD 5.95 billion, led by **wealth management** performance.

* Return on equity was 17.0% and return on tangible equity was 18.7%.

* Net interest income was little changed, while non-interest income rose 41%.

Original Press Release:

Singapore, Hong Kong, Indonesia, India, China, Taiwan, Regional, April 30 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

- First-quarter net profit rises to SGD 2.93 billion as total income reaches a new high, led by record **wealth management** performance; ROE at 17.0%

DBS Group's net profit for first-quarter 2026 rose 1% from a year ago to SGD 2.93 billion. Total income reached a record of SGD 5.95 billion, led by robust **wealth management** performance, which drove fee income and treasury customer sales to new highs. Deposit growth momentum was strong, while markets trading income rose. These more than offset the impact of lower interest rates and a stronger Singapore dollar. The cost-income ratio was 39%. Asset quality was resilient, with the NPL ratio stable at 1.0% and specific allowances at 14 basis points of loans. Return on equity was 17.0%, while return on tangible equity was 18.7%.

Compared to the previous quarter, net profit was 24% higher. Net interest income was little changed on a day-adjusted basis, as rate pressures were offset by hedging and balance sheet growth. Non-interest income rose 41%, with double-digit increases in fee income and treasury customer sales, while markets trading income more than doubled. Expenses declined 3%, while specific allowances more than halved.

The Board declared an ordinary dividend of SGD 66 cents per share and a Capital Return dividend of SGD 15 cents per share for the first quarter.

Quarter-on-quarter performance

Group net interest income was little changed on a day-adjusted basis at SGD 3.49 billion as the impact of lower Sora and Hibor, as well as foreign exchange translation from a stronger Singapore dollar, was offset by hedging and balance sheet growth. Group net interest margin narrowed four basis points to 1.89%. Commercial book net interest income of SGD 3.48 billion was also little changed on a day-adjusted basis.

Loans rose 2% or SGD 8 billion in constant-currency terms to SGD 453 billion. Non-trade corporate loans increased 2% or SGD 5 billion from broad-based growth across the region and a range of industries. Non-housing consumer loans increased 4% or SGD 2 billion, while trade and housing loans each rose 1% or SGD 1 billion.

Deposits rose 3% or SGD 19 billion to SGD 630 billion, led by growth in Casa balances. The Casa ratio improved slightly to 55%.

Commercial book net fee income rose 35% to SGD 1.48 billion. The increase was led by **wealth management** fees, which reached a record SGD 907 million driven by higher investment product sales and bancassurance.

Transaction services fees were also at a new high of SGD 257 million, while loan-related fees were higher at SGD 209 million. These increases were partially offset by lower investment banking and card fees.

Commercial book other non-interest income rose 24% to SGD 602 million, driven by treasury customer sales to **wealth management** and corporate customers, which reached a new high.

Markets trading income increased to SGD 389 million from higher contributions across a range of activities, benefitting from market volatility and lower funding costs.

Expenses of SGD 2.30 billion were 3% lower due to declines in non-staff costs. The cost-income ratio was 39%.

Profit before allowances rose 23% to SGD 3.65 billion.

Year-on-year performance

Group net interest income declined 5% as net interest margin narrowed 23 basis points from lower interest rates and a stronger Singapore dollar. Rate pressures were mitigated by hedging and balance sheet growth. Loans grew 6% or SGD 25 billion in constant-currency terms, led by corporate loans, while deposits were 12% or SGD 66 billion higher, with more than two-thirds of the increase from Casa balances. Commercial book net interest income declined 7% as net interest margin fell.

Commercial book net fee income grew 16%, led by higher **wealth management** fees. Investment banking, transaction services and card fees were also higher.

Commercial book other non-interest income rose 10%, driven by record treasury customer sales.

Markets trading income increased 7%, supported by lower funding costs and improved trading conditions.

Expenses rose 4% led by higher staff costs, and profit before allowances was little changed.

Balance sheet

Asset quality was resilient. Non-performing assets fell 3% from the previous quarter to SGD 4.72 billion as new non-performing asset formation was low and more than offset by repayments and write-offs. The NPL ratio was stable at 1.0%. Specific allowances were SGD 157 million or 14 basis points of loans. Allowance coverage stood at 131% and at 200% after considering collateral.

Liquidity remained healthy. The liquidity coverage ratio of 151% and net stable funding ratio of 117% were both well above regulatory requirements.

The reported Common Equity Tier-1 ratio was 16.9% based on transitional arrangements, while the pro-forma ratio on a fully phased-in basis was 14.8%. The leverage ratio of 5.9% was well above the regulatory minimum of 3%.

DBS CEO Tan Su Shan said, "We had a strong start to the year, with record total income and a return on equity of 17% despite continued rate headwinds and heightened geopolitical uncertainty. The quarter was anchored by record **wealth management** performance, alongside robust deposit growth, record transaction services fees and stronger markets trading income. This reflects the resilience of our franchise and our ability to capture opportunities and support client needs amidst a challenging environment.

"While the Iran war and its potential second-order effects have added uncertainty to the outlook, our stress tests indicate that our credit portfolio remains sound. Our solid balance sheet, with prudent general allowance buffers, strong capital position and robust liquidity, underpins our resilience.

"We also continue to invest in structural growth initiatives, including transformational technology, to enhance how we serve our customers and capture long-term opportunities."

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named "World's Best Bank" by Global Finance, "World's Best Bank" by Euromoney and "Global Bank of the Year" by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging

digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named "World's Best Digital Bank" by Euromoney and the world's "Most Innovative in Digital Banking" by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the "Safest Bank in Asia" award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025.

DBS provides a full range of services in consumer, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region's most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by uplifting lives and livelihoods of those in need. It provides essential needs to the underprivileged, and fosters inclusion by equipping the underserved with financial and digital literacy skills. It also nurtures innovative social enterprises that create positive impact.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Investment Banking, Financial Performance, Dividend Updates]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

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HSBC **Private Bank** appoints Head of Global India

Distributed by Contify.com

420 words

29 April 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC **Private Bank** appoints Gautam Anand as Head of Global India, effective 24 April 2026.

* Gautam brings 25+ years of experience in **private banking**, wealth management, and investment banking.

* He will lead Global India **private banking** franchise, overseeing coverage across India and key international hubs.

Original Press Release:

April 29 -- HSBC **Private Bank** issued the following news release:

HSBC today announced the appointment of Gautam Anand as Head of Global India, HSBC **Private Bank**, effective 24 April 2026. The appointment will play a key role in strengthening connectivity across HSBC's international network for Global India clients.

Gautam brings over 25 years of experience across **private banking**, wealth management, and investment banking. Prior to joining HSBC **Private Bank** in December 2023 as Global Coordinator, Global India, Middle East, North Africa and Europe, he held senior leadership roles across various international financial institutions, where he was responsible for driving the growth of South Asian and Global India client businesses across Asia.

In his new role, Gautam will lead the Global India **private banking** franchise, overseeing coverage across India, and key international hubs including Dubai, Hong Kong, Singapore and the UK, with a focus on delivering holistic client solutions for Global India clients. He will report to Tommy Leung, Head of **Private Bank**, South Asia and Aladdin Hangari, Head of **Private Bank**, MENAT.

Commenting on the appointment, Tommy Leung, Head of **Private Bank**, South Asia said: "As our clients become increasingly international in their outlook, the ability to deliver seamless cross-market solutions remains a key priority. Gautam brings deep experience and a strong track record in leading Global India client businesses, and his appointment will further strengthen how we connect our teams and capabilities across markets to better serve our clients."

About HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 56 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,233 billion at 31 December 2025, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Investment Banking, Management Changes]

Source: HSBC **Private Bank**

COMPANIES & MARKETS

Volatility pushing the wealthy to focus on risk, succession: HSBC's Tommy Leung

Jean Low

746 words

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MARKET volatility is forcing high-net-worth investors to reshape their priorities, with **private-banking** conversations shifting away from pure returns towards risk management, diversification and succession planning, said Tommy Leung, HSBC's head of global **private banking** for South Asia.

The shift is especially pronounced among entrepreneurs, who account for about two-thirds of HSBC's **private banking** clients and whose wealth remains closely tied to their operating markets.

For this group, the need to diversify has therefore become more pressing, prompting more families to diversify geographically and use Singapore as an offshore booking centre, Leung noted.

"Diversification is highly correlated to the amount of wealth a client has," he said. "I do not think it is about one single geopolitical trigger that has led to this diversification, but... (instead) the client's needs and overall level of wealth."

Having multiple booking centres has become more attractive as a result, he added.

When setting up family offices in Singapore, clients evaluating where to base their assets weigh several factors. These include legal stability, ease of doing business, tax frameworks, and ease of access to opportunities and professionals for support networks.

"Singapore ranks highly across all these different areas," Leung observed. "It may not be the absolute top in each category, but on balance, it is way ahead of the competition."

Beyond geographic diversification, risk management has taken on renewed urgency as market volatility rises.

Leung said that clients increasingly need to understand how systemic shocks, such as sharp movements in interest rates or oil prices, impact their portfolios.

Banks such as HSBC are deploying quantitative tools that draw on historical data to model how past crises – such as the 1973 oil shock during the Yom Kippur War – would play out across the current holdings in clients' portfolios, he noted. These can allow clients to understand and manage their risk better.

Current geopolitical tensions have also put the notion of safe-haven assets to the test. Leung observed that during recent risk-off periods, only a narrow subset of assets actually rallied – chiefly, the US dollar, and to some extent, mega-cap US technology companies.

The performance of financial assets often depends on "positioning", he added. For instance, gold – traditionally a safe haven – saw sell-offs in recent weeks because it had become a "crowded trade".

"What is a safe haven today may not be a safe haven tomorrow," Leung explained. "What you really want to know is where the risks are hidden in your portfolio, so you can be prepared if something material happens."

On the recent wave of private-credit redemptions in the United States, Leung said that investor education is critical, particularly around the illiquid nature and limited transparency of these products.

To manage risk in private markets, sizing is key, he noted, adding that it provides "tremendous value" in a diversified portfolio.

"If you do not invest in private markets, you are missing a huge chunk of the opportunities globally," he explained. "Private markets still offer you a decent private-market premium or liquidity premium that adds to the longer-term return."

Leung added that, amid risks and volatility, opportunities remain, such as the "very exciting space" of artificial intelligence. "Not just AI, but the new economy, new technology in general."

However, he cautioned that these assets and opportunities are often "richly valued", flagging the need for understanding valuations and the "right price" even within compelling themes.

Wealth planning conversations are also shifting in scope, extending beyond asset management to longer-term questions of legacy.

"The roles that these entrepreneurs play are also different compared to before," Leung said. "They are the founders of businesses, and they themselves are investors."

He added that these entrepreneurs tend to have twin imperatives of extracting liquidity from assets and preserving wealth across generations.

This transition involves a new generation stepping into the frame with a different set of challenges, inheriting not just wealth, but also significant responsibility.

As these businesses mature, Leung sees more conversations moving towards separating ownership from day-to-day operations.

He noted that **private banks** are engaging clients earlier in the process, helping to build networks, drawing on lessons from past experiences, and laying the groundwork to diversify and protect wealth for the long term.

These, he said, all add up to diversify, protect and ultimately transfer wealth across generations.

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DBS PB's Thailand, Philippines market head joins Lombard Odier

Citywire Asia Staff

207 words

28 April 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

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DBS Private Bank's Thailand and Philippines market head has joined Lombard Odier as Southeast Asia market head.

Edwin Tan has joined the Swiss private bank, after being in DBS for two years, according to a 28 April release. Based in Singapore, he will report to Omar Shokur, regional head for Asia, private clients, effective 13 July.

'Lombard Odier is in full expansion mode in Asia,' said Shokur. 'Southeast Asia remains a key strategic priority for us.'

Tan's hire follows the appointment of Andrea Meierhofer, Southeast Asia market head in December 2024, and Alfred Low in September 2025 who leads Lombard Odier's North Asia market.

At DBS, Tan rebuilt the bank's Thailand onshore business and expanded the talent base in key markets such as the Philippines and Thailand, according to the release.

Prior to joining DBS, Tan was at UBS Global Wealth Management, where he was market group head for its Thailand onshore and offshore market team. He was previously a Bangkok-based market group head for the Philippines, Thailand and Vietnam at Credit Suisse for a year.

Tan has also worked at SCB Julius Baer and Siam Commercial Bank, based in Thailand.

Document CWIRAS0020260428em4s00001

Exclusive: Julius Baer bulks up NRI team with trio hire in Hong Kong

Priyanka Boghani

199 words

27 April 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Julius Baer has hired three private bankers to cover the global Indian market based in Hong Kong, Citywire Asia can reveal.

The bank will onboard Rajat Sood and Saurav Sekhar from DBS Hong Kong, according to sources. It has already hired Anshul Rai from Standard Chartered.

Sood is understood to report to group head Kapil Kapoor, who has a reporting line to market head Kunal Sumaya.

A spokesperson from the bank declined to comment on the hires.

Sood and Sekhar were both at DBS Hong Kong. Sood was most recently global Indian and international clients head at DBS Treasures, as of four months ago, according to his LinkedIn profile. Sekhar was at DBS Private Bank, while Rai worked at Standard Chartered for over two years based in Singapore, where he covered the Global South Asia market as well.

The hires come as the NRI market [shrinks](#) in Hong Kong, resulting in many bankers relocating to Singapore or Dubai to cover the moneyed diaspora.

The overall number of NRI bankers are also shrinking, with the usual reshuffle last year exposing an increasingly [shallower](#) talent pool.

Document CWIRAS0020260427em4r00002



Business

Life insurance sales in Hong Kong hit record amid 'rise of millionaires'

Enoch Yiu

843 words

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scmp.com

SCMCOM

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Industry wrote US\$42.2 billion in new life policies last year, 'capturing both onshore and offshore demand across Asia', HSBC Life CEO says

Life insurance sales in Hong Kong rose 50.6 per cent to another record last year as affluent customers continued to buy policies in the city for wealth transfer, protection and medical needs.

The industry wrote HK\$330.9 billion (US\$42.2 billion) in new life policies in 2025, compared with HK\$219 billion a year earlier, [which was also a record](#), according to data from the Insurance Authority released on Friday.

The continuous growth of the business in recent years was due to more wealthy people setting up **family offices** in the city and using insurance policies to transfer wealth to the next generation, said Paul Murray, CEO of Swiss Re's life and health business.

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Hong Kong does not charge estate duty and has offered tax incentives for single **family offices** since 2023, which Murray cited as factors attracting wealthy families.

Hong Kong had more than 3,380 single-**family offices** operating in the city as of the end of 2025, an increase of about 680 over the past two years, according to a study by the Hong Kong Institute for Monetary and Financial Research.

"The rise of millionaires in Hong Kong led to an increase in **family offices** because of its friendly jurisdiction, rule of law and low-tax regime," Murray said. "They found Hong Kong to be an ideal location for succession planning, and that led to increased sales of insurance policies."

Murray added that high-net-worth policies paid out compensation quickly upon the demise of policyholders, helping family members avoid selling assets under unfavourable economic circumstances.

HSBC Life remained the top seller of new policies for the fourth year in a row, accounting for 15.5 per cent of sales, the Insurance Authority data showed.

Daisy Tsang, CEO of HSBC Life Hong Kong and Macau, said insurance sales had been particularly strong in the high-net-worth segment in Asia. The rising number of affluent customers, driven by the growing Asian economy, was expanding the pool of individuals seeking to protect wealth and plan for intergenerational transfer, she said.

A recent HSBC survey of 900 high-net-worth individuals found that 60 per cent had not yet taken part in wealth-transfer planning for their combined US\$5.8 billion in wealth, representing a large population of potential new clients.

"The internationalisation of wealth planning is strengthening Hong Kong's role as a regional hub, with deep capital markets and a strong advisory ecosystem enabling it to capture both onshore and offshore demand across Asia," Tsang said.

"Asia's ageing population is increasing demand for retirement and protection solutions as people live longer and spend more years outside the workforce."

Swiss Re provided reinsurance to support direct insurers in offering these products, Murray said.

"High-net-worth insurance is a very rapid area of growth in Hong Kong and other markets in the Asia-Pacific, where it holds around 30 per cent of the wealth of global high-net-worth individuals," he said.

Patrick Graham, CEO of Manulife Hong Kong and Macau, said mainland visitors remained a key growth driver for the Hong Kong insurance industry.

"Hong Kong's insurance industry maintained strong momentum throughout 2025, driven by sustained demand for savings, health, protection and legacy solutions," Graham said.

"Continued interest from both local customers and mainland Chinese visitors highlights Hong Kong's strengths as a well-connected international financial centre and a key hub within the Greater Bay Area."

The number of mainland visitors to the city rose 11 per cent to 37.83 million last year, accounting for 76 per cent of total tourists, according to data from the Hong Kong Tourism Board.

The Insurance Authority did not disclose statistics on sales to mainland visitors last year, as it was reviewing how to define and identify mainland visitors and other overseas visitors.

Graham said high-net-worth individuals were increasingly demanding cross-border and intergenerational wealth and legacy planning, reinforcing Hong Kong's appeal as a preferred wealth-planning destination in Asia.

BOC Life CEO Wilson Tang said there was strong demand for retirement products as a result of the ageing population. People aged 65 and above accounted for 22 per cent of Hong Kong's 7.5 million residents last year, which would rise to 31 per cent by 2036, according to an official forecast.

"The silver economy is providing new business opportunities for insurers," Tang said. "BOC Life has provided retirement products to meet the needs of customers who want to retire and live in the Greater Bay Area and other mainland cities."

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Hong Kong - Banking - Competitive Landscape

3,062 words

23 April 2026

MarketLine Industry Profiles Online

DMRP

English

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The Hong Kong banking industry is primarily dominated by players such as BOCHK , SCBL, and HSBC . The leading players are based in Hong Kong and China, indicating the well-diversified geographical presence of the leading players in the industry. There is not much differentiation in the industry, as all the main players offer similar financial products to consumers and operate with similar strategies. The only way a player could get a competitive edge over their peers is if that player was involved in a government project or financed a low-risk endeavor.

Who are the leading players?

The Hong Kong and Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd. (HSBC)

HSBC Hong Kong, a subsidiary of HSBC Holdings Plc , is the largest bank in Hong Kong, with a 37.1% market share in 2025. In January 2026, HSBC officially completed the \$13.6 billion buyout of Hang Seng Bank , which is now a wholly-owned subsidiary. The bank offers personal, commercial, and corporate banking; insurance; wealth and asset management; money and capital markets; and treasury and securities solutions in Asia-Pacific. HSBC operates under six segments: wealth and personal banking, commercial banking, global banking, markets and securities services, corporate center, and others. HSBC primarily operates in various Asia-Pacific countries, including Hong Kong, China, India, Australia, Malaysia, Singapore, Indonesia, Taiwan, and others. HSBC 's global businesses operate in 62 countries and territories, serving approximately 42 million customers globally.

Bank of China (Hong Kong) Ltd. (BOCHK)

BOCHK , a subsidiary of BOC Hong Kong (Holdings) Ltd. , is the second-largest bank in Hong Kong, with a market share of 23.8% in 2025. The bank is based in Hong Kong and offers banking services, including corporate, private, enrichment, and **wealth management**. It provides products like time deposits, current accounts, savings accounts, personal loans, business loans, and credit cards. BOCHK also offers life, travel, and medical insurance. It also provides ecommerce, investment, RMB, remittance, trade finance, treasury, and payroll services. It caters to personal, corporate, and institutional customers in Hong Kong and China.

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd. (SCBL)

SCBL, a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC , is the third-largest bank in Hong Kong, with a 0.2% market share in 2025. The bank is based in Hong Kong and offers personal, private, SME, and wholesale banking services to individual and corporate customers. SCBL classifies its operations into four segments: corporate, commercial, and institutional banking; consumer, private, and business banking; central and other items; and ventures. As of December 31, 2024, it had assets of HKD2,569,032 million (\$329.4 billion), loans and advances to customers of HKD953,252 million (\$122.2 billion), and deposits from customers of HKD1,763,250 million (\$226.2 billion).

What are the strategies of the leading players?

HSBC 's strategy in Asia builds on 160 years of experience in the region, aligning with the biggest opportunities to create further shareholder value. The major goals include becoming the leading international wealth, corporate, and institutional bank by market share across Asia, extending the strengths of its leading Hong Kong franchise into key growth markets such as mainland China, India, and the ASEAN region, and supporting the transition to a low-carbon economy through sustainable finance solutions. The bank invests in its people and technology, focuses on connecting Asian markets and the world through HSBC 's global network, and continually streamlines its organization to realize greater operating efficiencies through technology.

SCBL is executing a strategy focused on becoming a leading "Global Hausbank" by combining its extensive cross-border network with specialized **wealth management** expertise. The bank is investing \$1.5 billion over five

years to target \$200 billion in net new money, with a specific focus on affluent clients across Asia, Africa, and the Middle East. In Hong Kong, its digital strategy is central to its growth, featuring the expansion of its virtual bank, Mox, and the integration of generative artificial intelligence (AI) to enhance risk management and customer research. Furthermore, the bank is a major proponent of sustainable finance, aiming for net-zero operations and supporting clients' transitions to greener business models.

BOCHK's strategy is anchored in its role as a "super-connector" between the Chinese mainland and international markets, leveraging its position as a major Renminbi (RMB) clearing bank. The bank is prioritizing cross-border solutions within the Greater Bay Area (GBA) and expanding its corporate banking presence along the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) corridors to capture trade and wealth flows. Its digital acceleration plan includes the use of AI for credit scoring and anti-fraud, as well as exploring digital currencies like Electronic Chinese Yuan (e-CNY) to grow transaction volumes. BOCHK also maintains a strong focus on high-quality development through green finance, targeting a 20-30% growth rate in its sustainable loan book through 2027.

How are industry players responding to trends in the industry?

The Hong Kong banking industry is undergoing a significant digital transformation, characterized by the rapid expansion of virtual banks, open banking frameworks, and a heavy emphasis on AI-driven hyper-personalization. Local and international institutions are leading this shift, evolving from branch-reliant models into integrated digital ecosystems that provide 24/7 access to financial and lifestyle services via advanced mobile platforms. For instance, HSBC Hong Kong has integrated its "Communication Amplifier" generative AI platform to create tailored marketing content and uses its "WealthSignal Engine" to provide real-time, data-driven insights for **wealth management** clients. Standard Chartered is leveraging its "Standard Chartered's proprietary Generative AI (SC GPT)" internal platform and AI-powered "Foreign Exchange (FX) Intelligent Expert" to deliver instant, multilingual market briefings and personalized customer engagement. Meanwhile, virtual banks like Mox Bank continue to set benchmarks with mobile-first features such as the all-in-one Mox Card, allowing users to "flip" between credit and debit spending instantly. Hong Kong banks are also increasingly adopting hybrid and multi-cloud solutions for operational agility, while advanced data analytics are utilized extensively for high-precision fraud detection, automated credit scoring, and strict regulatory compliance under the HKMA's Fintech 2025 strategy.

What have been the recent developments in the industry?

In April 2026, the Hong Kong Monetary Authority (HKMA) made history by granting the city's first two stablecoin issuer licences to HSBC and Anchorpoint Financial. This regulatory milestone establishes a framework for digital currencies pegged to the Hong Kong dollar, aiming to enhance payment efficiency and support the city's Web3 ecosystem.

In January 2026, HSBC officially completed the privatization of its subsidiary, Hang Seng Bank, for \$13.6 billion. Following shareholder approval, Hang Seng was delisted from the Hong Kong Stock Exchange (HKEX) on 27 January 2026. This strategic move allows HSBC to fully integrate Hang Seng's operations and capital into its broader Hong Kong business line to drive greater efficiency.

In October 2025, the Hong Kong Monetary Authority (HKMA), the city's central banking institution and regulator, launched the second phase of its Generative AI (GenA.I.) Sandbox to accelerate the practical application of artificial intelligence in finance. This collaborative initiative involves 20 major banks and 14 technology partners working together to move AI use cases from small-scale experimentation to secure, large-scale implementation across the industry. By providing a controlled environment for testing, the HKMA helps banks integrate advanced AI for tasks.

This section contains brief overviews of the leading companies in the Hong Kong banking industry.

Company

Company Name: Bank of China (Hong Kong) Ltd

Bank of China (Hong Kong) Ltd (BOCHK), a subsidiary of BOC Hong Kong (Holdings) Ltd, is a bank that offers corporate banking, **private banking**, enrich banking, and **wealth management** services. The company offers products such as time deposit, current accounts, savings accounts, personal loans, business loans, and credit cards. It provides life insurance, travel insurance, motor vehicle insurance, and medical and accident insurance. BOCHK provides services including e-commerce services, financial institutions, investment services, RMB services, remittance, trade finance and services, treasury services, and payroll services, among others. The company caters its products and services to personal, corporate, and institutional customers. It has operations in Hong Kong and China. BOCHK is headquartered in Hong Kong.

Head office: Bank of China Tower 1 Garden Road, Hong Kong City, Hong Kong (China SAR)

Website: www.bochk.com

Financial Year End: April

Company Overview

Bank of China (Hong Kong) Ltd (BOCHK), a subsidiary of BOC Hong Kong (Holdings) Ltd, is a bank that offers corporate banking, **private banking**, enrich banking, and **wealth management** services. The company offers products such as time deposit, current accounts, savings accounts, personal loans, business loans, and credit cards. It provides life insurance, travel insurance, motor vehicle insurance, and medical and accident insurance. BOCHK provides services including e-commerce services, financial institutions, investment services, RMB services, remittance, trade finance and services, treasury services, and payroll services, among others. The company caters its products and services to personal, corporate, and institutional customers. It has operations in Hong Kong and China. BOCHK is headquartered in Hong Kong.

Company

Company Name: Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd (SCBL), a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, offers personal, private, SME, and wholesale banking solutions. It includes savings, current, and time deposits. It provides loans such as personal and mortgage loans, credit cards, investment products and services, and retirement solutions. The bank also offers overdrafts, lines of credit, working capital finance, business installment loans, cash management, foreign exchange, securities services, market insights, remittances, and **private banking**. It offers insurance for travel, home, medical care, life, and critical illness. The bank operates through various channels such as online banking, mobile banking, and telephone banking, among others. SCBL is headquartered in Hong Kong.

Head office: 32nd Floor 4-4A Des Voeux Road, Central, Hong Kong City, Hong Kong (China SAR)

Website: www.sc.com/hk

Financial Year End: December

Company Overview

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd (SCBL), a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, offers personal, private, SME, and wholesale banking solutions. It includes savings, current, and time deposits. It provides loans such as personal and mortgage loans, credit cards, investment products and services, and retirement solutions. The bank also offers overdrafts, lines of credit, working capital finance, business installment loans, cash management, foreign exchange, securities services, market insights, remittances, and **private banking**. It offers insurance for travel, home, medical care, life, and critical illness. The bank operates through various channels such as online banking, mobile banking, and telephone banking, among others. SCBL is headquartered in Hong Kong.

Business Description

Standard Chartered Bank (Hong Kong) Ltd (SCBL) offers personal, private, SME, and wholesale banking services to individual and corporate customers.

As of December 31, 2024, it had assets of HKD2,569,032 million, loans and advances to customers of HKD953,252 million, and deposits from customers of HKD1,763,250 million.

SCBL classifies its operations into three segments: Corporate & Investment Banking; Wealth & Retail Banking; and Ventures.

Geographically, the company operates in four regions, namely, Hong Kong, Mainland China, Taiwan, and Korea.

Company

Company Name: The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corp Ltd

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corp Ltd (HSBC) is a subsidiary of HSBC Holdings plc, providing a wide range of domestic and international banking and financial services primarily in the Asia-Pacific region. The bank's main activities include offering savings and current accounts, mortgages, debit and credit cards, loans, and investment products. HSBC's notable services encompass treasury services, global asset management, insurance products, and **wealth management** solutions. The bank serves a diverse customer base, ranging from personal banking clients to ultra-high-net-worth individuals, as well as commercial customers such as small and medium-sized enterprises and corporates. The bank operates in various geographic locations, including Hong Kong, China, India, Australia, Indonesia, Malaysia, Singapore, and Taiwan. HSBC is headquartered in Hong Kong.

Head office: 1 Queen's Road Central HSBC Main Building, Hong Kong City, Hong Kong (China SAR)

Website: www.hsbc.com.hk

Financial Year End: December

Company Overview

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corp Ltd (HSBC) is a subsidiary of HSBC Holdings plc, providing a wide range of domestic and international banking and financial services primarily in the Asia-Pacific region. The bank's main activities include offering savings and current accounts, mortgages, debit and credit cards, loans, and investment products. HSBC's notable services encompass treasury services, global asset management, insurance products, and **wealth management** solutions. The bank serves a diverse customer base, ranging from personal banking clients to ultra-high-net-worth individuals, as well as commercial customers such as small and medium-sized enterprises and corporates. The bank operates in various geographic locations, including Hong Kong, China, India, Australia, Indonesia, Malaysia, Singapore, and Taiwan. HSBC is headquartered in Hong Kong.

Business Description

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corp Ltd (HSBC) provides a comprehensive range of domestic and international banking and related financial services, primarily in the Asia-Pacific region. The bank offers personal, commercial, and corporate banking, insurance, wealth and asset management, money and capital market services, and treasury and securities solutions.

As of December 31, 2024, HSBC reported total assets of HKD10,948,940 million, loans and advances to customers of HKD3,494,298 million, and customer deposits of HKD6,564,606 million. HSBC operates in various Asia-Pacific countries, including Hong Kong, China, India, Australia, Malaysia, Singapore, Indonesia, and Taiwan.

The bank operates through six business segments: Wealth and Personal Banking, Commercial Banking, Global Banking, Markets and Securities Services, Corporate Centre and Other (GBM-other).

Market Definition

The banking industry involves the activities of banks and similar institutions that offer financial services such as savings, loans, mortgages, and related services to businesses and consumers. Market value represents the total assets held by banks or related institutions in a country in a year. The market share represents the total assets held by the companies in the specific year. Geographical segmentation measures the total assets held by commercial banks of a particular region.

The market is segmented into bank credit, inter-bank loans, cash assets, trading assets, and others. The scope of others includes investments, loans receivable, and fixed assets. Bank credit refers to funds that a bank lends to individuals, businesses, or other entities. Inter-bank loans are loans made between banks. These loans serve as a mechanism for banks to manage their short-term liquidity needs and meet regulatory requirements. Cash asset products of banks provide customers with a secure and convenient way to manage their cash holdings while earning potential returns on their funds. Customers can choose from a variety of products based on their financial goals, risk tolerance, and liquidity needs. Bank trading assets refer to financial instruments and securities that banks hold primarily for trading to generate profits. These assets are actively bought and sold within the bank's trading desk or investment division to capitalize on short-term price fluctuations, market trends, or arbitrage opportunities. Trading assets can encompass a wide range of financial instruments such as equities, commodities, and foreign exchange.

All market data and forecasts are based on nominal prices, and all currency conversions used in the creation of this report have been calculated using yearly average exchange rates. The USD values may show a declining trend for a few countries, such as Argentina, Turkey, Nigeria, Egypt, and Russia. This is primarily because of the impact of exchange rates considered.

For the purpose of this report, the global market consists of North America, South America, Europe, Asia-Pacific, Scandinavia, and the Middle East & Africa.

North America consists of Canada, Mexico, and the US.

South America comprises Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, and Peru.

Europe comprises Germany, France, Italy, Russia, Spain, the Netherlands, Turkey, Switzerland, Sweden, Belgium, Poland, Norway, Austria, Denmark, Greece, Finland, Portugal, Ireland, the Czech Republic, and the UK.

Scandinavia comprises Denmark, Norway, and Sweden.

Asia-Pacific comprises China, Japan, India, Australia, South Korea, Indonesia, Taiwan, Thailand, Malaysia, Singapore, the Philippines, Pakistan, New Zealand, Hong Kong, Vietnam, and Kazakhstan.

The Middle East & Africa comprises South Africa, Nigeria, Saudi Arabia, Israel, Egypt, Kenya, Morocco, and the UAE.

The Hong Kong banking industry is overseen by a collaborative network of regulatory bodies, each playing a crucial role in maintaining financial stability and consumer confidence. At the forefront is the Hong Kong Monetary Authority (HKMA), the de facto central bank and primary regulator responsible for supervising banks, restricted licence banks, and deposit-taking companies. The HKMA adopts a risk-based approach to monitor compliance with financial regulations, oversees anti-money laundering (AML) measures, issues licenses under a three-tier system, and conducts on-site inspections to ensure market integrity. Supporting this is the Financial Services and the Treasury Bureau, which formulates the overall policy for the financial services sector, while the Securities and Futures Commission (SFC) jointly regulates institutions engaged in securities activities. Additionally, the Banking Complaints Procedures and the Code of Banking Practice provide mechanisms for resolving disputes and setting standards for customer relations, strengthening trust in the system.

The Hong Kong banking industry operates under a robust and evolving legislative framework spearheaded by the Banking Ordinance (Cap. 155), which integrates core elements of Basel III and mandates high capital adequacy standards, with local banks maintaining an average capital adequacy ratio often exceeding 20%. As a global financial hub, Hong Kong implements international standards to enable cross-border financial services while ensuring that authorized institutions comply with consolidated supervision. Licensing requirements specify that a corporation must meet minimum capital thresholds, such as HKD300 million (\$38.4 million) for a licensed bank, and demonstrate "fit and proper" management. The Anti-Money Laundering and Counter-Terrorist Financing Ordinance (AMLO) enforces strong due diligence and comprehensive reporting in alignment with Financial Action Task Force (FATF) standards. Lending practices are governed by strict macroprudential tools, including a maximum Loan-to-Value (LTV) ratio of 70% for many residential properties and rigorous Debt Servicing Ratio (DSR) limits, designed to guard against market overexposure and ensure consumer protection. These rigorous regulations have a profound impact on Hong Kong's banking industry, fostering a resilient and trustworthy financial environment. By mandating high capital requirements, comprehensive three-tier licensing standards, and strict conduct in lending and AML, regulators help safeguard financial stability and consumer interests. Adherence to evolving international standards and the adoption of RegTech ensure Hong Kong banks remain competitive and seamlessly integrated with global markets.

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Singapore - Banking - Competitive Landscape

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MarketLine Industry Profiles Online

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English

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The Singaporean banking industry is primarily dominated by a few key players, including DBS, UOB , OCBC , and SCBC. All these leading banks are based in Singapore, highlighting the significant presence of domestic banks in the industry. There is limited differentiation within the industry, as the main players tend to offer similar financial products to consumers and follow similar operational strategies. The only means by which a bank might gain a competitive advantage over its rivals is by financing low-risk ventures or engaging in government projects.

Who are the leading players?

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS)

DBS, through its principal subsidiary, DBS Bank , is the largest bank in Singapore, with an industry share of 38.2% in 2025. DBS is based in Singapore and offers consumer, corporate, and small and medium enterprises (SME) banking and other financial solutions. It also provides cash management, **wealth management**, and capital markets solutions. DBS classifies its operations into four segments: institutional banking, consumer banking/ **wealth management**, treasury markets, and others. As per the latest data available, as of December 31, 2024, it had assets of SGD827.2 billion (\$633.1 billion).

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB)

UOB is the second-largest bank in Singapore, with an industry share of 22.6% in 2025. The bank is based in Singapore and provides personal, commercial, business, private, and investment banking solutions. It also offers corporate finance, asset management, insurance, treasury, capital markets, venture capital management, and stock broking services. UOB classifies its operations into four segments: group retail (GR), group wholesale banking (GWB), others, and global markets (GM). As per the latest data, as of December 31, 2024, it had assets of SGD537.7 billion (\$411.5 billion).

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC)

OCBC is the third-largest bank in Singapore, with an industry share of 19.7% in 2025. The bank is based in Singapore and is a provider of consumer, corporate, investment, private, and transaction banking, as well as global treasury and stockbroking services. It also carries out insurance and asset management business activities through its subsidiaries. OCBC classifies its operations into five segments: global consumer and **private banking** (GCPB), global wholesale banking (GWB), insurance, global Treasury and markets (GTM), and others. As per the latest data available, as of December 31, 2024, OCBC operated through more than 400 branches and representative offices in Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the US, Indonesia, Australia, the UK, the UAE, and Luxembourg. As per the latest data available, as of December 31, 2024, it had assets of SGD625.1 billion (\$478.4 billion).

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd (SCBS)

SCBS, a subsidiary of Standard Chartered, is the fourth-largest bank in Singapore, with an industry share of 8.0% in 2025. SCBS is based in Singapore and is an international banking group that provides personal, business, private, SME, wholesale, Islamic, online, and investment banking services to personal and business customers globally. Standard Chartered classifies its business operations into four segments: corporate, commercial & institutional banking, consumer private & business banking, central & other items, and Ventures.

What are the strategies of the leading players?

DBS is strategically positioned to capitalize on global megatrends, including Asia's robust economic expansion, increasing intra-regional trade, swift technological breakthroughs, and the widespread transition toward

sustainability. The bank focuses on facilitating trade and capital flows while driving wealth creation throughout Asia, supported by an expanding footprint across Greater China, South Asia, and Southeast Asia. A central component of the company's strategy involves bolstering its technological resilience, refining its risk management frameworks, and optimizing operational processes across every industry in which it operates. Moreover, DBS is committed to advancing its climate risk management and stress-testing protocols while actively working to neutralize financial crime and cybersecurity risks. To reach these objectives, the group utilizes a mix of organic growth and inorganic acquisitions, broadening its comprehensive full-service banking offerings within its key industries of Singapore, Hong Kong, India, and Taiwan.

OCBC has formulated a comprehensive three-year corporate strategy designed to propel significant growth while simultaneously solidifying its foundational institutional strengths. The bank's strategic framework is primarily centered on capturing the expanding flows of regional trade, investments, and capital wealth throughout Asia. Among the core objectives and operational plans under this initiative are the capture of burgeoning Asian wealth via its integrated Singapore and Hong Kong twin hubs and advanced digital propositions, as well as the facilitation of increasing trade and investment corridors between Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) and Greater China. Moreover, the bank intends to unlock significant value from the emerging "new economy" and other high-growth industrial sectors, while actively contributing to the global transition toward a sustainable, low-carbon future. To realize these ambitious targets, OCBC is employing a dual-track approach of organic development and inorganic growth strategies, including the acquisition of PT Bank Commonwealth in Indonesia and increasing its stake in Great Eastern Holdings. Ultimately, the bank plans to significantly deepen its **wealth management** capabilities to bolster its overall competitive standing and industry leadership in the region.

UOB is dedicated to shaping the future of the ASEAN region by supporting both local individuals and businesses, as well as global entities seeking to connect with Southeast Asia. Guided by its core values and underpinned by its fundamental institutional strengths, the group is committed to assisting its customers while simultaneously driving consistent performance across its entire franchise. UOB's methodology for customer support is anchored in a long-term outlook, which ensures a prudent and disciplined balance between pursuing growth and maintaining corporate responsibility. The primary objectives and strategic plans of the group involve the creation of highly personalized financial solutions for both retail and corporate clients, empowering them to reach their financial aspirations through a seamless omnichannel delivery model. Moreover, the group strives to enable its customers to expand sustainably by deeply integrating environmental and social considerations into its business operations, thereby fostering responsible growth that generates a positive and meaningful impact on the economy, society, and the environment. Additionally, UOB intends to bridge its customers across ASEAN, China, and the rest of the international market by leveraging deep sector specialization, strategic ecosystem partnerships, and a unified digital platform through its cohesive "One Bank" approach.

What have been the most recent industry developments?

In January 2026, DBS, a Singapore-based lender, and OCBC, a-Singapore based major regional banking group, initiated a massive reallocation campaign targeting affluent retail and **private banking** clients. This strategic drive aims to convert excess liquid savings into higher-yield, managed investment portfolios as global interest rates begin to stabilize. By capitalising on a resurgence in investment intent, the banks intend to significantly grow their fee-based income throughout the year. The campaign focuses on diversifying client assets into personalized wealth products and sustainable investment funds, with the broader goal of cementing Singapore's position as a premier global **wealth management** hub by the end of 2026.

In May 2025, OCBC announced the strategic integration of its three stockbroking subsidiaries, OCBC Securities (Singapore), OCBC Securities Brokerage (Hong Kong), and PT OCBC Sekuritas (Indonesia), into its global markets division. This realignment, which became effective on July 1, 2025, was designed to streamline operations and reduce structural costs by centralizing the administration of all financial market products, including equities, FX, rates, and credit.

This section contains brief overviews of the leading companies in the Singaporean banking industry.

Company

Company Name: DBS Group Holdings Ltd

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS), through its principal subsidiaries offers a range of banking and financial solutions. The company offers a comprehensive range of services, including personal banking, **wealth management**, and business banking. Its major products include current and savings accounts, fixed deposits, loans, home finance, cards, payments, investment, and insurance products. DBS serves a diverse clientele, including individual consumers, institutional clients, government-linked companies, large corporates, and small

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and medium-sized businesses. It serves through branches and digital platforms. DBS has presence in Singapore, Australia, Bangladesh, China, Hong Kong, India, Taiwan, Thailand, the UAE, the UK, the US, Vietnam, Indonesia, Japan, Korea, Macau, Malaysia, Myanmar, and The Philippines. DBS is headquartered in Singapore.

The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD28,268 million for the fiscal year ended December 2025 (FY2025), a decrease of 8.6% over FY2024. In FY2025, the bank's operating margin was 50.3%, compared to an operating margin of 54.4% in FY2024. In FY2025, the bank recorded a net margin of 27.6%, compared to a net margin of 28.1% in FY2024.

Head office: 12 Marina Boulevard Marina Bay Financial Centre Tower 3, Singapore City, Singapore

Telephone: 6568788888

Fax: 6564451267

Number of Employees: 11000

Website: www.dbs.com/investors/fixed-income/overview

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: D05

Stock Exchange: Singapore Exchange Securities Trading

Company Overview

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS), through its principal subsidiaries offers a range of banking and financial solutions. The company offers a comprehensive range of services, including personal banking, **wealth management**, and business banking. Its major products include current and savings accounts, fixed deposits, loans, home finance, cards, payments, investment, and insurance products. DBS serves a diverse clientele, including individual consumers, institutional clients, government-linked companies, large corporates, and small and medium-sized businesses. It serves through branches and digital platforms. DBS has presence in Singapore, Australia, Bangladesh, China, Hong Kong, India, Taiwan, Thailand, the UAE, the UK, the US, Vietnam, Indonesia, Japan, Korea, Macau, Malaysia, Myanmar, and The Philippines. DBS is headquartered in Singapore. The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD28,268 million for the fiscal year ended December 2025 (FY2025), a decrease of 8.6% over FY2024. In FY2025, the bank's operating margin was 50.3%, compared to an operating margin of 54.4% in FY2024. In FY2025, the bank recorded a net margin of 27.6%, compared to a net margin of 28.1% in FY2024.

Business Description

DBS Group Holdings Ltd (DBS) offers consumer, corporate, and SME banking, and other financial solutions. It also provides cash management, **wealth management**, and capital markets solutions. As of December 31, 2024, it had assets of SGD827,219 million, deposits of SGD561,730 million, and loans and advances to customers of SGD430,594 million. It served 18.4 million individuals and 0.2 million institutional clients.

DBS classifies its operations into four segments: Institutional Banking, Consumer Banking/ **Wealth Management**, Markets Trading, and Others.

Company

Company Name: United Overseas Bank Ltd

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB) is a financial institution that provides banking and other financial-related services. The group's main activities include consumer banking, **private banking**, commercial banking, corporate banking, and institutional banking. UOB offers a wide range of products and services such as deposits, insurance, card services, **wealth management**, investment, and loan products. The group operates under the notable brand name UOB. Its services cater to individual customers, small, medium, and large enterprises, multinational corporations, financial institutions, and government-linked entities. The group operates through its banking subsidiaries in China, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, and Vietnam. It has a global network of branches and offices in Asia Pacific, Europe, and North America. UOB is headquartered in Singapore.

The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD20,676 million for the fiscal year ended December 2025 (FY2025), a decrease of 11.1% over FY2024. In FY2025, the bank's operating margin was 38.3%, compared to an operating margin of 47.1% in FY2024. In FY2025, the bank recorded a net margin of 17.9%, compared to a net margin of 21% in FY2024.

Head office: 80 Raffles Place Uob Plaza, Singapore, Singapore

Telephone: 6562222121

Fax: 6565367712

Number of Employees: 31222

Website: www.uobgroup.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: U11

Stock Exchange: Singapore Exchange Securities Trading

Company Overview

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB) is a financial institution that provides banking and other financial-related services. The group's main activities include consumer banking, **private banking**, commercial banking, corporate banking, and institutional banking. UOB offers a wide range of products and services such as deposits, insurance, card services, **wealth management**, investment, and loan products. The group operates under the notable brand name UOB. Its services cater to individual customers, small, medium, and large enterprises, multinational corporations, financial institutions, and government-linked entities. The group operates through its banking subsidiaries in China, Indonesia, Malaysia, Thailand, and Vietnam. It has a global network of branches and offices in Asia Pacific, Europe, and North America. UOB is headquartered in Singapore. The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD20,676 million for the fiscal year ended December 2025 (FY2025), a decrease of 11.1% over FY2024. In FY2025, the bank's operating margin was 38.3%, compared to an operating margin of 47.1% in FY2024. In FY2025, the bank recorded a net margin of 17.9%, compared to a net margin of 21% in FY2024.

Business Description

United Overseas Bank Ltd (UOB) provides personal, commercial, business, private, and investment banking solutions. It also offers corporate finance, asset management, insurance, treasury, capital markets, venture capital management, and stock broking services. As of December 31, 2024, it had assets of SGD537,664 million, total deposits of SGD403,978 million, and loans to customers of SGD333,930 million.

UOB classifies its operations into four segments: Group Retail (GR), Group Wholesale Banking (GWB), Others, and Global Markets (GM).

As of December 31, 2024, it operated through a network of over 470 branches and offices in 19 countries and territories in Europe, North America, and the Asia Pacific.

Company

Company Name: Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC) is a financial services group that provides a comprehensive range of banking products and services. The bank's main activities include offering deposit products, consumer loans, credit cards, **wealth management**, and brokerage services. OCBC serves individual customers, high net worth individuals, and institutional clients across various sectors, providing solutions such as project financing, cash management, and treasury products. The bank operates through a network of branches and offices. It has a presence in Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the US, Indonesia, Australia, the UK, the UAE, and Luxembourg. OCBC is headquartered in Singapore.

The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD20,076 million for the fiscal year ended December 2025 (FY2025), a decrease of 10.6% over FY2024. In FY2025, the bank's operating margin was 31.4%,

compared to an operating margin of 41.3% in FY2024. In FY2025, the bank recorded a net margin of 18.5%, compared to a net margin of 22% in FY2024.

Head office: 63 Chulia Street #10-00 Singapore, Singapore

Telephone: 6563633333

Fax: 6565343986

Number of Employees: 33323

Website: www.ocbc.com

Financial Year End: December

Ticker: O39

Stock Exchange: Singapore Exchange Securities Trading

Company Overview

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC) is a financial services group that provides a comprehensive range of banking products and services. The bank's main activities include offering deposit products, consumer loans, credit cards, **wealth management**, and brokerage services. OCBC serves individual customers, high net worth individuals, and institutional clients across various sectors, providing solutions such as project financing, cash management, and treasury products. The bank operates through a network of branches and offices. It has a presence in Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the US, Indonesia, Australia, the UK, the UAE, and Luxembourg. OCBC is headquartered in Singapore. The bank reported interest income of (Singapore Dollars) SGD20,076 million for the fiscal year ended December 2025 (FY2025), a decrease of 10.6% over FY2024. In FY2025, the bank's operating margin was 31.4%, compared to an operating margin of 41.3% in FY2024. In FY2025, the bank recorded a net margin of 18.5%, compared to a net margin of 22% in FY2024.

Business Description

Oversea-Chinese Banking Corp Ltd (OCBC), along with its subsidiaries, is a provider of consumer, corporate, investment, private, and transaction banking; and global treasury and stockbroking services. It also carries out insurance and asset management business activities through its subsidiaries. As of December 31, 2024, it had assets of SGD625,050 million, loans to customers of SGD315,096 million, and deposits of SGD390,687 million.

OCBC classifies its operations into five segments: Global Consumer/**Private Banking**, Global Wholesale Banking, Insurance, Global Markets, and Others.

As of December 31, 2024, OCBC operated through more than 400 branches and representative offices in Brunei, Myanmar, the Philippines, Thailand, Vietnam, Japan, South Korea, Taiwan, the US, Indonesia, Australia, the UK, the UAE, and Luxembourg.

Company

Company Name: Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd, (SCBS) a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, is a financial services provider that offers banking services. The bank provides deposit-taking, **wealth management** services, overdrafts, credit cards, auto financing, personal loans, and mortgages. SCBS offers trade finance, lending, foreign exchange, cash management, securities services, debt capital markets and corporate finance to corporate and institutional clients. The company also provides **private banking** services through its **private banking** division. It serves corporate and retail customers, individuals, and small and medium-sized enterprises. SCBS is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore.

Head office: 9 Changi Business Park Cres #05-01 Singapore City, Singapore

Website: www.sc.com/sg

Financial Year End: December

Company Overview

Standard Chartered Bank (Singapore) Ltd, (SCBS) a subsidiary of Standard Chartered PLC, is a financial services provider that offers banking services. The bank provides deposit-taking, **wealth management** services, overdrafts, credit cards, auto financing, personal loans, and mortgages. SCBS offers trade finance, lending, foreign exchange, cash management, securities services, debt capital markets and corporate finance to corporate and institutional clients. The company also provides **private banking** services through its **private banking** division. It serves corporate and retail customers, individuals, and small and medium-sized enterprises. SCBS is headquartered in Singapore City, Singapore.

Market Definition

The banking industry involves the activities of banks and similar institutions that offer financial services such as savings, loans, mortgages, and related services to businesses and consumers. Market value represents the total assets held by banks or related institutions in a country in a year. The market share represents the total assets held by the companies in the specific year. Geographical segmentation measures the total assets held by commercial banks of a particular region.

The market is segmented into bank credit, inter-bank loans, cash assets, trading assets, and others. The scope of others includes investments, loans receivable, and fixed assets. Bank credit refers to funds that a bank lends to individuals, businesses, or other entities. Inter-bank loans are loans made between banks. These loans serve as a mechanism for banks to manage their short-term liquidity needs and meet regulatory requirements. Cash asset products of banks provide customers with a secure and convenient way to manage their cash holdings while earning potential returns on their funds. Customers can choose from a variety of products based on their financial goals, risk tolerance, and liquidity needs. Bank trading assets refer to financial instruments and securities that banks hold primarily for trading to generate profits. These assets are actively bought and sold within the bank's trading desk or investment division to capitalize on short-term price fluctuations, market trends, or arbitrage opportunities. Trading assets can encompass a wide range of financial instruments such as equities, commodities, and foreign exchange.

All market data and forecasts are based on nominal prices, and all currency conversions used in the creation of this report have been calculated using yearly average exchange rates. The USD values may show a declining trend for a few countries, such as Argentina, Turkey, Nigeria, Egypt, and Russia. This is primarily because of the impact of exchange rates considered.

For the purpose of this report, the global market consists of North America, South America, Europe, Asia-Pacific, Scandinavia, and the Middle East & Africa.

North America consists of Canada, Mexico, and the US.

South America comprises Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, and Peru.

Europe comprises Germany, France, Italy, Russia, Spain, the Netherlands, Turkey, Switzerland, Sweden, Belgium, Poland, Norway, Austria, Denmark, Greece, Finland, Portugal, Ireland, the Czech Republic, and the UK.

Scandinavia comprises Denmark, Norway, and Sweden.

Asia-Pacific comprises China, Japan, India, Australia, South Korea, Indonesia, Taiwan, Thailand, Malaysia, Singapore, the Philippines, Pakistan, New Zealand, Hong Kong, Vietnam, and Kazakhstan.

The Middle East & Africa comprises South Africa, Nigeria, Saudi Arabia, Israel, Egypt, Kenya, Morocco, and the UAE.

The Singaporean banking industry operates within a highly sophisticated and integrated regulatory framework led by the Monetary Authority of Singapore (MAS). Unlike many other jurisdictions, MAS serves as a "unified" regulator, acting as the central bank while also supervising bank safety, capital adequacy, and conduct. It ensures financial system stability and maintains industry integrity through a combination of strict prudential oversight and proactive support for financial innovation.

A foundational law governing the industry is the Banking Act 1970 of Singapore, which provides the legislative basis for the licensing and supervision of full, wholesale, and offshore banks. This act grants MAS extensive powers to set standards for capital and liquidity, often requiring banks to maintain buffers that exceed international minimums to ensure they can meet their financial promises. The framework also integrates the Singapore Deposit Insurance Corporation (SDIC), which protects customer deposits up to SGD100,000.0 (\$18.1)

per person, per institution. The modern regulatory landscape has been further shaped by the Payment Services Act 2019, which streamlined the regulation of payment systems and digital asset services to manage evolving risks in the fintech space.

A major regulatory development for the industry relates to the implementation of the Basel III standards, with MAS refining risk-based capital requirements to ensure local banks remain "unquestionably strong" against global volatility. The industry is navigating the Digital Bank Licensing Framework, which has introduced new competition from non-bank players aimed at serving underbanked segments. Overall, Singapore's regulatory environment prioritizes financial resilience and digital transformation. While these regulations drive up operating costs through tough compliance and reporting demands, particularly regarding anti-money laundering (AML) and cybersecurity, they also ensure a high level of trust in the system. Consequently, major banking groups such as DBS Bank, Oversea-Chinese Banking, and United Overseas Bank are increasingly adopting artificial intelligence (AI)-driven solutions and Open Banking protocols to meet the demands of a digital-first global industry.

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HSBC appoints Desmond Kuang as Chief Investment Officer, Asia

Distributed by Contify.com

426 words

22 April 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

* Desmond will develop regional investment strategies for **private banking** and premier clients in Asia, excluding Hong Kong.

* He brings 20 years of experience in banking, leadership positions in asset management and investment research.

* Desmond will report to Willem Sels and Ishan Sarkar, based in Singapore.

Original Press Release:

April 22 -- HSBC **Private Bank** issued the following news release:

HSBC today announced the appointment of Desmond Kuang as Chief Investment Officer, Asia, HSBC **Private Bank** and Premier Wealth, effective 6 July 2026.

In his new role, Desmond will be responsible for developing regional investment strategies and themes across all asset classes for **private banking** and premier clients in the region, excluding Hong Kong. He is an active member in the bank's Global Investment Committee, a governance body which periodically analyses and develops asset allocation strategies for its clients.

Desmond brings 20 years of experience in the banking industry, having held a range of leadership positions across asset management and investment research sectors. Desmond is currently Chief Investment Officer, China and Interim Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions, China. He will continue in these roles until successors are appointed.

Willem Sels, Global Chief Investment Officer, HSBC **Private Bank** and Premier Wealth, said: "We are delighted to welcome Desmond as Chief Investment Officer, Asia. As wealth continues to grow rapidly in Asia, clients and investors are seeking timely and actionable investment insights to pursue their wealth goals. Desmond brings deep experience and rigour that will further strengthen our insights-led investment culture, an approach our clients have come to trust."

Based in Singapore, Desmond will report to Willem Sels, Global Chief Investment Officer, HSBC **Private Bank** and Premier Wealth, as well as to Ishan Sarkar, Head of Wealth and Premier Solutions, Singapore.

About HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com

About HSBC Holdings plc

HSBC Holdings plc, the parent company of HSBC, is headquartered in London. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 56 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,233 billion at 31 December 2025, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

[Category: Asset and Wealth Management, Investment Banking, Management Changes]

Source: HSBC **Private Bank**

Document ATINBK0020260423em4m000ek

DBS Private Bank loses North Asia senior market head

Cheryl Heng

171 words

20 April 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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DBS Private Bank has lost its senior market head for North Asia, Citywire Asia understands.

Gloria Sun is departing the Singaporean bank after a year. Citywire Asia reached out to a spokesperson from DBS Private Bank for a comment.

Based in Hong Kong, Sun joined DBS in December 2024, pegged to cover the Taiwan market too. She reported to Carol Wu, DBS Private Bank's head of private banking, North Asia.

Prior to that, Sun was at Deutsche Bank Private Bank as head of its North Asia team. She joined the German lender in 2017, leading a team to cover clients in Greater China. The team was responsible for acquiring new clients and raising assets in Greater China.

She also had stints at Bank of East Asia Hong Kong.

Last week, Citywire Asia covered the [departure](#) of DBS Private Bank's Thailand and Philippines market head Edwin Tan. The bank's head of funds John Ng also [left](#) in March.

Document CWIRAS0020260420em4k00001

Business

Standard Chartered Korea rolls out next-gen private banking model

337 words

20 April 2026

The Korea Herald

KORHER

English

(c) 2026 The Korea Herald

Standard Chartered Bank Korea said it is strengthening its "next-generation private banking model" for affluent clients, alongside the launch of a global lifestyle program.

The revamped model targets clients with assets of 1 billion won (\$678,000) or more, incorporating asset management systems from key global hubs including Singapore, Hong Kong and the United Arab Emirates, tailored to the Korean market.

At the core of the offering is a "thought leadership" program featuring masterclasses with industry leaders. A highlight is a "Masterclass with Coach Pak Se-ri," scheduled for May. Pak — the first client of the bank's private banking center — will host in-person sessions, with selected clients receiving one-on-one lessons and private dinners through an on-site raffle.

The initiative is built around five pillars: private wealth management, specialized asset allocation, inheritance and succession planning, global lifestyle benefits and dedicated private banking centers.

Leveraging the global network of its parent, Standard Chartered, the bank said it offers tailored portfolio management supported by a team of experts, including advisors affiliated with INSEAD.

The bank has also been expanding its physical presence. In November, it opened the Apgujeong Private Banking Center in Seoul's Gangnam district, featuring a high-end lounge and 11 consultation rooms designed for affluent clients. Expansion is planned for the second half of the year.

Lifestyle offerings are also being scaled up. In March, in collaboration with the Ritz-Carlton Yacht Collection, clients were invited to tour "Luminara," a 46,000-ton luxury yacht docked at Incheon Port, with curated onboard experiences led by professional guides and chefs.

The bank has also partnered with Porsche dealer SSCL to host curated exhibition tours at Porsche Center Busan and Porsche Studio Hannam.

"We will set the standard for next-generation private banking based on our five core values across space, service and experience," said Sachin Bhambani, head of affluent and wealth solutions at Standard Chartered Bank Korea.

[\(Standard Chartered Bank Korea\)](#)

Document KORHER0020260420em4k0015p

DBS Hong Kong to open first flagship DBS Treasures Centre in Kowloon

Distributed by Contify.com

704 words

17 April 2026

Contify Banking News

ATINBK

English

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Key Highlights:

- * DBS Treasures Centre to offer exceptional personalised financial services.
- * Second flagship in Hong Kong, reinforcing DBS' leadership in **wealth management**.
- * DBS Hong Kong achieves double-digit year-on-year revenue growth in 2025.

Original Press Release:

Hong Kong, April 17 -- DBS Bank Ltd issued the following news release:

- Prime golden mile location secured to target growing affluent segments, reinforcing DBS' leadership as Asia's wealth gateway

DBS Bank (Hong Kong) Limited ("DBS Hong Kong") is thrilled to announce the opening of its first flagship Treasures Centre in Kowloon on 50 Nathan Road in the third quarter of 2026. This iconic DBS Treasures Centre, its second flagship in Hong Kong, will be an upscale establishment designed to redefine the banking experience for its affluent clientele with exceptional personalised financial services.

The new three-storey DBS Treasures Centre, spanning over 10,800-square-feet, will be strategically located in the heart of Tsim Sha Tsui's Golden Mile. This vibrant location is a hub of ethnic heritage, global travellers, boasting some of the highest foot traffic and affluent density in Hong Kong. The high-street location of the new flagship DBS Treasures Centre firmly cements DBS' leadership at the forefront of the growing international affluent market in Hong Kong.

Sebastian Paredes, Head of DBS North Asia and Chief Executive Officer of DBS Hong Kong, said, "Hong Kong remains a vibrant international financial centre, a prime **wealth management** hub and a top destination for international wealth flows with connectivity to global markets. DBS is well positioned to support our wealth clientele in Hong Kong and in the region, leveraging our unique strengths and strategic position as Asia's safest bank and most trusted partner for **wealth management**."

Ajay Mathur, Head of Consumer Banking Group and **Wealth Management**, DBS Hong Kong, said, "Our Consumer Banking Group delivered solid performance and achieved double-digit year-on-year revenue growth in the full year of 2025. The expansion reflects DBS Hong Kong's strategic move and strong momentum in consumer banking and **wealth management** businesses, driven by a rapidly growing affluent customer base. This new prime location with its vivacious energy will allow us to be where our clients are, as we aspire to serve them better."

The new Treasures Centre will complement the DBS Treasures Centre at 18 Queen's Road Central, reinforcing DBS' commitment to providing unparalleled banking experience to all local and international affluent individuals.

About DBS

DBS is a leading financial services group in Asia with a presence in 19 markets. Headquartered and listed in Singapore, DBS is in the three key Asian axes of growth: Greater China, Southeast Asia and South Asia. The bank's "AA-" and "Aa1" credit ratings are among the highest in the world.

Recognised for its global leadership, DBS has been named “World’s Best Bank” by Global Finance, “World’s Best Bank” by Euromoney and “Global Bank of the Year” by The Banker. The bank is at the forefront of leveraging digital technology to shape the future of banking, having been named “World’s Best Digital Bank” by Euromoney and the world’s “Most Innovative in Digital Banking” by The Banker. In addition, DBS has been accorded the “Safest Bank in Asia” award by Global Finance for 17 consecutive years from 2009 to 2025.

DBS provides a full range of services in consumer, SME and corporate banking. As a bank born and bred in Asia, DBS understands the intricacies of doing business in the region’s most dynamic markets.

DBS is committed to building lasting relationships with customers, as it banks the Asian way. Through the DBS Foundation, the bank creates impact beyond banking by uplifting lives and livelihoods of those in need. It provides essential needs to the underprivileged, and fosters inclusion by equipping the underserved with financial and digital literacy skills. It also nurtures innovative social enterprises that create positive impact.

With its extensive network of operations in Asia and emphasis on engaging and empowering its staff, DBS presents exciting career opportunities. For more information, please visit www.dbs.com.

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Facility Expansion]

Source: DBS Bank Ltd

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Companies & Markets

OCBC to train wealth advisers using generative AI

Deon Loke

370 words

15 April 2026

Business Times Singapore

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online

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[SINGAPORE] OCBC has launched a generative artificial-intelligence-powered training programme for its 900 wealth advisers in Singapore, shifting away from a model that relied exclusively on in-person supervision, it announced on Wednesday (Apr 15).

The six-month initiative was developed over a year using large language models and proprietary customer data, and deploys GenAI to coach wealth advisers on competencies including investment advisory, client management, product mastery and wealth planning.

Before this rollout, wealth advisory training was conducted one-on-one by supervisors.

"Wealth advisers can take up to three weeks to secure a training session with their supervisors who typically have to coach up to 10 staff. This is in addition to having other responsibilities, resulting in inconsistent evaluation standards and feedback quality across different supervisors," OCBC said.

The programme uses the bank's anonymised proprietary insights on customer behaviours to generate realistic training scenarios.

"These include helping a customer to create an investment portfolio to address their long-term needs, identifying a customer's risk profile, selling more sophisticated financial products or adjusting investment strategies in line with market movements," OCBC said.

"During each training session, the programme – available to wealth advisers on their work devices – dynamically adapts its responses based on what is said, engaging naturally as a customer would in a real-life setting."

Following AI sessions, supervisors receive automated reports detailing an adviser's specific competency gaps, allowing for more targeted in-person follow-ups.

Performance and expansion

Initial data from the first three months of implementation indicates that advisers using the programme secured double the number of weekly client appointments compared to those who had not yet undergone the training, OCBC said.

Additionally, this group recorded a 50 per cent increase in revenue over the three months preceding the programme.

The bank said that plans to localise and export the training platform to its markets in Malaysia and Hong Kong at a later stage.

Content in these regions will be adjusted to reflect local products, regulatory requirements and customer behaviours.

The programme covers advisers across three retail segments: personal banking, Premier Banking and Private Premier Client.

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Business

Standard Chartered brings crypto into private banking

847 words

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The Korea Herald

KORHER

English

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Global wealth head says custody will anchor digital asset push, stays bullish on AI-led markets

[Samir Subberwal, Standard Chartered Bank's global head of wealth solutions, retail products, data and analytics, speaks during an interview with The Korea Herald at the bank's Korean headquarters in central Seoul on Tuesday. \(Im Se-jun/ The Korea Herald\)](#)

Standard Chartered plans to extend its digital asset offering to affluent clients this year, a move that adds a new dimension to the bank's push to deepen its **wealth management** business in South Korea and broader Asia.

Samir Subberwal, Standard Chartered Bank's global head of wealth solutions, retail products and data and analytics, said the bank sees custody, rather than simple access to crypto, as the core differentiator as digital assets move further into mainstream wealth conversations.

"Bank custody is the important point in our digital assets plan," Subberwal said in an interview with The Korea Herald in Seoul on Tuesday. "We already offer that to corporates, and we will extend that to high-net-worth customers this year."

The significance of the plan lies less in crypto access itself than in where Standard Chartered is trying to take it. The group's digital asset buildout has so far been centered on institutional markets, with a broader platform spanning custody, trading and tokenization.

Subberwal said the bank is now looking to bring part of that institutional-level infrastructure into **private banking**, betting that affluent clients will be more comfortable holding digital assets through a regulated bank than through standalone crypto platforms.

"I think sophisticated customers will feel a lot more secure having the custody of their bitcoin with the bank," he said. "That's a differentiating proposition that we will bring to customers."

Standard Chartered's push into digital assets aligns with the global bank's broader strategy of diversification in the Korean market. The bank is trying to build scale in affluent banking by steering clients away from trading-driven behavior and toward more diversified, advisory-led **wealth management**.

"Korea is one of our bigger markets for affluent banking, and we will continue to invest here," Subberwal said, pointing to the bank's recent Priority Private launch in Korea and plans to keep investing in relationship managers and wealth specialists.

That reflects how the bank sees its opening in a market dominated by local lenders and securities firms. Rather than compete head-on on plain trading access, Standard Chartered wants to position itself around asset allocation, global portfolios and cross-border advice.

Subberwal described Korea as traditionally "more of a trading market when it comes to wealth," but said the bank is trying to change that conversation. "We are trying to encourage customers to think beyond just local-equities trading and think diversification, global diversification," he said.

To do that, the bank is offering model portfolios based on client risk profiles, allocating across equities, fixed income and alternatives including gold. The idea is to position Standard Chartered as an adviser on broader portfolio construction.

That strategy also reflects the structure of the Korean market itself. Subberwal said the opportunity in Korea is both domestic and cross-border: expanding the bank's local wealth base while connecting Korean clients to offshore opportunities. Even while staying constructive on Korea through the AI and semiconductor theme, he said the concentration of the local market makes diversification essential.

"If you're fully exposed only to Korean equities, Korean equities are predominantly two stocks," he said, referring to Samsung Electronics and SK hynix. "So we will always recommend customers to diversify."

That message is especially important as local banks step up their own **private-banking** and **wealth-management** efforts. Standard Chartered's answer, Subberwal suggested, is not to become more like domestic competitors, but to lean further into its global research, CIO views and cross-border capabilities.

"For us, the biggest challenge is, 'how can we be two, three times of what we are today?'" he said. "That's why we want to invest and grow in that segment."

The bank's broader market stance remains constructive despite the geopolitical shock from the Iran conflict. Standard Chartered is still overweight equities, particularly US equities and Asia ex-Japan, even as it has adjusted some of its interest-rate expectations and credit views. Subberwal said the bank now expects two US rate cuts this year instead of three, while keeping its core equity positioning intact.

He was more definitive on artificial intelligence, dismissing concerns that the trade has already entered bubble territory.

"We still think that the AI trend is only in the beginning of its life cycle," Subberwal said. Standard Chartered remains overweight semiconductors, which it sees as the first phase of the AI buildout, and expects the theme to continue feeding earnings growth for companies exposed to it.

That also informs its view on Korea. "Korean stocks are closely linked to AI, which is why Korea remains a core holding within Asia ex-Japan," Subberwal said. "From that broader thematic perspective, we remain quite bullish."

Document KORHER0020260414em4e004ph

OCBC hires Indonesia **private banking** head from Julius Baer

Priyanka Boghani

220 words

13 April 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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Singaporean lender OCBC has named a new **private banking** head based in Indonesia to lead its operations on the ground.

Fernando Baay has taken on the role of **private banking** head based in Jakarta, according to his LinkedIn profile. He will drive the business, using the 'one bank' approach to leverage OCBC Indonesia's platform. OCBC's **private banking** arm, Bank of Singapore, does not have a presence in Indonesia.

Citywire Asia reached out to the bank for a comment on the hire.

Baay joins from Julius Baer, where he covered the Asia desk in Switzerland for over two years. He also worked at Credit Suisse for five years and Citi **Private Bank** for 16 years, in Singapore and Indonesia.

Bank of Singapore recently [hired](#) Vi Sun Yang as its new head of **private banking** for Asean. She was also from Julius Baer, where she worked as the Southeast Asia market head.

The Singapore bank's wealth management unit saw its assets under management jump 15% year on year to S\$343bn (\$271bn), pulling in \$27bn of net new money last year, according to results published 25 February. The bank unveiled a three-year strategy, including goals to scale its affluent segment in Hong Kong and **private banking** in Indonesia.

Document CWIRAS0020260413em4d00001



Wealth Management

HSBC faces \$79m lawsuit over client's decade-long assets freeze; The claimant alleges the bank's Middle Eastern arm did not verify funds and client information in a \$10m transfer

By Xhulio Ismalaj and Lars Mucklejohn

453 words

8 April 2026

17:17

fnlondon.com

LONFIN

English

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HSBC is one of a host of lenders operating private banking services from the UAE PHOTO: Walaa Alshaer/Bloomberg/Getty Images

An HSBC client is suing the bank's Middle Eastern arm for \$79m over claims that "wrongful conduct" led to it freezing her funds for more than a decade over unfounded suspicions that they were the proceeds of criminal activity.

Nazma Begum, her son Amar Khan, and their joint investment vehicle, Jakob, filed a claim with the Dubai International Financial Centre Courts on 9 March alleging that HSBC Bank Middle East Limited's lapses in verifying funds and client information caused a decade-long freeze on more than \$10m.

The dispute dates back to 2012, according to the lawsuit, when HSBC Bank Middle East relationship manager Katherine Lisle advised Begum to invest proceeds from a Pakistan property sale via a Guernsey account instead of buying Dubai real estate.

About \$10m was frozen after HSBC's private bank filed a Suspicious Activity Report with Guernsey's Financial Intelligence Unit in 2013, citing suspected links to Mazam Ali Khan, Begum's estranged husband who had been convicted of VAT fraud in Belgium in 2007.

Under Guernsey law, once reported, financial institutions cannot access the assets without official consent.

The DIFC filing says HSBC Guernsey disclosed internal documents in 2023 which showed that HSBC Bank Middle East "had committed several wrongs regarding the Guernsey Account opening", which led to the decade-long freeze on the claimants' funds.

The Royal Court of Guernsey ordered the release of the funds in 2024, ruling that the millions were not criminal proceeds.

Begum's claim says the freeze led to losses as it prevented her from investing in Dubai's property market, which later rose in value.

"The claimants seek compensation for HBME's wrongful conduct," according to the court filing, which alleges that HSBC

Begum claims that HSBC Middle East failed to verify the funds' source, submitted inaccurate client documentation, misrepresented Mazam Ali Khan's role, and provided information that triggered suspicion, causing the funds to be wrongly flagged as potentially criminal.

The claimants are seeking compensation for the frozen funds and lost investment gains, as well as legal costs and additional damages.

An HSBC spokesperson said: "We dispute the allegations being made and intend to defend ourselves fully. As the case is ongoing, it would be inappropriate to comment further."

Write to Xhulio Ismalaj at xhulio.ismalaj@dowjones.com and Lars Mucklejohn at lars.mucklejohn@dowjones.com

Document LONFIN0020260408em480002t

Wealth

Innovating and disrupting itself is what helped DBS win award for world's best private bank

LEE SU SHYAN

1,405 words

6 April 2026

Business Times Singapore

STBT

print

A30

English

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LAST month, DBS celebrated being the first Asia-headquartered bank to land Euromoney's gong for "The world's best private bank", but the foundation for the success was laid many years ago. Group head of DBS Private Bank Joseph Poon told The Business Times: "It was our ability to innovate ahead of time and put in structures that have reaped us this dividend."

According to Euromoney, by the end of June 2025, the private bank had delivered S\$23.3 billion in net new money, 37 per cent annualised growth in wealth-related fees, a 72 per cent return on equity and a 46 per cent cost-income ratio, making it among the most efficient in developed markets.

Another feat: assets under management (AUM) had doubled in five years; S\$1.2 billion of fees were added between 2022 and 2024, achieving in half the time what had previously taken six years.

Digitalisation and artificial intelligence

From as early as 2014, DBS had embarked on its digitalisation journey. It began experimenting with artificial intelligence (AI) to drive value for the business and customers.

In recent years, this included embedding AI into its systems to help relationship managers in their dealings with wealth clients. For example, AI was used to analyse client preferences, to see how the bank could give more useful and more timely advice to clients.

Poon said: "Many of our clients have become increasingly comfortable with self-service banking through our award-winning digiWealth app. Today, more than 90 per cent of our wealth customers actively use the app."

Going digital was not just for efficiency, Poon insists. "We did so as to enable our clients to invest faster, more safely and more intelligently than ever before."

It was a bold move for an industry which had been defined by high-touch interactions, with its traditional image of personalised wealth service provided by relationship managers.

Poon said that machine learning is used to synthesise clients' preferences, their risk tolerance, while also reviewing their risk exposures, volatility and other data points. "We get a very good read of the clients, where they are in their risk profile, in their life journey."

He added: "We've developed AI-generated prompts which are highly personalised. For example, if our system detects that a client has been converting Singapore dollars into sterling every month, it can prompt the client when the exchange rate is more favourable. It might say: 'Based on today's rate, your trade could yield more pounds than usual. Would you like to convert now?'"

AI has been deployed across adverse news screening, information summarisation and the analysis of client data and documentation, all of which have improved risk monitoring and enhanced efficiency.

Poon sees technology as helping to automate more transactional-type activities. In short, "our relationship managers can focus on having more meaningful and value-adding conversations around asset allocation, portfolio strategy or even legacy planning".

Innovation, including on the crypto front

A little-known fact: “Crypto holdings with us have now exceeded gold, a clear signal of client confidence and future readiness,” said Poon.

Some years ago, Poon came across clients who stored their crypto investments such as Bitcoin and Ethereum on thumb drives, with all the attendant security risks. This signalled the growth of crypto assets – an area which offered opportunities for the **private bank**.

It announced in 2020 that it would set up the DBS Digital Exchange, to provide an ecosystem for fund raising through asset tokenisation and secondary trading of digital assets including cryptocurrencies.

DBS Digital Exchange has expanded to not only allow clients to hold their crypto assets alongside their traditional assets, such as equities, bonds or mutual funds, but also be placed in a trust structure suitable for legacy planning.

In fact, DBS Trustee is the world’s first and only bank-backed trust to hold cryptocurrencies, recording inflows exceeding S\$2 billion last year. All this contributed to DBS **Private Bank** landing its second award for “The world’s best for digital assets”.

With DBS being the only bank in Asia and among the few globally with this scale of offering (including the digital exchange), “being innovative and disrupting one’s business has turned out well for us”, Poon said.

As well, by enabling clients to manage both traditional and digital assets in one view, DBS **Private Bank** is attracting the next-generation of wealth, a group who is comfortable with digital assets.

One Bank

Apart from the innovation efforts, what ties it all together is the “One Bank” model.

That is an approach that unifies **private banking** with corporate and investment banking, enabling an entrepreneurial client to address operating companies, holding structures and family wealth through a single platform, noted Euromoney .

For example, Poon said: “We realised a client was doing a lot of Singapore government securities trades through other banks, so we worked with our SME team to onboard his account and link him up through our treasury traders, allowing him to trade everything seamlessly within DBS.”

Another example was leveraging the structuring capabilities of DBS’ global financial markets team, which allowed a family office client to gain exposure to a sub-fund portfolio through a total return swap transaction, a solution typically reserved for institutional investors.

Performance and resilience

While a **private bank** is always measured on how well it manages the fortunes of its clients, that is, the return on their money, Poon said that increasingly, what matters to them is “the return of their money”.

Counterparty risk is very much at the forefront of the minds of clients these days but DBS has strong credit credentials.

It pairs an AA /Aa1 group credit with Singapore’s AAA jurisdiction; a common equity Tier 1 ratio of 17.4 per cent, a non-performing loan ratio of around 1 per cent, and operational losses about four times lower than the industry average. These metrics helped DBS clinch its third award, Euromoney’ s “The world’s safest **private bank**” award.

Poon noted that while some peers have experienced greater volatility in their P&L (profit & loss) performance, DBS **Private Bank** has maintained relatively steady growth, which reflects both maturity and stability of its business model.

But the bank has led on the investment front too.

“We made non-consensus, bold calls – and we were right,” Poon said, such as on nuclear energy and gold.

Euromoney pointed out that the bank’s barbell approach of quality growth and income for investor portfolios ranks among the top decile of peers since inception.

Looking ahead amid the Middle East conflict

With an estimated US\$5.8 trillion of wealth that will be transferred between generations in the Asia-Pacific region, DBS **Private Bank** is in pole position to tap this market, Poon reckons.

In Asia, unlike Europe, most of the wealth continues to be represented by family businesses. For DBS, the proportion of **private bank** clients who also run businesses is around 70 per cent.

For potential clients from Europe, US, or from elsewhere in Asia, Poon sees the bank's strength as being able to offer on-the-ground knowledge on potential business partners' bespoke investment opportunities in this part of the world.

Recently, DBS partnered Granite Asia, a multi-asset investment platform which will develop new funds exclusively for DBS clients and offer co-investment opportunities. DBS' involvement will include areas such as subscription financing and corporate loans, advisory for merger and acquisition mandates, supporting bond issuances and preparing for an IPO (initial public offer).

Meanwhile, the Middle East conflict is something that the bank, unsurprisingly, is closely monitoring.

Poon said: "The bank has been continually working with clients to double down on asset diversification and risk management to mitigate the evolving macroeconomic and geopolitical environment."

Many of the clients in the Middle East region have diversified their assets, Poon added, and "are holding them across multi-jurisdictions including Asia and as such, are adopting a wait-and-see approach".

He concluded: "Helping grow, protect and preserve our clients' personal wealth is what I consider 'hygiene' for any **private bank**. The future of global **private banking** lies in helping to do the same for our clients' businesses and being a part of that growth journey as they scale."

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THE STRAITS TIMES

Business

Younger DBS shareholders drawn by dividends turn up at AGM for the first time

Sheila Chiang

932 words

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SINGAPORE - Young investors were among first-time attendees at DBS's 2025 annual general meeting (AGM), drawn to the bank's dividends and a growing desire to take a more active role in managing their portfolios.

Over 1,700 shareholders attended the two-hour AGM held at Marina Bay Sands Expo and Convention Centre at 2pm on March 31.

Ms Kang, in her early 30s, attended the AGM for the first time, even though she has been a DBS shareholder for the past 10 years.

This year, she was able to attend in person as she had some free time, whereas in previous years she had relied on a friend to cast her proxy votes.

She told The Straits Times: "I wanted to see what the AGM was really like. I like to hear what they have to say. It's peak entertainment when shareholders and the board go back and forth during Q&A but it's also very valid questions from people who actually care (about the company)."

She added: "I think it's important that the board actually addresses the questions."

Ms Kang further noted that she does not expect the best returns this year given the current macroeconomic environment, elevated geopolitical tensions and potential interest rate cuts.

Mr Tuan Ding Ren, another first timer at the AGM, said he was curious about what takes place at such shareholder meetings.

DBS was one of the counters the 25-year-old student added to his investment portfolio a year ago to build up his retirement funds, and it has since become one of his largest holdings.

"I invest in DBS because it is the leader (among the Singapore banks), is one of the most stable stocks, gives good dividends and has good leadership which I witnessed myself today," he said.

He also owns OCBC and UOB shares, and plans to increase his shareholding in the banks in the future.

DBS announced a total dividend of \$3.06 per share for the full year of 2025, up 38 per cent from the previous year.

Its fourth-quarter final dividend alone was 81 cents per share, comprising an ordinary dividend of 66 cents, up 6 cents from the third quarter, and a capital return dividend of 15 cents.

DBS plans to continue paying capital return dividends of 15 cents per share per quarter in 2026 and 2027, subject to unforeseen circumstances.

Mr Don Khoe, 31, told The Straits Times that he had previously sold his DBS shares but decided to buy the stock again a few months ago after liquidating his US positions and rebalancing his portfolio to mainly Singapore dollar positions. He also holds some UOB shares.

Mr Khoe, who attended the AGM with his spouse, said he found shareholders' questions – especially those that pointed to how DBS could improve its customer service – interesting.

The 2025 DBS AGM saw shareholders raise concerns about the bank's exposure to the Middle East amid the Iran war.

Speaking at the meeting, her first as chief executive of DBS, Ms Tan Su Shan said the bank's exposure to the region is minimal.

"We've done a lot of stress tests with our business heads. In terms of first-order impact, (it is) very little, because our core market is Asia, (and) our exposure to the Middle East is very, very limited," said Ms Tan.

Still, she warned of stagflation risks – where inflation remains high even as growth slows – especially if oil prices continue to stay elevated at more than US\$100 per barrel from prolonged conflict.

"The second-order impact – which is around inflation, consumer slowdown, supply chains – can cause problems.

"We are watching sectors such as autos, oil and gas, and shipping, to assess how they may be affected if the Strait of Hormuz is shut and upstream supply is disrupted," she said, adding that while there are concerns about small- and medium-sized enterprises, governments are likely to step in with support.

It could be tough for the bank to replace net interest income lost as a result of interest rates going down, she said.

For now, DBS is seeing increased customer activity in transaction services and is focusing on high-growth segments, including banking financial institutions such as insurers and fund managers, as well as transaction banking.

"These are all high return on equity businesses and we will continue to grow these three segments," she said.

Wealth management is also a key focus area for DBS.

Ms Tan highlighted that wealth clients remain loyal to the bank because "we embed them with foundational estate planning and long-term solutions."

In 2026, DBS was named the world's best private bank by Euromoney – marking the first time an Asia-based bank has earned the title.

"The fact that we are the first Asian bank to be recognised as the world's best private banking speaks to it, she said. "Our team is working very hard to get new to-bank customers and also to deepen our relationships."

Ms Tan further noted that the Monetary Authority of Singapore plans to become a global gold trading hub amid a rise in interest in the precious metal from retail and institutional investors.

"We are playing in all three segments – physical gold, paper gold and tokenised gold – and we're also in the business of structured products for gold. We think Singapore can be a good hub for physical, digital and paper gold."

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HSBC announces two senior appointments in mainland China wealth business

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Contify Banking News

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Key Highlights:

* HSBC appoints Max Xu as Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking (IWPB) China.

* Samuel Chen named Head of **Private Bank**, HSBC China, effective 1 April 2026.

* Wealth business in mainland China delivers 37% year-on-year growth in invested assets.

Original Press Release:

March 31 -- HSBC **Private Bank** issued the following news release:

HSBC today announced the appointments of Max Xu as Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking (IWPB), HSBC China, and Samuel Chen as Head of **Private Bank**, HSBC China, both effective 1 April 2026. These appointments reinforce HSBC's commitment to accelerating growth in the world's second-largest wealth market.

Mainland China is central to the bank's strategic priority to become the leading international **wealth manager**, particularly in Asia and the Middle East. In 2025, the Group's Wealth business in mainland China continued to deliver strong results, with Wealth invested assets up 37 per cent year-on-year, driven by robust wealth distribution and growth in **Private Bank**[1].

Kai Zhang, Head of International Wealth and Premier Banking, Asia, said: "Mainland Chinese households hold around USD22 trillion in cash, including an estimated USD6.5 trillion of savings that could shift into investments[2]. With our international network, full wealth offering and integrated financial solutions, HSBC is well placed to capture this opportunity."

Kai added: "The appointments of Max and Samuel strengthen our leadership bench as we continue to expand our onshore wealth and **private banking** franchise in mainland China, reinforcing our commitment to sustainable growth and superior client experience across the Premier, Premier Elite and **Private Bank** continuum."

Max is currently Head of Premier Banking, IWPB China. He joined HSBC in 2025 and brings over 20 years of experience across institutional and consumer banking at leading international financial institutions. In his new role, Max will lead IWPB China to drive high-quality growth across Premier, Premier Elite and **Private Bank**, deepen connectivity across key corridors, and strengthen collaboration with Corporate and Institutional Banking. Max will report to Mark Wang, CEO of HSBC China, and functionally to Kai Zhang.

Samuel will report to Max Xu and work closely with Lok Yim, Regional Head of HSBC **Private Bank**, Asia Pacific. He will focus on accelerating HSBC's **Private Bank** business in mainland China, deepening client relationships through a holistic **wealth management** offering across investments, lending, insurance and wealth planning.

Lok Yim, Regional Head, HSBC **Private Bank**, Asia Pacific, said: "HSBC's **Private Bank** business in mainland China is a key pillar of our global wealth strategy. Over the past few years, we've delivered substantial growth, expanded our mainland China footprint to six major cities, and built an award-winning franchise. We're pleased to have Samuel lead this important business. His leadership and strategic focus, together with a strong understanding of our entrepreneurial clients position him well to bring the full strengths of HSBC to our clients."

Samuel brings close to 20 years of banking experience, including over nine years with HSBC **Private Bank** in senior client-facing roles. Since the expansion of HSBC's **Private Bank** mainland China business in 2022, he has

helped build the investment counselling team. He later led the Wealth business under HSBC Qianhai Securities, helping secure a margin finance license and launching wealth lending offerings for high net worth clients in mainland China.

About International Wealth and Premier Banking

International Wealth and Premier Banking (IWPB) comprises Premier banking outside of Hong Kong and the UK, our **Private Bank**, Asset Management and Insurance businesses. IWPB delivered revenues of USD14.5 billion in 2025, an increase of 5 per cent year-on-year. Wealth fee and other income across all our businesses reached USD9.4 billion, up 24 per cent. At 31 December 2025, bank-wide Wealth balances were USD2.1 trillion, of which more than USD1 trillion was booked in Asia.

About HSBC **Private Bank**

HSBC **Private Bank** helps clients manage, grow and preserve their wealth for generations to come. Its network of global experts helps clients access investment opportunities around the world, plan for the future with wealth and succession planning, manage their portfolio with tailored solutions, and find the right support for their philanthropy. www.privatebanking.hsbc.com.

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited

The Hongkong and Shanghai Banking Corporation Limited is the founding member of the HSBC Group. HSBC serves customers worldwide from offices in 56 countries and territories. With assets of USD3,233 billion at 31 December 2025, HSBC is one of the world's largest banking and financial services organisations.

Footnotes:

[1] HSBC 2025 Strategic Report

↔(

<https://www.privatebanking.hsbc.com/media-releases-and-news/hsbc-announces-two-senior-appointments/#back1>)

[2] HSBC Global Research: The Flying Dutchman, 2 June 2025

↔(

<https://www.research.hsbc.com/gateway/speedbump-front/ui/index.html#/registration?ou=1zssnf22jgh3m3jpg3b9z7&vid=32531090>)

[Category: Asset and **Wealth Management**, Investment Banking, Management Changes]

Source: HSBC **Private Bank**

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Business

Former OCBC chief Helen Wong's 2025 pay falls 6.3% to \$12 million in last year at bank

Sheila Chiang

541 words

24 March 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

online

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SINGAPORE - OCBC Bank's former chief executive Helen Wong, who retired at the end of 2025 after four years at the helm, took home less in her final pay package there.

Ms Wong earned \$12 million in 2025, 6.3 per cent lower than the \$12.8 million she received in 2024. It was also lower than the \$12.1 million she earned in 2023, according to the bank's annual report released on March 24.

Her pay package consisted of a \$1.2 million base salary, \$6.3 million bonus and \$4.2 million deferred shares. Non-cash components such as club and car benefits worth \$323,000 made up the rest.

OCBC also saw a decline in 2025 earnings. Net profit was 2 per cent lower at \$7.42 billion, compared with a record \$7.6 billion the previous year, after tax expenses rose 27 per cent.

Ms Wong passed the baton to Mr Tan Teck Long, who assumed the role of CEO on Jan 1. He was OCBC's head of global wholesale banking since joining the bank in 2022.

He launched a new corporate strategy on the back of the bank's earnings results, as OCBC closed out its previous three-year strategy of unifying its brand across core markets and realising stronger synergies under the group.

The new strategy involves capturing rising Asia flows, deepening core market franchise, advancing technology-led and customer-centric capabilities through AI, digital and data, and supporting the green transition.

In the annual report, Mr Tan said that the new strategy reflects a world that is becoming more complex, more digital and more interconnected.

"Against this backdrop, our new strategy is designed to help OCBC ride these long-term waves and reposition the group for the future. It is built around four broad strategic shifts," Mr Tan said.

The strategy is expected to drive stable to improving return on equity, with a stronger focus on higher-returning businesses. It will also maintain cost discipline with cost-to-income ratio – a key banking efficiency metric – at low-to mid-40 per cent.

The bank said that it is on track to complete its \$2.5 billion capital return plan, comprising special dividends and share buybacks, by 2026.

OCBC's annual report followed that of DBS and UOB earlier in March.

UOB CEO Wee Ee Cheong took home about the same pay as Ms Wong in 2025, but it was 20 per cent less than the \$15 million he received in 2024. It was also lower than the \$15.9 million he received in 2023.

DBS CEO Tan Su Shan was paid \$9.64 million in 2025 for her first nine months in the role, as well as the period earlier in the year when she served as deputy CEO.

She took over the helm in March 2025, when Mr Piyush Gupta retired after 15 years in the role. She had been appointed deputy CEO in August 2024.

Mr Gupta's last-drawn full-pay package amounted to \$17.6 million for 2024, when the bank achieved record earnings.

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COMPANIES & MARKETS

Banks cannot intervene in winding-up bids by 1MDB-linked firms: Singapore High Court

Ry-Anne Lim

535 words

20 March 2026

Business Times Singapore

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print

A5

English

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THE Singapore High Court has ruled that Standard Chartered Bank (StanChart) and BSI Bank cannot intervene in winding-up applications brought by offshore companies in relation to the 1Malaysia Development Bhd (1MDB) scandal.

In a judgment released on Thursday (Mar 19), the court said that the banks have no standing to participate in the winding-up, even though they could face claims if the applications succeed.

The applicants were four entities: Alsen Chance, Brightstone Jewellery, Brazen Sky and Blackstone Asia Real Estate Partners.

They are linked to fugitive financier Jho Low, who is wanted for his central role in the multibillion-dollar corruption scandal, and his associates.

Together, they alleged that StanChart permitted over 100 intrabank transfers between 2009 and 2013 that “helped conceal the flow of stolen funds”, and it “chose to overlook obvious red flags” in relation to the transfers.

Meanwhile, Brazen Sky’s BSI account allegedly held overvalued fund units to hide a misappropriated investment in a PetroSaudi joint venture.

The four companies are being liquidated in the British Virgin Islands as part of efforts to recover funds allegedly misappropriated from 1MDB.

These include US\$150 million in transfers from a Blackstone account to Najib Razak, Malaysia’s former prime minister, as well as US\$53.4 million from Alsen Chance and US\$77 million from Brightstone to vendors for luxury purchases linked to Najib’s wife, Rosmah Mansor.

The four companies sought to be wound up in Singapore so liquidators here could pursue claims against the banks for these past transactions, which largely took place before Singapore adopted cross-border insolvency rules.

“It is not disputed that the purpose of these applications is to ultimately allow the Singapore liquidators to pursue avoidance claims against (the banks),” the court said in the latest judgment.

StanChart, BSI Bank and an employee at one of the lenders argued that they should be allowed to take part in the winding-up proceedings. The applicants objected to this.

For one, the banks said they should be treated as “contingent creditors” with the standing to oppose a winding-up application, since they could be awarded legal costs in ongoing litigation with the companies.

They also asserted that any winding-up order would affect them, so participating now would “conserve judicial time and resources”.

Further, the winding-up applications were a precursor to claims against them, they said, effectively making them “direct targets” of the process.

The court rejected this, saying that the possibility of adverse costs orders does not amount to a contingent liability. The commencement of litigation is merely a risk and not an actual liability, it added.

While it acknowledged that claims “may well be brought” against the three parties if the liquidation applications are successful, the court said: “This is a separate point altogether”.

The court added: “At that stage, (they would) be entitled to defend the claims on the merits. There must be something more, apart from being the sole direct target of a winding-up application, for a person to be entitled to participate in the hearing itself.”

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Business

UOB chief Wee Ee Cheong's pay down 20% to \$12 million in 2025

Sheila Chiang

557 words

19 March 2026

The Straits Times

STIMES

online

English

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SINGAPORE - UOB deputy chairman and chief executive Wee Ee Cheong was paid less in 2025 compared with 2024, mainly due to a lower bonus.

Mr Wee's \$12 million 2025 pay package was 20 per cent lower than the \$15 million he received in 2024. It was also lower than the \$15.9 million he received in 2023, according to the bank's annual report released on March 19.

His annual remuneration comprised a base salary of \$1.44 million, unchanged from 2024, and a bonus of \$10.6 million, down from \$13.6 million in 2024. Benefits-in-kind, and transport- and events-related benefits amounted to \$42,629, lower than the \$46,944 in 2024.

UOB said that 60 per cent of the variable pay to Mr Wee is deferred and will vest over the next three years. Of the deferred variable pay, 40 per cent will be issued in deferred cash, while the remaining 60 per cent will be in the form of share-linked units.

Variable pay is the part of one's salary that is not fixed and can change depending on performance, company results, or specific targets.

UOB's fourth-quarter net profit for the period ended Dec 31, 2025, fell 7 per cent year-over-year as net interest income moderated amid interest margin headwinds. Net profit for the three months came in at \$1.41 billion, down from \$1.52 billion a year ago.

For 2025, net profit was \$4.7 billion, 23 per cent lower than \$6 billion a year ago, largely due to pre-emptive general allowances that the group proactively set aside in the third quarter to strengthen provision coverage amid growing macroeconomic uncertainties.

Allowances for credit and other losses more than quadrupled in the quarter to \$1.36 billion.

In a statement, Mr Wee said that the bank will continue to stand by its customers through challenging conditions while safeguarding the long-term interests of all stakeholders.

UOB is also focused on capturing Asean's opportunities, he said.

He noted that UOB is in a sweet spot to capture Asean's next stage of growth, given its network across the region and as the bank continues to invest in people, capabilities and technology to better support customers.

"We will strengthen our position as the leading trade bank in Asean, build a profitable and scalable consumer franchise and deliver sustainable returns through cycles," he said.

"Asean is entering a new phase of growth, underpinned by rising affluence, ageing populations and deeper regional integration. These shifts will drive demand for smarter banking, long-term wealth planning and seamless regional connectivity."

UOB is the second of the three local banks to release annual reports for 2025.

DBS CEO Tan Su Shan was paid \$9.64 million for 2025, in her first year at the helm, according to the bank's annual report released on March 9.

Just over half of her 2025 pay package came from a deferred award of \$4.92 million, to be paid mostly in shares. The rest was made up of a cash bonus of \$3.69 million, a base salary of \$975,250 and other payments of \$68,694 comprising club, car and driver benefits.

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COMPANIES & MARKETS

DBS, OCBC, UOB could benefit as the Middle East's ultra-rich relook where to park their billions

841 words

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Business Times Singapore

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A6

English

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PRIVATE bankers and **wealth managers** are known to be a tight-lipped bunch. But from the marbled office lobbies of the Marina Bay Financial Centre to the private dining rooms of Raffles Place, whispers are rising by half a decibel: As geopolitical sands shift in the Middle East, a quiet, accelerating wave of ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) capital could be actively charting an exit ramp – including to Singapore.

For the better part of the last two years, Dubai was the darling of the **family office** world. It offered zero tax, a golden visa that felt like a VIP pass to the future, and a regulatory touch so light it was almost ethereal.

For a single-**family office** (SFO), however, the first rule of stewardship is capital preservation. And with the turmoil in the Middle East now in its third week, one longer-term implication could be that a permanent risk premium will now be attached to Gulf assets.

To be clear, it is unlikely that there will be a dramatic exodus of capital from the Middle East. The region remains one of the world's most significant sources of wealth and its financial centres have grown increasingly sophisticated.

Speaking to The Business Times just after the start of the conflict, **wealth managers** in Singapore said that the Republic could see "incremental inflows" if geopolitical tensions escalate further.

Indeed, global wealth rarely moves in dramatic waves. It trickles, hedges and diversifies – a new banking relationship here; an investment vehicle there; gradually, a deeper footprint in financial centres that promise stability.

But Singapore has spent decades positioning itself for moments like these. It has cultivated a reputation as a neutral, predictable financial centre where global capital can sit quietly, protected by strong legal institutions and a regulatory environment that prizes stability.

Supported by a deep banking sector, a growing base of asset managers and a regulatory framework designed to accommodate private investment structures, Singapore's **family office** ecosystem has expanded rapidly in recent years. In calmer times, its reputation attracts business. In uncertain times, that becomes a strategic asset.

Shift to safety

For some **family offices** managing multi-generational fortunes, a second financial hub abroad can function as a form of insurance against the sort of geopolitical volatility that no portfolio manager can model with precision.

UHNW families in the Middle East – those with investable assets north of US\$30 million – have long maintained what some **wealth managers** call a "diversified domicile strategy".

In practice, this means keeping money in multiple jurisdictions simultaneously: a Swiss **private bank** for legacy holdings; a London account for children in school; and increasingly, an Asian banking centre for exposure to the region's growth story.

What is changing now is the weight assigned to each of those legs.

Prolonged periods of geopolitical stress reinforce the need for these wealth hedges. And Singapore's Big Three local banks could find themselves well positioned to rise with the tide.

With the massive private wealth stock in the Gulf region – estimated to be over a trillion dollars – even a trickle flowing through could translate into meaningfully incremental assets under management for DBS, OCBC and UOB.

The three local lenders have all spent years expanding their **private banking** capabilities to capture a growth in global wealth flows.

DBS, South-east Asia's biggest bank, has been steadily strengthening its own **wealth management** franchise alongside its institutional banking operations. It has set its sights on becoming a top-tier **wealth manager** in Asia, and Middle Eastern inflows would help accelerate a journey already well under way.

Meanwhile, OCBC – through its **private banking** arm, Bank of Singapore – has built a reputation as a gateway for international wealth entering Asia, with advisory teams that understand the often complex governance structures that characterise Gulf UHNW households.

UOB, traditionally the most domestically anchored of the three, has also been quietly expanding its **wealth management** footprint in ways that suggest it is thinking beyond its historical core markets. The Gulf wave could represent an opportunity to close the gap with its larger rivals.

Longstanding relationships

To be sure, the Singapore banking trio will not easily displace the global giants.

For example, Swiss houses such as UBS, Julius Baer and Pictet have the brand recognition and longstanding relationships with Gulf royalty and merchant families that come from decades of cultivation.

But for investors watching DBS, OCBC and UOB and wondering where the next chapter of their **wealth management** growth is written, it may be worth looking towards the Middle East.

These SFOs do not just park cash in fixed deposits. They require sophisticated brokerage, custodial services, complex credit facilities and bespoke advisory. This feeds directly into the local banks' **wealth management** fee engines.

As interest rates soften and net interest margins inevitably face compression this year, the Big Three are under pressure to supercharge their non-interest income. A rising tide of Middle Eastern wealth provides the perfect offset.

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Supplement
Securing what matters most, for the next generation

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N EARLY three-quarters of **family office** professionals report increasing tension among family members, according to Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**'s 2025 research, The Great Repositioning*. Families are navigating market volatility, geopolitical uncertainties and shifting generational expectations. All these forces are converging, compelling families to think about continuity more urgently and making succession planning a priority that can no longer be delayed.

'Succession planning isn't simply about safeguarding assets. It's about managing relationships across generations. This means being present for those building the legacy as well as the successor inheriting responsibility.'

Foo Tian Ong, regional head for South-east Asia and Singapore location head at Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**

Families recognise the risks, yet still postpone action. The reason is simple. Succession planning forces uncomfortable conversations about control, inheritance and family leadership especially if the head of the family is still alive. Cultural norms such as taboos around discussing incapacity and bias towards sons, in parts of Asia, add another layer.

Yet the research shows 87 per cent of families believe better succession planning, particularly around cross-border assets, could save them millions. At the same time, while 84 per cent of family members say next-generation engagement is essential, one-third remain dissatisfied with current levels of involvement. Together, these findings underscore that succession planning triggered by crisis is reactive, narrowing options and increasing risk, both financially and relationally.

"Succession planning is compromised when it's reduced to a transaction rather than built as a long-term family process," says Foo Tian Ong, regional head for South-east Asia and Singapore location head at Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**. "Our experience shows that the families who navigate this successfully began the conversation years before any trigger event, building trust, aligning values and bridging generational perspectives."

Early engagement changes the nature of advice. Instead of stepping in at moments of urgency and uncertainty, advisers work with families over time, reviewing governance structures, clarifying decision-making roles and preparing successors gradually. Succession can then evolve alongside changes in regulation, markets and family dynamics.

Rethinking where else and how wealth is anchored

Succession planning grows more complex when families operate across borders. The broader environment in which ultra-high-net-worth (UHNW) families operate has grown more demanding.

The same report also reveals 54 per cent of families are considering relocating their **family offices** (FO) in the next 12 months, reflecting a reassessment of long-term positioning. The top reasons cited include cybersecurity, geopolitical stability and access to specialist talent. For many families, relocation forms part of a strategy to strengthen resilience and diversification.

As wealth and family members span multiple jurisdictions, structures designed for one generation may no longer fit the next. Regulatory requirements shift. Tax frameworks evolve. Technology reshapes how wealth is managed and reported.

Families are no longer maintaining assets within a single jurisdiction or predictable policy regime. They are navigating global exposure, regulatory scrutiny and intergenerational change simultaneously. Succession frameworks must now reflect this repositioning of wealth, geography and governance.

A living process, not a one-time legal event

One Baby Boomer family member with a Hong Kong-based FO, quoted in the research, describes the disciplined approach their family is taking amid heightened uncertainty. "We are about to put our succession plan through a family review. It will then go to the office for execution and support. The global environment today is emphasising preparedness for issues that simply were not around two years ago."

Their experience is not unique. Standard Chartered sees succession increasingly regarded not as a one-time legal event, but as an ongoing process requiring regular review.

Families are enlisting external support to bring neutrality, objectivity and structure to emotionally complex discussions. Effective succession plans combine the "letter of the law", defining ownership and control, with the "spirit of the law", a living framework such as a family charter that articulates shared intentions, values and principles. Balancing both reduces the risk of misunderstanding and long-term disputes.

From old guards to the new guards – bridging generations

When succession plans falter, it is rarely because families lack financial resources or sophisticated structures. The breakdowns are often interpersonal.

Communication gaps can widen between generations shaped by different economic cycles. Investment philosophies may diverge as younger family members seek exposure to newer sectors or geographies.

Where older generations may prioritise capital preservation and continuity, successors may look for different opportunities, access and thematic allocations aligned to their interests. Harnessing this diversity can strengthen strategy and reinforce cohesion, but only when governance provides clear guardrails.

As wealth grows more complex and generational expectations evolve, families are seeking partners who can provide both financial and relational continuity, delivered through dedicated, hands-on advisory support. This extends from succession planning and navigating complex cross-border structures to shaping philanthropic legacies.

"Our generational partnership model is central to the way we work," says Mr Foo. "We bring together seasoned bankers who have earned our clients' trust over decades with younger digitally native talent who understand how the next generation thinks and operates. Succession planning isn't simply about safeguarding assets. It's about managing relationships across generations. This means being present for those building the legacy as well as the successor inheriting responsibility. Building that trust requires being a true partner to the entire family, not just the account holder."

As families rethink how they preserve and grow wealth, Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank** provides both tangible solutions and intangible support.

The Bank offers highly curated opportunities, co-investment options and solutions tailored to specific sector interests or geographic preferences, including private-market opportunities and emerging areas that enhance diversification alongside traditional portfolios.

Initiatives such as the Private Markets Co-Investment Club give eligible UHNW clients deal-by-deal access to manager-led private-market opportunities globally, supported by institutional-grade due diligence and execution. Standard Chartered also has a sports-focused alternative investment fund for UHNW and HNW clients, tapping into sports, media and entertainment as an emerging asset class for those seeking diversification.

At the same time, the Bank provides softer, relationship-driven support. Its flagship Global Families Network Forum helps strengthen succession planning through peer connections. This exclusive platform connects UHNW

families in a private setting to exchange insights and experiences, supporting engagement across multi-generational families outside formal planning cycles.

As a universal bank, Standard Chartered also offers corporate banking services to help families see their full financial picture, from personal wealth to operating businesses and corporate structures. This allows clients to better understand where and how family and enterprise can intersect across generations.

The role of trusted partnership

Standard Chartered Global **Private Bank**'s approach is built on long-term relationships, supporting families through business transitions, **family office** relocations, philanthropic shifts and generational change. In an environment where regulation, geopolitics and markets evolve rapidly, continuity of advice matters.

Mr Foo says, "Succession planning isn't a product you buy when an urgent situation arises. It is a relationship you build over time. The families who get that right are the ones whose legacies survive."

For families navigating one of the largest intergenerational wealth transfers in history, the question is no longer whether to plan, but who to plan with and when to start. The legacies that survive will be those built on early preparation, resilient frameworks and partnerships that recognise succession planning is ultimately about relationships, not just transactions.

"The families that wait for the perfect moment find themselves navigating transitions under pressure. Early action gives families options. Succession planning is about being ready for tomorrow, today," Mr Foo concludes.

*The quantitative research data is drawn from a survey of 300 individuals. The sample group comprised 70 family heads, 70 next-gen family members and 160 FO professionals across Mainland China, Singapore, Hong Kong, London, Dubai, India and Africa. All participants come from families with a minimum of US\$500 million in investable assets.

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Document STBT000020260318em3i00002

BusinessWorld

Special Report

SPECIAL REPORT: Fourth Quarter Banking Report FINANCIAL RATIO

1,563 words

16 March 2026

BusinessWorld

BSWRLD

S4/2

English

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FINANCIAL RATIOS

INTERMEDIATION RATIO	TOTAL LOANS/TOTAL DEPOSITS		
Q4' 25	Q3' 25	Q4' 24	

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	86.91%	84.55%	84.71%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	74.07%	75.69%	70.46%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	91.72%	89.57%	86.95%
Land Bank of the Philippines	42.16%	41.13%	42.03%
China Banking Corp.	73.13%	70.07%	69.90%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	74.21%	76.65%	69.47%
Security Bank Corp.	75.68%	75.37%	85.40%
Philippine National Bank	71.76%	73.76%	68.42%
Union Bank of the Philippines	74.88%	74.87%	77.47%
Development Bank of the Philippines	65.85%	64.00%	70.38%
East West Banking Corp.	87.93%	87.66%	86.84%
Asia United Bank Corp.	79.07%	76.87%	78.72%
Citibank NA	9.15%	9.96%	9.74%
Hongkong & Shanghai			
Banking Corp. Ltd. , The	40.45%	47.51%	46.54%
Bank of Commerce	72.42%	71.75%	63.87%
Philippine Bank of Communications	77.71%	76.05%	91.81%
Philippine Trust Co.	24.25%	22.28%	20.94%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	37.73%	39.29%	33.38%
Standard Chartered Bank	19.45%	16.43%	16.69%
MEDIAN	73.13%	73.76%	69.90%

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Maybank Philippines, Inc.	74.20%	76.37%	77.67%
Philippine Veterans Bank	42.89%	45.32%	46.76%
CTBC Bank	93.30%	96.92%	108.35%
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	67.52%	42.83%	40.18%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	5.08%	6.40%	2.82%
Bank of China Ltd.	117.77%	116.82%	120.13%
Deutsche Bank AG	32.76%	45.22%	70.50%
MEDIAN	67.52%	45.32%	70.50%

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	51.70%	62.57%	46.68%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	71.36%	71.31%	60.94%
Australia & New Zealand			
Banking Group Ltd.	55.13%	55.89%	20.48%
Bank of America NA	9.57%	4.38%	5.72%

ING Bank N. V.	303.66%	603.72%	192.56%
BDO Private Bank	10.60%	9.15%	7.04%
KEB Hana Bank	112.39%	92.26%	110.18%
MEDIAN	55.13%	62.57%	46.68%

P20B AND BELOW

Industrial and Commercial

Bank of China Ltd.	56.00%	99.02%	105.30%
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	366.51%	279.92%	162.64%
Industrial Bank of Korea	236.57%	442.50%	367.10%
Mega International Commercial Bank	73.09%	75.83%	78.83%
Shinhan Bank	219.13%	146.62%	119.40%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	4098.32%	3149.57%	12971.35%
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	590.78%	825.89%	783.40%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	30826.74%	15637.91%	17259.81%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	500.22%	609.16%	846.41%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	869.90%	792.40%	554.86%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	13.27%	13.41%	25.61%
MEDIAN	366.51%	442.50%	367.10%

GRAND MEDIAN	73.60%	75.53%	73.99%
TOTAL LOANS/TOTAL DEPOSITS	72.28%	71.33%	70.30%

STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY RATIO	STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY/TOTAL ASSETS
Q4' 25 Q3' 25 Q4' 24	

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	11.91%	12.06%	12.05%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	10.76%	11.06%	10.88%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	12.78%	13.29%	12.79%
Land Bank of the Philippines	7.87%	7.73%	8.01%
China Banking Corp.	8.44%	8.30%	8.48%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	9.62%	9.68%	10.85%
Security Bank Corp.	9.66%	10.01%	9.66%
Philippine National Bank	17.00%	18.24%	16.59%
Union Bank of the Philippines	17.10%	16.95%	16.73%
Development Bank of the Philippines	9.53%	9.41%	9.77%
East West Banking Corp.	13.93%	14.25%	13.85%
Asia United Bank Corp.	15.86%	15.70%	15.07%
Citibank NA	7.10%	6.79%	6.40%
Hongkong & Shanghai			
Banking Corp. Ltd. , The	6.64%	6.48%	6.62%
Bank of Commerce	12.25%	12.37%	11.98%
Philippine Bank of Communications	11.92%	11.70%	12.83%
Philippine Trust Co.	13.73%	13.50%	12.69%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	7.16%	8.54%	9.54%
Standard Chartered Bank	8.55%	7.59%	8.21%
MEDIAN	10.76%	11.06%	10.88%

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Maybank Philippines, Inc.	9.91%	10.72%	10.32%
Philippine Veterans Bank	9.14%	12.99%	4.21%
CTBC Bank	13.47%	12.17%	10.64%
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	21.08%	10.54%	11.64%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N. A.	7.45%	8.29%	7.42%
Bank of China Ltd.	13.90%	14.31%	17.96%
Deutsche Bank AG	6.03%	5.00%	7.28%
MEDIAN	9.91%	10.72%	10.32%

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	27.84%	25.56%	27.94%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	22.12%	20.88%	20.33%
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	12.55%	12.49%	12.49%
Bank of America NA	16.37%	15.86%	12.91%
ING Bank N.V.	29.06%	27.62%	34.63%
BDO Private Bank	25.26%	23.59%	20.83%
KEB Hana Bank	29.71%	28.81%	26.84%
MEDIAN	25.26%	23.59%	20.83%

P20B AND BELOW

Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	27.49%	35.38%	59.66%
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	60.77%	57.55%	53.05%
Industrial Bank of Korea	41.37%	39.93%	48.15%
Mega International Commercial Bank	37.89%	35.89%	31.96%
Shinhan Bank	46.55%	43.57%	41.11%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	36.70%	38.15%	39.85%
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	64.08%	67.72%	75.37%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	31.49%	39.17%	31.38%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	49.82%	55.60%	52.03%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	52.41%	57.30%	62.70%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	5.09%	2.87%	0.85%
MEDIAN	41.37%	39.93%	48.15%

GRAND MEDIAN	13.81%	13.40%	12.81%
STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY/TOTAL ASSETS	11.39%	11.52%	11.43%

STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY TO LOANS RATIO	STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY/TOTAL LOANS
Q4' 25	Q3' 25
Q4' 25	Q4' 24

P100B AND OVER

BDO Unibank, Inc.	17.70%	18.16%	18.03%
Metropolitan Bank & Trust Co.	21.36%	21.90%	21.25%
Bank of the Philippine Islands	18.18%	19.67%	18.86%
Land Bank of the Philippines	21.18%	21.21%	21.73%
China Banking Corp.	17.15%	17.58%	17.77%
Rizal Commercial Banking Corp.	19.87%	19.43%	22.28%
Security Bank Corp.	21.48%	22.13%	20.22%
Philippine National Bank	30.80%	32.70%	31.54%
Union Bank of the Philippines	35.93%	36.38%	36.40%
Development Bank of the Philippines	18.88%	19.03%	17.99%
East West Banking Corp.	21.01%	21.59%	21.67%
Asia United Bank Corp.	24.96%	25.32%	23.57%
Citibank NA	100.84%	94.04%	108.49%
Hongkong & Shanghai Banking Corp. Ltd., The	24.98%	21.61%	20.74%
Bank of Commerce	21.60%	22.75%	23.35%
Philippine Bank of Communications	22.03%	21.53%	20.11%
Philippine Trust Co.	66.18%	70.59%	70.04%
MUFG Bank Ltd.	30.14%	32.57%	36.69%
Standard Chartered Bank	71.10%	71.42%	72.35%
MEDIAN	21.60%	21.90%	21.73%

OVER P50B, BUT BELOW P100B

Maybank Philippines, Inc.	18.33%	19.39%	19.90%
Philippine Veterans Bank	25.54%	34.81%	9.96%
CTBC Bank	24.13%	20.87%	18.62%
Mizuho Bank Ltd.	52.89%	36.39%	44.28%
JPMorgan Chase Bank N.A.	191.70%	183.17%	390.68%

Bank of China Ltd.	29.06%	27.54%	34.31%
Deutsche Bank AG	29.77%	18.42%	17.97%
MEDIAN	29.06%	27.54%	19.90%

OVER P20B, BUT BELOW P50B

Sumitomo Mitsui Banking Corp.	86.44%	62.15%	92.59%
CIMB Bank Philippines, Inc.	47.66%	43.58%	48.73%
Australia & New Zealand Banking Group Ltd.	53.11%	50.99%	119.24%
Bank of America NA	249.23%	526.34%	288.70%
ING Bank N. V.	52.27%	49.36%	80.90%
BDO Private Bank	445.59%	472.21%	521.80%
KEB Hana Bank	56.50%	57.21%	50.24%
MEDIAN	56.50%	57.21%	92.59%

P20B AND BELOW

Industrial and Commercial Bank of China Ltd.	145.19%	194.12%	288.77%
Bangkok Bank Public Co. Ltd.	63.64%	66.22%	85.29%
Industrial Bank of Korea	74.02%	73.73%	83.99%
Mega International Commercial Bank	98.29%	93.38%	92.60%
Shinhan Bank	116.83%	115.51%	97.77%
Chang Hwa Commercial Bank Ltd.	118.56%	153.84%	185.66%
Cathay United Bank Co. Ltd.	92.61%	96.20%	116.09%
Hua Nan Commercial Bank Ltd.	48.76%	81.81%	61.95%
United Overseas Bank Ltd.	70.63%	73.10%	71.32%
First Commercial Bank Ltd.	86.67%	100.83%	103.79%
Al-Amanah Islamic Investment Bank	45.70%	24.97%	4.17%
MEDIAN	86.67%	93.38%	92.60%

GRAND MEDIAN	46.68%	36.38%	40.49%
STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY/TOTAL LOANS	21.45%	22.03%	21.84%

Source: Banks's published balance sheets and consolidated balance sheets for the fourth quarter.

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UBS hires ex-HSBCprivate banking exec in Geneva

Paromita Dey

227 words

13 March 2026

Citywire Middle East

CWIRME

English

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UBS has appointed Mostafa Baligh as an executive director in its private banking division, based in Geneva, according to an update on his LinkedIn profile.

In his new role, Baligh will advise high-net-worth and ultra-high-net-worth clients, entrepreneurs, and family offices across Egypt, North Africa, and Jordan.

His remit includes global investment strategies, portfolio management, wealth structuring, and cross-border financial solutions — areas that have become increasingly important as Middle Eastern and North African wealth continues to internationalise.

Baligh joins UBS from HSBC Private Bank in Dubai, where he spent more than four years as a director. His earlier career includes roles at Abu Dhabi Islamic Bank (ADIB), Emirates Islamic, and CIB Egypt, giving him a broad regional perspective across both conventional and Islamic finance.

The appointment comes as UBS continues to strengthen its wealth management franchise following its landmark acquisition of Credit Suisse in 2023. The group has been sharpening its focus on emerging market wealth pools, including the Middle East and North Africa, where client demand for global diversification and sophisticated advisory services has been rising.

Meanwhile, UBS chief executive Sergio Ermotti, who returned to lead the bank through the Credit Suisse integration, is [expected](#) to step down early-2027, marking the end of a pivotal chapter for the Swiss banking giant.

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Document CWIRME0020260313em3d0002t

Business

NSE appoints 20 merchant banks for IPO book running

The Hindu Bureau

164 words

12 March 2026

The Hindu Online

THINDO

English

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The National Stock Exchange (NSE), which is the largest exchange by volume, has appointed 20 merchant bankers for conducting its initial public offering,.

The exchange's IPO was in limbo for almost a decade and had recently received SEBI's nod to file papers.

"The 20 merchant bankers selected include Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited, JM Financial Limited, Axis Capital Limited, IIFL Capital Services Limited (formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited), Motilal Oswal Investment Advisors Limited, ICICI Securities Limited, SBI Capital Markets Limited, Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, HDFC Bank Limited, Avendus Capital Private Limited, Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited, Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited, J.P. Morgan India Private Limited, HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited, IDBI Capital Markets & Securities Limited, 360 ONE WAM Limited, Anand Rathi Advisors Limited, DAM Capital Advisors Limited, Pantomath Capital Advisors Private Limited, and Equirus Capital Private Limited," NSE said in a statement.

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Business

StanChart looks to China wealth in Singapore

OWEN WALKER ; ARJUN NEIL ALIM

445 words

12 March 2026

Financial Times

FTFTA

1; Main

10

English

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Financial services

Standard Chartered plans to double the number of private bankers catering to wealthy Chinese in Singapore despite increased scrutiny of flows from China after a series of high-profile money-laundering scandals.

The bank, which has ambitions to be a top **wealth manager** in Asia, would add up to 50 relationship managers in Singapore this year to attract rich Chinese clients, Raymond Ang, global head of StanChart's private bank, told the FT.

"Singapore continues to be a very important offshore banking centre for wealthy Chinese clients, especially from northern and western China," he said.

The city-state has long been seen as a destination for Chinese people to park their money outside the mainland.

In 2024, the latest data available, Singapore reported a 43 per cent increase in the number of single-**family offices** through which many individuals manage their wealth.

But a series of money-laundering cases in recent years involving Chinese nationals has led to increased scrutiny of sources of wealth and delays in setting up accounts.

This has resulted in some clients favouring Gulf financial centres due to the relative ease of setting up bank accounts and establishing **family offices** there.

"I would be very surprised if there was growth of 43 per cent last year" for Singapore's **family offices**, said Neil Synnott, regional chief commercial officer for Asia-Pacific at investment services group IQ-EQ. "Growth may be down but the numbers and assets under management will still be up."

StanChart, which has its headquarters in London but derives most of its revenue from Asia, believes that there is still enough demand in Singapore because of the city-state's historic strength in attracting Chinese wealth.

The attacks against Iran this month and Tehran's retaliation across the Middle East have led some bankers to believe wealthy clients may move their money from the Gulf to Singapore.

Attracting wealthy expatriates from China and India, who often have complex multi-jurisdictional sources of income and investment, has been central to StanChart's plans to bolster its **wealth management** business.

In 2024, the bank announced plans to double its investment in **wealth management** and plough \$1.5bn into the business over five years as part of efforts to shift into areas less dependent on interest income.

It added 275,000 affluent clients last year and \$52bn of net new money. Roughly a third of its clients were Chinese customers who held money outside the mainland, the bank said.

City-state has long been seen as a place for Chinese people to park their money outside the mainland

Document FTFTA00020260312em3c0008n

DBS Private Bank funds boss exits

Citywire Asia Staff

148 words

10 March 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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DBS Private Bank's head of funds John Ng has exited the Singapore-based lender.

Ng has left after a nine-year stint at the bank, where he led the funds and product team.

A DBS spokesperson confirmed Ng's departure.

He joined from Bank of Singapore as head of portfolio counselling and product strategy, in what was then a newly created role, in 2017. At Bank of Singapore he had led research teams covering fund, equities, bonds and private equity, spending eight years at the OCBC-owned private bank.

Prior to that, Ng worked in asset management, having a four-year stint in Europe with Fortis Investments. He also had earlier roles in corporate banking and project finance at banks in Singapore and Hong Kong earlier in his career.

His replacement has not yet been announced by DBS.

Document CWIRAS0020260310em3a0002t



Business

HSBC Hong Kong CEO sees global tensions, China tech growth drawing wealth to city

Enoch Yiu

883 words

9 March 2026

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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HSBC's local unit gained nearly 2 million new customers in two years as global investors shift assets to Hong Kong

Escalating geopolitical tensions and the rapid growth of Chinese technology companies are prompting international investors to shift more assets to Hong Kong, according to the head of HSBC's local unit.

The trend is benefiting the bank's **wealth management business**. HSBC had added nearly 2 million new individual customers in the city over the past two years, bringing its total customer base in Hong Kong to about 7 million, said Maggie Ng, CEO of HSBC Hong Kong, in her first media interview since taking the role in October.

"Some of our international clients have contacted our bankers in recent days to seek advice on how to diversify their portfolios amid the geopolitical tensions," Ng said.

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Market participants said the [conflict between the United States and Iran](#) had prompted investors in the Middle East and Europe to consider reallocating part of their investments to Hong Kong and other Asian markets as a perceived safe haven.

Ng said the bank had also seen capital inflows into Hong Kong and mainland Chinese stocks following the technological breakthrough of artificial intelligence start-up DeepSeek in January last year, when it introduced low-cost, high-efficiency AI models.

"With geopolitical tensions continuing to escalate, and with strong growth opportunities among Chinese technology companies listed in Hong Kong, we expect capital inflows into the city to continue this year," Ng said.

"This will strengthen Hong Kong's role as a **wealth management** centre and a **family office** hub."

The Hong Kong government plans to submit a bill in the first half of this year seeking to expand the range of investment products – including gold and [digital assets](#) – that qualify for tax exemptions for **family offices** and investment funds.

Ng said the move would help attract more wealthy families to the city.

"While we have seen many wealthy mainland Chinese clients come here to establish **family offices**, we are also seeing affluent families from across Asia and other parts of the world choosing Hong Kong for investment and succession planning," she said.

HSBC's 7 million customers in Hong Kong came from about 170 countries and regions, she added.

"We are not limited by geographic boundaries in our business development. While we continue to serve our local customers, we also want to be a bank serving international clients."

The lender added 1.1 million new individual customers last year after adding 800,000 in 2024, driven largely by growth in its **wealth management** business, Ng said.

To serve international clients and younger, tech-savvy investors, HSBC had increased investment in its wealth centres as well as its digital platforms and services, she said. The bank operates five **wealth management** centres in Hong Kong, each hosting about 100 client meetings a day on average.

More than 80 per cent of wealth transactions are executed through mobile apps. HSBC added more than 600 new features to its Hong Kong mobile app last year and will launch a scheme on Monday encouraging passbook customers to switch to integrated accounts.

The bank was also deploying artificial intelligence to enhance client services, including chatbots to answer customer enquiries and tools to summarise research reports. The next stage would allow platforms to screen and recommend suitable products to clients, Ng said.

"The digital shift has attracted younger customers. Many of our new clients are in their early 30s, and the average age of our Hong Kong customer base has fallen by about five years compared with a few years ago," she said.

HSBC last month reported better-than-expected profits for 2025. Pre-tax profit from its Hong Kong operations, including Hang Seng Bank, rose 5 per cent to US\$9.6 billion last year, making the city the lender's single largest market and contributing 32 per cent of group pre-tax profit.

However, rising bad debt remains a concern. The bank set aside US\$700 million in provisions related to Hong Kong's commercial real estate sector last year, up from US\$100 million in 2024, as oversupply of office and retail space weighed on property values.

"Hong Kong residential property prices turned the corner in 2025," Ng said. "We recognise that commercial real estate is cyclical and we take a long-term view. While there are short-term challenges, we remain constructive about the medium- to long-term outlook."

HSBC also added 30,000 new corporate clients in Hong Kong last year, bringing its total to more than 300,000. Ng attributed the growth to improving retail sales and business sentiment.

Hong Kong retail sales rose nearly 7 per cent year on year in December and increased 1 per cent for 2025 as a whole, according to government data. Statistics from the Hong Kong Monetary Authority also showed that new mortgage loan applications rose 15.4 per cent in January from the previous month.

Document SCMCOM0020260309em3900001

Exclusive: HSBC Private Bank and Premier Wealth's Asia CIO exits

Priyanka Boghani

174 words

9 March 2026

Citywire Asia

CWIRAS

English

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After almost a decade at HSBC, the **private bank** and premier wealth's Asia chief investment officer has retired, Citywire Asia has learnt.

Hong Kong-based Fan Cheuk Wan has exited the bank, where she held the role for over five years. Her last day was 28 February.

She was responsible for developing regional investment strategies and investment themes across all asset classes for **private banking** and wealth management clients in Asia. Fan was also a member of the global investment committee and chair of the regional investment committee in Asia, making investment decisions on tactical asset allocation for advisory portfolios of **private banking** clients, according to her LinkedIn.

She also held the role of chief market strategist Asia at HSBC.

A spokesperson from the bank confirmed Fan's retirement.

Prior to her tenure at HSBC, Fan worked at Credit Suisse for over eight years as the Apac CIO and head of research for Apac and also spent over five years at ABN AMRO.

Document CWIRAS0020260309em3900003

Business

Hong Kong banks face limited Middle East risk but tensions cloud expansion plans

Enoch Yiu

868 words

5 March 2026

scmp.com

SCMCOM

English

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HSBC and Standard Chartered expanded in the Middle East in recent years to capture growing cross-border trade and wealth management flows

Hong Kong lenders have only “insignificant” exposure to the Middle East, the city’s banking regulator said, although analysts expect escalating tensions in the region could slow local banks’ expansion plans in the near term.

“The exposures of the Hong Kong banking sector to the Middle East are insignificant,” a spokeswoman for the Hong Kong Monetary Authority (HKMA) said in response to an inquiry from the South China Morning Post.

“The HKMA does not comment on market rumours,” she added, responding to a Bloomberg report earlier this week that said the authority had asked at least two local lenders to review their Middle East exposures amid rising geopolitical tensions.

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HSBC and Standard Chartered – two of the three note-issuing banks in the city – have stepped up their presence in the Middle East in recent years to capture growing cross-border trade and wealth management opportunities.

Standard Chartered opened a branch in Saudi Arabia in 2021, adding to its long-established presence in the United Arab Emirates (UAE), where it has operated for more than a century.

HSBC, meanwhile, opened a 24,000 sq ft wealth centre in Dubai in September, its first wealth hub in the Middle East. The facility represents the bank’s largest investment in its premier banking segment in the UAE in two decades, according to HSBC’s local CEO.

Despite the modest exposure levels, analysts said heightened geopolitical risk could temper banks’ expansion plans in the short term.

“The Middle East conflicts will inevitably lead local lenders to slow down their investment in Dubai and other cities in the area for the near future,” said Kenny Ng Lai-yin, a strategist at Everbright Securities International.

Standard Chartered, headquartered in London but focused on emerging markets across Asia, the Middle East and Africa, has operations in Bahrain, Iraq, Oman, Pakistan, Qatar, Saudi Arabia and the UAE, according to its 2025 results announcement.

The UAE was the bank’s fourth-largest contributor to pre-tax profit last year, generating US\$562 million or about 7 per cent of the group’s total of US\$7.9 billion.

That placed it behind Hong Kong, which contributed US\$2.66 billion, as well as African and other smaller markets at US\$1.41 billion and Singapore at US\$1.14 billion, but ahead of India at US\$543 million and the United States at US\$501 million.

Revenue from the UAE reached US\$1.17 billion last year, accounting for 5.6 per cent of the group’s total US\$20.89 billion.

A research report by JPMorgan Chase said a further escalation of military conflict in the Middle East could trigger broader market risk aversion, potentially leading to a sharper pullback in Standard Chartered's share price because of its relatively higher exposure to the region.

However, the bank said the risks would remain manageable, noting that about 73 per cent of Standard Chartered's loans in the UAE were extended to governments, public-sector entities or financial institutions.

Loans issued by Standard Chartered in the UAE accounted for 2.5 per cent of its total loan book last year, while HSBC's lending to the Middle East represented about 2.3 per cent of its total loans, according to the JPMorgan Chase report.

HSBC reported profit before tax of US\$1.09 billion in the Middle East last year, equivalent to 3.6 per cent of the group's total US\$29.9 billion.

"The UAE is one of the top priority markets for HSBC, where we make around US\$1 billion in profit, and the growth opportunity is significant," Mohamed Al Marzooqi, CEO of HSBC UAE, said in an interview with the SCMP in Hong Kong in September.

Hong Kong lawmaker Robert Lee Wai-wang, chairman of Grand Finance Group, said rising uncertainty in the Middle East could prompt investors to shift their focus towards Hong Kong and other Asian markets.

"Given the recent events in the Middle East, investors and businesses will undoubtedly want to choose a place that is business-friendly and stable to operate," Lee said.

Analysts, however, expected banks to maintain their longer-term strategy in the region despite short-term caution.

"Many companies are looking for new markets and supply chains in the Middle East amid the trade tensions between China and the US," Ng said. "Banks will still need to maintain a presence there to meet the demand of their clients."

Mary Huen Wai-yi, CEO of Standard Chartered Hong Kong, Greater China and North Asia, had previously said that many corporate customers were interested in using the bank's network to access business opportunities in the Middle East.

HSBC and Standard Chartered declined to comment on their Middle East operations.

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COMPANIES & MARKETS

OCBC chief Tan Teck Long's new strategy is a masterstroke, but execution risks abound

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WITH the tailwinds of peak interest rates decisively fading, the maiden full-year results briefing last week for OCBC's new group chief executive officer Tan Teck Long was less about the rearview mirror and more about setting the cadence for his tenure.

The headline numbers for FY2025 were certainly respectable. Despite a 2 per cent dip in full-year net profit to S\$7.42 billion, total income hit a record S\$14.6 billion – supporting a 2 per cent rise in profit before tax to a new high of S\$9.12 billion.

But Tan, who formally succeeded former chief Helen Wong at the start of this year, needed a compelling narrative to convince the market that Singapore's second-largest bank can find its next engine of growth.

Enter his freshly minted corporate strategy, "The Next Frontier" – a strategic framework that has all the makings of a masterstroke.

By pivoting deliberately towards South-east Asia and aggressively doubling down on a "whole-of-wealth" continuum, OCBC is leaning into its most formidable, yet historically underutilised, structural advantage: owning the entire wealth manufacturing and distribution chain.

For years, one critique of OCBC has been that its powerful individual engines – including **private banking** arm Bank of Singapore (BOS) and insurance unit Great Eastern Holdings (GEH) – often operated as distinct silos rather than a synchronised fleet.

The Next Frontier is a mandate to finally bridge those gaps. And we did not have to wait long to see this integration in action.

Great Eastern's wealth pivot

The debut of Great Eastern Private this week serves as the first major proof of concept for Tan's unified vision.

The insurer on Tuesday (Mar 3) unveiled Great Eastern Private, a segment proposition created for high-net-worth (HNW) individuals and families across Asia.

Rather than selling universal life policies in a vacuum, this represents an expansion of the insurer's capabilities and service offering to deliver a new suite of solutions and services that support established clients looking to preserve their financial legacy for future generations.

Crucially, it hardwires the broader OCBC ecosystem into the offering. This includes the **private banking** capabilities of BOS and the asset management capabilities of Lion Global Investors.

The scale of the opportunity is staggering, with an estimated US\$5.8 trillion in assets expected to be passed down in Asia-Pacific between 2023 and 2030.

To capture this, GEH is treating wealth transfer not just as a financial transaction, but also as a holistic lifestyle phase.

A prime example is the newly minted Hewton Fair Suite, an exclusive space within the Great Eastern Centre designed for servicing HNW clients. It comes with an on-site medical suite in partnership with Raffles Medical

Group, providing same-day health assessment, as well as access to “healthy longevity” and “medi-wellness” services.

While Great Eastern Private anchors the domestic and regional wealth continuum, OCBC’s broader ambition relies on executing a highly ambitious global geographic play through its **private banking** crown jewel, BOS.

BOS has explicitly anchored its future on a “three-hub” approach: Singapore, Hong Kong, and Dubai, with a target for the Middle East to account for up to 20 per cent of its total revenue and assets under management (AUM).

However, with the Middle East conflict threatening to drag the broader Gulf region into a protracted cycle of instability, this global thrust faces a complex, double-edged sword.

The immediate headwind is macroeconomic. A widening conflict triggers a risk-off environment, where ultra-HNW clients retreat to cash or short-term government bonds – assets that typically generate lower recurring advisory fees.

This “wait-and-see” paralysis will make it significantly harder for BOS to hit its aggressive double-digit fee income growth targets.

Yet, beneath the headline volatility lies a profound structural catalyst: the flight to quality.

As Middle Eastern family offices assess heightened regional risks, the imperative for geographic diversification grows.

This is where BOS’ specific architecture shines. Because it operates a fully fledged hub in Dubai and is headquartered in Singapore, it is perfectly positioned to capture this anxious capital internally.

If a wealthy Gulf client feels overexposed, their BOS relationship manager in Dubai can seamlessly book their assets in Singapore. OCBC retains the client within the Next Frontier ecosystem, actively monetising the geopolitical anxiety.

Reality check

However, a masterstroke on paper needs to survive contact with operational reality. Bringing OCBC’s ambitious domestic and global strategy to life faces severe execution hurdles.

First is the sheer friction of cultural and operational integration. Forcing collaboration between insurance agents, retail branch managers and bespoke **private bankers** involves untangling complex webs of misaligned compensation, client ownership disputes and legacy IT infrastructure.

Encouragingly, OCBC is tackling this head-on with a newly formed wealth management committee comprising Tan, GEH group chief executive Greg Hingston, BOS chief executive Jason Moo, and OCBC head of global consumer financial services Sunny Quek.

This coordinated tone from the top is an undeniably positive development, signalling that the mandate for cross-pollination is being driven by the group’s heaviest hitters and is less likely to be derailed by inter-departmental turf wars.

Second is the funding tightrope. Tan’s strategy relies heavily on advancing technology-led capabilities across the group. Yet, management has committed to maintaining a cost-to-income ratio in the low-to-mid-40 per cent range.

Balancing capital-intensive digital transformation with rigorous cost discipline – while margins compress – leaves little room for error.

Finally, there is the matter of timing. Notably, during the recent results briefing, Tan hesitated to pin down hard targets, specific synergies or firm deadlines for when this internal integration will yield distinct, quantifiable boosts to the bottom line.

While a degree of executive prudence is understandable when rolling out a massive transformation, the market’s patience is rarely infinite.

OCBC has the right road map, the right assets, and a structural advantage in turbulent times. But to truly conquer the Next Frontier, its leadership will need to prove they can move the needle from elegant strategy to hard, measurable execution.

Banking & Finance

HSBC opens wealth centre at Singapore Land Tower amid premium pivot

Shikhar Gupta

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[SINGAPORE] HSBC on Friday (Feb 27) announced the opening of its fourth and largest wealth centre in Singapore on the 33rd floor of the Singapore Land Tower.

This comes as the bank is set to close its Raffles Place retail branch on Saturday, a move announced in January as it pivots towards affluent clients in one of Asia's most important financial hubs.

The new facility has 14 meeting rooms, as well as a family room that the bank said will offer "privacy for complex and multi-generational wealth discussions".

Ashmita Acharya, HSBC's head of international wealth and premier banking in Singapore, said the city-state is "a priority market and a wealth hub" for the bank.

The new wealth centre spans 7,884 square feet and is designed to "deliver a personalised and premium banking experience".

HSBC said Premier and Premier Elite clients will have "exclusive spaces" in the facility.

Premier Elite caters to "affluent clients with a minimum total relationship balance of S\$1.2 million". Such clients will have access to "bespoke creations" from celebrity chef Janice Wong, among other privileges.

The bank said that the new wealth centre is a part of its "ongoing multi-year transformation journey, which includes a fivefold investment towards increasing its physical network in Singapore".

HSBC's announcement follows media reports earlier in the week claiming that the bank has kicked off the sales process for its Singapore insurance business.

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